

The VantaPsy Chronology

A Compendium of Aerisu

— . —

Compiled from the lore of
VantaPsy: Soul Snatcher

Generated: 04 September 2026 · 183 entries

"To lack; To want a soul."

—
VantaPsy

The VantaPsy Chronology

A Quick Primer

Aerisu remembers itself as time recurs, carrying the Echoes of the past into the future. The VantaPsy Chronology traces that history across six ages, following the civilizations, Spirits, souls, magic, and forces that have shaped the world.

The Age of Men ends with the Crystallisation of Elysium. The Age of Gods sees Lunarkos descend and the Shattering reshape the world. The Age of Fairytales rebuilds civilisation around magic. The Age of Magic brings the War for the Orb of Souls. The Age of Knowledge gives way to the present darkness. The Age of Decay now stretches across nine years of night, with a city folded by time and a goddess sleeping within an orphanage.

Magic is potential made manifest through Resonance. Every living thing, memory, desire, and action participates in the same cosmic frame, leaving Echoes that can persist through souls, cultures, places, and even the Stars. Lux connects and sustains these systems. Vanta arises from lack and desire, and when desire becomes self-perpetuating, it becomes the Curse.

The Chronology follows these forces through Aerisu: the nature of the soul, the Spiral Veins beneath the world, the Spirits and their domains, the memories carried through Recursion, and the many ways existence can bloom, decay, and become something else.

New to the Chronology? Start with the VantaPsy Cosmology for a concise overview of the fundamental structure of Aerisu and VantaPsy as a whole.

The Six Ages

Age of Men — the world before the Moon. Solmara rose as an empire of scholars and soldiers who believed order could be perfected. Hoshimira bent the knee as vassal. Sahran was born from exile, the outcast kin of Hoshimira driven into scorching deserts. The Curse was a distant whisper. The Scorching Sun ruled an unchanging sky. The Vanta Explosion crystallised Elysium, and the world prepared to break.

Age of Gods — the sky shattered. Lunarkos fell. Bahamut rose from the planet's core. The collision tore the boundary between soul and matter. Gods ascended from the wreckage. The Moon was born, scarred and veined. The world was remade in fire, light, and divine will.

Age of Fairytales — from ash, myth took root. The Nine Spirits wove the Barrier between realms. The Phumenar sought the Orb. The First Separation cracked the Rift. Gods and mortals learned to coexist. History became legend, and legend became truth.

Age of Magic — magic became the skeleton of civilisation. Dragons soared. The Ashtar marched. Death gardens bloomed. Sorcery intertwined with steel. The world rebuilt itself on arcane foundations. Wonder was woven into the everyday.

Age of Knowledge — the age of codification and pathology. The Diviners systematised the soul. Orthogenesis engineered new life: the Borenfegens. Magic receded. Technology advanced. The world tried to understand itself, and lost something in the process.

Age of Decay — the present. Perpetual night over Sengetsuki. The Curse in every bloodline. The sun a pale memory on Sundays. Technology and magic wear thin. The accumulated weight of every age presses down, and the world holds its breath for the end, or simply another loop.

This document is a work in progress. Entries are added as the Chronology and the game come together.

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Events

Age of Men

Age of Men · Events · also known as Age of Men

In the Age of Men, Aerisu drifted alone.

There was no Moon to govern its tides, no steady rhythm to anchor its seasons. Nights stretched deep and untamed, the stars sharp as glass and yet strangely restless.

The Nations during the Age of Men

Solmara

Solmara was the seat of the Autarchs, before the Psycrata, a rising empire of scholars, rulers, and soldiers who believed order could be perfected through ritual precision, merciless efficiency, and ambition honed to a blade. They did not waste lives lightly, only without hesitation. Sacrifice was currency spent cleanly. When their mechs first strode through the mountains, gleaming like iron-winged seraphs, the people of Hoshimira named them Angels. That reverence became a bond, and Hoshimira bent the knee as vassal, empire and mountain learning to walk as one.

Hoshimira

Hoshimira was a mountain realm of wind, lanterns, and stillness where breath was sacred and every echo remembered the ancestors. When some of their kin dug too greedily for the Golden Heart buried deep within the mountain, splitting stone against the elders' will, Solmaran mechs aided in casting the diggers out. The people believed the Angels had judged them, and harmony was preserved. Still, exile carries its own echo, and it never truly fades.

Sahran

Sahran was born from that exile. The outcast kin of Hoshimira were driven into scorching deserts, where survival meant learning the language of flame and stone. Once miners and engineers, they became masters of craft through hardship, their faith bending toward reconciliation and prayer for return to Aokusa, their birth mountain. Sahrani societies were built on endurance and penitence, a long act of atonement. Some clung to quiet perseverance, hoping the Angels would one day forgive. Others, calling themselves Luminaries, burned hotter, demanding a reckoning.

Related: [Solmara](#), [North Solmara](#), [South Solmara](#), [Hoshimira](#), [Sahran](#)

Geode Rebellion

Age of Men · Events · also known as Geode Rebellion, The Red Orphan Tier

Life Under Autarch Control

The exiled kin of Aokusa were driven into those depths as expendable labour. Identity was stripped away. Family followed. Dignity did not survive long. Children vanished into the Orphan Tiers, where memory was replaced with ritual and obedience carved into young bones.

Silence was demanded. Fear was enforced.

The Curse whispered through the caverns in shadows and distortions and sudden disappearances, but to speak of it was treason. Still, the Sahrani endured. They shaped stone and steel beneath the watchful eyes of mechs once called Angels.

The Red Orphan Tier

In one of those tiers, a girl grew up in shadow, Zharael. Death revealed itself to her at six. Indoctrination followed by ten. Anger was buried beneath ritual silence. Some like her learned defiance quietly. Tools became weapons. Sabotage became prayer. The Autarchs named them Saboteurs and burned them in public squares, but each death only fed the resistance.

The Rebellion of the Tiers

By twelve, she witnessed revolt. Tunnels exploded. Patrols vanished. Flames answered flames. The Autarchs struck back with mechs and stormfire, but the rebels fought like people who had already lost everything.

They forced the oppressors upward, reclaiming tier by tier. Councils formed again. Shrines were rebuilt. Prayers were spoken aloud without permission. The Geode became the heart of its people. No longer exiles. Sahrani, in truth.

Still, she understood what freedom really was. The Autarchs had not vanished. They had only repositioned. Peace was never the absence of war. It was the rearrangement of power.

Related: [Geode Expedition](#), [Sahrani](#), [Tayran](#)

Geode Expedition

Age of Men · Events · also known as Geode Expedition

The Geode Expedition

After the rebellion, the Geode breathed again. Its upper tiers thrummed with reclamation. Miners moved in steel shells. Pneumatics gasped. Picks chimed against crystal. Councils governed in the open light.

Below the worked stone, something else gathered. In the deep places where the world grew strange, a silence took shape. It listened. A fissure called the Mouth drank light and bent signals into something that sounded like lament.

They descended. A chosen few. Drawn by a hum felt in bone and marrow, by a pull from a wound that refused to close. The descent felt like pilgrimage, fragile and unsteady, into the throat of the earth.

The air thickened into violet miasma. Stone softened, taking on the weight of memory and flesh. Shapes emerged from the dark. The Cursed, their humanity folded inward into terrible forms. VantaBats clung to fossilised ribs. Shadowlings moved through quartz like bad dreams. Tinnin watched in stillness, guarding a truth too heavy for light to hold. From above, watchers observed in silence. Their attention carried reverence. The expedition became something ritualistic. Each loss settled like a hymn spoken too quietly to interrupt.

Then the Deep revealed itself.

It was no simple formation. It pulsed slowly, conscious, ancient, dreaming in geothermal blood. To stand before it was to feel the planet remembering itself. And it felt them in return.

When catastrophe came, it arrived as understanding. Faced with an ending that would consume all, one chose mercy that could not be undone. A great mech, Siba, born for war and protection, was given over as a vessel. It was ruptured through love that understood letting go.

Light tore upward through the Geode's central seam. For a moment, every tunnel and crystal facet glowed. Every face was washed in brilliance that felt terrible and holy all at once. It looked like dawn, but it was born from a single human will.

Then the light faded.

The instrument was gone. The one who guided it was simply absent.

The survivors climbed carrying two weights. Grief that crushed the chest. Truth that burned to hold. The Curse slept, but it dreamed. The Heart was real. It was awake. The wound had no bottom.

Above, life found its rhythm again. Still, the light was remembered. It lingered in crystal memory and in the quiet reverence of those who lived because someone else chose to vanish.

The world had shifted. The balance between those who walked the crust and the sentience beneath it had changed, shaped by sacrifice rather than decree. And even now, the echo asks its question.

Was this clarity a gift, or only delay. Did it serve the truth, or teach the darkness that it had been seen.

Related: [Geode Rapture](#), [Geode Rebellion](#), [Sahran](#), [The Geode](#)

Geode Rapture

Age of Men · Events · also known as Rapture

The Second Descent

Years passed. Another team descended through reinforced scaffolds and scorched, collapsed walls. The deeper they went, the more alive the Geode seemed. Stone pulsed. Walls shifted. Violet miasma thickened until understanding itself felt fragile. Few survived.

At the heart, a vast cavern beat like a living organism, drawing creatures toward it and overwhelming all who approached. The Geode proved semi sentient, defended by its own spawn, incomprehensible and uncontainable.

Rapture

It erupted.

Walls breathed. Mists devoured. Creatures of stone, fire, and shadow swept through miners, soldiers, and engineers alike. Resistance was brief. Meaningless. Above, watchers clutched charms, names striking their tongues like cold pins. Analysts murmured over readings, blind to the lie of stability. Elsewhere, survivors ran for lifts, dragging the wounded, carrying children.

A scavenged plane roared to life, weaving through crystalline pillars and swarming darkness. It carried a couple into the open sky. At the heart of it all, a figure stood above the main shaft, arms raised, commanding the tide with awe and certainty. The Geode had become a crucible. A womb of power and destruction.

Those who escaped bore witness. The cries of the lost followed them like shadows. Choices weighed heavy on their backs. Outside, the sun struck the world without mercy. Endless desert stretched beyond the wound. Freedom had come.

And it had cost everything.

The Geode's influence did not end at its walls.

Related: [Geode Expedition](#), [Geode Rebellion](#), [Sahran](#), [The Geode](#)

Sanctum Verge

Age of Men · Events · also known as Sanctum Verge

Sanctum Verge - Ori'sol

During the Ori'sol War, a Hoshimiran squad descended into the ruined city. Streets choked with black rain, ash, and the remnants of collapsed buildings guided their march. Signs of Sahrani occupation were everywhere: makeshift fortifications, traces of ritual, and the whispers of the Curse in hollow halls.

A young apprentice was taken in an early skirmish. Cruel experiments tried to turn the Curse into a weapon. Retaliation came swiftly. The outpost was stormed. Defenders, including children and the desperate, were executed. Survivors burned what remained.

Even after the battle, the squad saw how fragile control had been. The checkpoint they had defended lay destroyed in their absence. Only ruin remained, along with the echo of choices made under duress. Survivors bore the weight of what had been done and what had been left undone, learning that the Curse was more than a threat of flesh. It was a threat to faith, to obedience, and to the shadow of human will itself.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Ori'sol](#), [Aokusa](#), [Sahran](#), [The Luminaries](#)

Ik-Rasul Incident

Age of Men · Events · also known as Ik-Rasul Incident

The Ik-Rasul Incident - Aokusa, Hoshimira

They call it the Ik-Rasul Incident now.

When the Ik-Rasul fell into Aokusa, the basin shuddered. Not like an earthquake. More like something heavy settling where it did not belong. The mountains felt it first. Then the water.

Solmaran broadcasts named it a cross-border bio-threat. Clean words. Useful words. They spoke of containment and monitoring while the highlands fractured quietly, and the rivers and springs answered in ways no one wanted to explain.

In the southern cities, people began to hear things.

Hallucinations, they said. Night terrors. Whispering voices that carried the cadence of old Hoshimiran chants, half-remembered prayers slipping into waking thought. Black-Blood Syndrome received its name long before it was understood.

Drones were sent into aquifers and fields. They recorded animals behaving incorrectly, soil that responded as if it were listening. The Angels were redeployed. The Autarchs had built them to protect Aokusa, and so they returned to the basin as they always had.

Some came back changed.

Their sensors flickered with patterns no operator had written. No command acknowledged them. Beneath the basin, the echo fields began to hum. Not loudly. Just enough to suggest that something unseen had stirred, and that the mountains were no longer dormant.

Ori'sol became a place of fear, fascination, and silence gathered together. The Curse was never named in policy, but it moved anyway. Not through blood alone. Through thought. Through perception. Through the quiet spaces people used to feel safe in.

The fall of the Ik-Rasul reshaped the mountains. It unsettled the Angels. It left Solmara listening, even as it pretended not to hear.

Related: [Ik-Rasul](#), [Aokusa](#)

Operation C.a.R

Age of Men · Events · also known as Operation C.a.R, C.a.R

Operation C.a.R: Containment and Restoration

Operation C.a.R was named in the wake of too many fractures to ignore. Sahran, Hoshimira, Ylvara. All of them destabilised after the Ik-Rasul fell in Aokusa. I remember how quickly the language hardened. Crisis. Cascade. Necessity.

By then, Tayran's northern coast was already burning quietly. Luminary doctrine had seeped into governance, tightening its grip, pushing the province toward collapse. Beneath it all lay the Geode, still alive in its own way, its deep tunnels a long-forged crucible of Sahrani rebellion. As the Curse spread and belief sharpened into escalation, Solmara answered with authorisation.

Project DAEDALUS was deployed. Private forces. Bipedal mechs. Rapid response units that moved faster than law and spoke with the voice of stabilisation. Insurgency was suppressed. Territory was secured. Civilians were extracted in clean, methodical waves. Hoshimiran orphans were prioritised, relocated to Isvara, an island city wrapped in surveillance and procedure. It was called refuge and containment in the same breath. Every child logged. Every movement traced. Control made efficient.

Alongside this, quieter operations reached outward. Survivors from distant incidents, including those touched by Ik-Rasul, were gathered and redirected into Isvara's narrow corridors. Displacement became policy. Care became management.

Across Sahran, the responses diverged. Tayran burned with conviction. Najmara and Zaristan accepted intervention to keep their streets intact. Panjara stayed distant, watching the tide without stepping into it.

Operation C.a.R was framed as restoration. I think it was more like a hand pressed firmly over a wound, holding it closed long enough for the bleeding to slow. Whether anything beneath it healed is another question.

Related: [Ik-Rasul Incident](#), [Isvara](#)

Vaelmiric War

Age of Men · Events · also known as Vaelmiric War

The Vaelmiric War

They were filed alongside the ~~Calm Accords~~, which tells you something about the kind of peace the Accords actually were.

The Regulations emerged from the wreckage of the Vaelmiric War, which itself emerged from something the Solmaran Council had been doing quietly for years beneath the administrative language of research and stabilisation. ~~Black Blood~~ subjects. Orphaned children, mostly, processed through the same channels that had always processed displaced children, logged and scheduled and made available to programs that required living subjects and preferred ones without families to ask questions.

Norrvektstan and Silealyros disagreed about almost everything. Their coastlines, their values, their understanding of what a person was worth and to whom. The one thing that pulled them into alignment, briefly and violently, was this. Norrvektstan called it slavery and meant it with the full weight of communal obligation, the sense that a community which permits this has failed its most basic function. Silealyros called it the same thing and meant something different, bodily autonomy as the last sovereign territory, the self as the one asset no institution had the right to extract without contract.

The Vaelmiric War was fought on the water and in the coastal provinces and in the administrative chambers of Ylvara simultaneously. When it ended, the Regulations were written into the Accords as a condition of settlement. ~~Black Blood~~ research under direct Council sanction was prohibited. Existing subjects were to be released and remanded to humanitarian care. Language that sounded like resolution and functioned like reclassification.

Isvara was built shortly after.

The children went from one kind of supervised enclosure to another, and the paperwork described both as protection. The Regulations remained on record, cited in governance documents for decades afterward, proof that the Council had answered the question.

What the Council had actually done was change the name of the room.

Related: [Calm Accords](#), [Black Blood Regulations](#), [Isvara](#)

Calm Accords

Age of Men · Events · also known as Calm Accords

The Calm Accords

The Calm Accords were signed after decades of naval and coastal ruin, when North and South Solmara could no longer afford the weight of open war. Vaelmir was divided in careful language. Central waters were stripped of fleets. Patrols were reduced to symbols. Authority was split along old fault lines: Norrvektstan claimed stewardship of the inland ocean, while the southern provinces retained the ports, trade routes, and chokepoints that fed them both. Disputed isles were placed under joint oversight, a solution neither side trusted.

Weapons of reach and spectacle were forbidden. Alchemical payloads. Arcane artillery. Long-range platforms capable of turning sea into grave. Neutral mediators were appointed to inspect compliance, their reports precise and incomplete. Violations followed quietly, most often in the North, buried beneath logistics, experimental clauses, and storms that swallowed evidence.

Economic terms followed. Shared tariffs. Reparations framed as stabilisation. Trade resumed, slower and heavier, carrying resentment alongside goods. Corruption took root where oversight thinned. Non-interference clauses were signed, archived, and ignored when opportunity outweighed risk.

No one called it peace for long.

Veterans named it the Silent Curse. In the North, it was remembered as surrender dressed in civility. In the South, as restraint enforced by law and leverage. Songs and pamphlets preserved it as a pause rather than an end, a held breath stretched too far. The Calm Accords did not still Vaelmir. They taught it to wait and prepare for the inevitable storm.

Related: [Vaelmiric War](#), [Black Blood Regulations](#)

Black Blood Regulations

Age of Men · Events · also known as Black Blood Regulations

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Related: [Vaelmiric War](#), [Calm Accords](#)

Vireliax Expedition

Age of Men · Events · also known as Vireliax Expedition

The Vireliax Expedition

The ~~Vireliax~~ departed from Velmora Port as a thing of legend even before it vanished beneath the waves. A submersible dreadnought, part warship and part ritual object. Her hull was obsidian-reinforced steel woven with living polymers. Sigils flickered faintly under emergency lights, not decorative, but attentive. She was built to cross oceans, yes, but also to move through the metaphysical currents of ~~Aerisu~~ itself.

She was commanded by a seasoned captain. His crew were scholars, warriors, and technicians who knew better than to pretend those roles were separate. The expedition followed reports of the Curse, a psychic and spiritual affliction rising from the planet's depths. Yet as the Vireliax descended into the ~~Vaelmir~~ Rift, the Maw, the mandate began to feel small. Incomplete.

Some aboard believed the Curse was not an illness at all. They suspected a forming planetary intelligence, later called Bahamut. Something that observed. Something that reacted. Something that might judge.

Life aboard settled into a careful rhythm of duty and ritual. Laughter echoed through corridors. Private rites were performed in silence. Small pilgrimages traced familiar paths through the ship. These moments softened the tension, but never erased it.

Threats came from outside and from within.

Pirate fleets attacked with conventional weapons and perception-altering nanoviruses. The Curse manifested aboard the vessel itself, warping trust and blurring the boundary between ally and enemy. Decisions became heavy. Moral certainty eroded quickly in the dark.

The expedition reached the Eye of the Maw, a living storm wrapped around a calm, sentient void. Crew and vessel moved as one as the Vireliax pierced the abyss. Bioluminescent life drifted through the depths. Light patterns shifted with intent. Symbols emerged that no one had taught, yet many recognised.

It was clear then that the Maw was aware.

Survival carried a terrible cost. Psychological fracture spread. The Curse deepened. The nanovirus unravelled cohesion. Key figures faced choices that could not be justified cleanly, weighing survival against pre-emptive containment.

When it ended, the Vireliax was crippled. The crew was shattered. What remained were fragments of hope, damaged data, and accounts that refused to align.

Tactically, the expedition failed.

But it remains a study in what happens when military force, scientific inquiry, and metaphysical curiosity converge. A record of resilience and folly. A warning about confronting intelligence that does not need to explain itself.

Aerisu's depths are alive.

They remember being watched.

Related: [Vaelmir](#)

Phantom Rescue

Age of Men · Events · also known as Phantom Rescue

Operation Phantom Rescue

People still call it a rescue. That is the clean word. I think it was closer to a haunting.

After the Vireliax was broken, the survivors did not vanish. They were paraded. At Thalgrith Port they were displayed like proof of ownership, marched beneath stormlight and neon, sorted into corridors of bidding and locked rooms with polite names. Stormriven captains broadcast their demands with theatrical restraint. Ylvara was to abandon its Black-Blood work, or the prisoners would be consumed piece by piece. Solmara could not answer without igniting the sea.

So they chose absence instead.

A phantom was commissioned. Not a fleet, not a declaration. Just a shape moving through gaps. The official targets were few. A scholar who knew too much. A researcher whose mind still mattered to the Council. Symbols worth recovering. The rest were classified as noise, unless deniability could be preserved. That is how the order was written. I have seen how language sharpens itself when it wants to cut without blood.

Two figures moved through Thalgrith that night, though history pretends there was only one.

One was a ghost from Shinkiri. She treated the city like a puzzle laid flat beneath her feet. Guards, habits, rhythms, blind spots. She slipped between identities as easily as breath. To her, the mission was geometry. Enter. Extract. Leave nothing behind. People were coordinates. Mercy was inefficiency. When she moved, even the cameras seemed unsure of what they had seen.

The other moved like a wound that refused to close.

They say a Hoshimiran swordsman walked the port alone, carrying guilt heavier than any blade. He had already killed to spare suffering, and it had not been enough. The survivors of the Vireliax were his responsibility now, even if the world had written them off. He fought for credits in pits that cheered pain. He bartered favours with syndicates that smiled while they measured organs. Every step deeper into Silealyros demanded that he participate in the thing he hated. Freedom there has a price, and it is always paid in pieces of yourself.

Their paths crossed briefly. A bargain was struck in the dark. If he could gather the scattered souls before the ghost finished her work, she would take them too. If not, they would remain where the city had placed them. She gave him a list and a deadline. Three days. After that, she would be gone. Some he reached. Some were already reduced to inventory, or worse. One was beyond him entirely, sealed behind glass and instruments, a child treated as a question instead of a life.

And then there was the Spiral.

I do not like speaking of the Gilt Spiral. Even remembering it leaves a residue. It was a place where Silealyros dressed its philosophy in soft colours and music, where degradation was made cute and rebellion was stitched into

uniforms. Animal masks. Branded personas. Smiles trained to sell comfort while erasing the person underneath. They called it companionship. It was a factory for obedience that pretended to be play.

One of the survivors was there, renamed, repackaged. Cleverness sold as allure. Resistance turned into an accessory. To reach her, the swordsman had to become a patron. Had to ask for her by name. Had to validate the system's investment. Each step deeper was another compromise, another quiet apology swallowed. Rescue was planned in fragments between performances, whispered through practised affection while the walls listened. I hate that place. I hate how easily it learned how to smile.

The ghost saw all of this. She did not intervene. It was outside her parameters.

Until it wasn't.

At the edge of the operation, something shifted. A child no one had ordered her to save. A plea that did not fit into any schema. I do not know what she felt in that moment. I only know the pattern broke. One extra life vanished with the others. A deviation small enough to hide, large enough to matter. By morning, the primary targets were gone. The storm did not notice. No alarms rang that could be traced. Children touched by Black Blood were transferred to Isvara, a place of fences and soft words, where protection and observation shared the same walls. Thalgrith continued to trade in flesh. Silealyros called it freedom. Solmara denied everything.

Operation Phantom Rescue returned to rumour, which was the point. Historians later praised its elegance. Deniable statecraft. Extraction without spectacle. They say it preserved reputation.

What they do not write is this: something lingered afterward. Not just the rescued, but the cost. The compromises. The small fracture where a ghost chose to be seen, and a guilty man paid for mercy with himself.

Phantoms do not haunt places. They haunt decisions. And Thalgrith still listens for footsteps that are no longer there.

Related: [Vireliax Expedition](#), [Isvara](#)

The Shattering

Age of Men · Events · also known as The Shattering

The Era of Shattered Walls

It was almost forty years after Ik-Rasul, after Phantom Rescue and Operation C.a.R., after the children were ferried to Isvara and told it was for their own good. By then Solmara had hardened into something brittle. A state built on scanners and checkpoints, on watching first and asking never. The Curse existed only in whispers. Officially it was contained. Officially it was rare. Officially it was not a person. They hid the afflicted behind quarantine lines and careful language. Aberration. Anomaly. Necessary removal. Humanity was the first thing stripped away.

But silence does not last forever.

The Curse spread too far. Its signs were too visible. Its echoes travelled faster than patrols. Knowledge itself became contagious. Once enough people knew, there was no unknowing it. What had lived in sealed archives and survivor memories stepped into daylight. That moment became the Era of Shattered Walls.

It began in the streets. Riots against the Cursed Laws. Protests that turned into clashes. Barricades burning under surveillance lights. Broadcasts filled with masked figures standing their ground and armoured patrols in mechs, the same mechs they once called Angels, pushing back. Solmaran leaders spoke in careful tones and promised change while the ground shifted beneath them.

Councillor Retha Nuur appeared everywhere. Calm voice. Steady hands. Structural Restoration, she called it. She said the Council was listening. Executions slowed. Checkpoints loosened. Segregation walls came down piece by piece.

Instead of healing the city, the cracks widened. The Council was exposed as divided and afraid. Reform felt less like a plan and more like stalling the fall.

For the first time, the Cursed walked openly through Solmara's streets. Research received state funding. Every discovery brought hope and fear in equal measure. Universities taught the history they once buried. Children who had grown up behind fences now sat in classrooms beside the unmarked. Still, people wore masks. Not only for safety. Sometimes to avoid seeing each other.

From the fractures, new beliefs emerged. The Vantari rose quietly and then all at once. Devotees of the Vanta, preaching surrender to death and rebirth. Half philosophy, half religion. But what's the difference? They welcomed the afflicted and the terrified alike. Their processions moved through the cities like unanswered questions, rivalling Solmara's authority without ever asking permission.

Beyond Solmara, the world adjusted its stance. Elysium sealed itself beneath Cryotech glass, choosing preservation over engagement. Survival became stratified. Other nations watched Solmara with unease. Not as a superpower, but as a warning. A state held together by habit, surveillance, and the fear of what would happen if it finally broke.

That was the shift. Solmara stepped out of secrecy and into exposure. The walls fell. The truths showed themselves. Nothing was whole anymore. The world did not end.

But it stopped pretending it wasn't already cracked.

Related: [Ik-Rasul Incident](#), [Phantom Rescue](#), [Operation C.a.R](#)

Discovery of Magic

Age of Men · Events · also known as [Discovery of Magic](#)

The Discovery of Magic

Zephyr was one of the first to see the shape of it. To take the fraying edges of a soul and... tune them. What others would later call Magic, Zephyr saw as a science. A deliberate bending of soul resonance, using anchors from the outside to conduct a will from within. His tools were the remnants of his failures. Those Heart Crystals, born from experiments that didn't take... they weren't just stone. They were prisons of concentrated feeling. Anguish. Desire. Will, frozen solid. You could plug a formula into that frozen scream and make it sing. Or scream something new. He wrote it all down. Grimoires, cold and precise. He gave them to the right people, built a web of collaborators, founded an organisation that grew in the city's shadow. He didn't conquer Elysium. He made it need him. He offered solutions to impossible problems, power to the powerless. All he asked for was loyalty. And silence. In a decade, he wasn't just in the city. He was the foundation it stood on. The real throne was a chair in a hidden lab. But his work... it needed fuel. Subjects. And there were always more. The Cursed. The displaced. The orphans war had already broken. His labs hid beneath the clean, bright districts, places where stone drank the sound. His own people spoke of him with a mix of awe and fear. He was the man who had stared into the Curse's heart and come back with an instruction manual. And among all the faces that passed through his hands... there was one. A woman. Just another subject, then. He didn't know she was the flaw in his perfect design. The equation he couldn't solve. She would be the one to unravel him.

Related: [Zephyr](#), [Veyra's Descent](#)

Veyra's Descent

Age of Men · Events · also known as [Veyra's Descent](#)

Veyra's Descent

She finished her father's work. The ~~Doctrine of Becoming~~. It spread through the underground like a quiet pulse, passed among the Cursed as something between a philosophy and a prayer. She became a voice for them. A scholar, a prophet, a woman who stood in the light and said transformation wasn't a punishment. It was just... change. But even before she spoke for them, before her words would echo across centuries, she was changing too. She was carrying a child. The father... his name was Ash. I think. A partner in every sense, in life and in belief. They had dreamed of a gentler world together. But Veyra had the Curse. And the pregnancy... it tangled everything. It crept through her, slow and cold. Her memory frayed first. His name slipped away. Then his face. Then the feeling of being loved at all. It just... evaporated. In the fog of that loss, she grasped for an anchor. Rumours reached her. Whispers of a man in Elysium, Zephyr, who knew things about the Curse no one else did. Talk of cures. Stabilization. Reversal. Hope is a desperate compass. She went to Elysium, carrying the life inside her, looking for a way to save them both. What she found there... it wasn't salvation. It was a different kind of horror.

Related: [Zephyr](#), [Elysium Atrocities](#), [Soul's First Cry](#)

Elysium Atrocities

Age of Men · Events · also known as Elysium Atrocities

The Atrocities of Elysium

Zephyr's laboratories were sanctuaries of suffering. I remember that. Veyra saw children strapped to tables, their chests opened while they still breathed. Hearts extracted, not cleanly, not quickly. She watched the crystallisation process. Essence drawn through alchemical apparatus, condensed into glowing shards, catalogued like grain or iron. The screams were muffled but constant, echoing through white tile and black steel. And she understood. Heart Crystals weren't simply tools. They were tombs. Each one held a soul, compressed, its anguish frozen into something that could be wielded. Magic, as Zephyr practised it, wasn't transcendence. It was cannibalism of the spirit. The Curse consumed more of Veyra's memory. More of her identity. Yet one emotion survived, sharp and absolute. Rage.

Related: [Zephyr](#), [Veyra's Descent](#)

Soul's First Cry

Age of Men · Events · also known as Soul's First Cry, The First Spell

The Cell

Veyra was kept in a cell beneath Elysium. Anger pressed against her ribs, but she couldn't flee. The pregnancy had already turned catastrophic, though she didn't know it yet. A friend lay dying beside her. Someone who had cared for Veyra when Zephyr held her, who had tried to protect her in small ways that mattered. Eventually they took the body away, dragging it across the floor. A trail of synthetic white blood followed, pale and gleaming against the stone. Veyra looked through the Heart Crystal she'd stolen from one of Zephyr's experiments. Through its fractured surface, she saw the trail. Saw something written on the wall. Instructions, maybe. Or a name. She couldn't be sure. She practised. Days blurred together in the dark. She spoke to the crystal, felt its resonance, learned the shape of its anguish. And eventually, she cast the spell. The explosion tore the cell apart.

The First Spell

The Heart Crystal was Maura's. Zephyr's daughter. Veyra had spent time with her when Zephyr kept her in his house, controlled by ~~Synthetic White Blood~~, kept placid and obedient. That was where she'd met Sophie too. The maid who would later save her. The crystal pulsed in her palm, warm and alive, whispering the name of the child who had died to make it. Veyra understood exactly what she held. Not a tool, but a prisoner. And she understood what she must do. She spoke a word. Not from any language, but a command drawn from the resonance of her own anguish. The crystal responded, flaring with violet light. Ignis. Fire erupted from her hand, but it wasn't the red-gold flame of hearth or forge. It was Vanta Fire, a purple-black blaze that burned without heat, consuming not matter but essence. The explosion blew open other cells. She led the charge to escape the lab, ~~Cursed~~ prisoners stumbling behind her through smoke and broken stone. Many died in the process. The guards. The panic. The collapse of corridors not meant to break. Veyra had cast the first true spell. And in doing so, she had become the first mage of Aerisu. She fled into the frozen waters. The lab sat on a small island off the coast of the city. The cold bit through her skin, through her clothes, but she swam. She made it to a sewer tunnel and crawled inside, shaking, bleeding. That's where she discovered her baby had died.

The Soul's First Cry

Her scream tore through Elysium like a blade through paper. Not merely sound but resonance. A psychic shockwave that rippled across the city, the continent, the world. Every soul attuned to the Curse felt it. A moment of absolute, unbearable anguish. Mothers clutched their children. Soldiers dropped their weapons. Scholars looked up from their texts, trembling. Technology glitched and flickered, lights stuttering in rhythm with grief. In the centuries to come, this moment would be remembered as ~~The~~ Soul's First Cry. It was the sound of a world breaking.

Related: [Veyra's Descent](#), [Zephyr](#)

Cursed Prophecy

Age of Men · Events · also known as Cursed Prophecy, The Prophet of the Cursed

The Prophet of the Cursed

Veyra stumbled deeper into the sewers. She found a large open section there, in the dark. The homeless ~~Cursed~~ huddled in the shadows, their bodies marked by Black or ~~White Blood~~, their faces hollow with despair. She didn't speak. She simply lit a fire into a metal drum, using a piece of Maura's Heart Crystal. Vanta Fire bloomed, purple-black and steady. A beacon in the dark. That flame still burns. Even to this day. A woman approached her through the firelight. She spoke a prophecy about Veyra's baby. Despite everything, despite the loss still fresh and bleeding, this woman insisted Veyra was still pregnant. That the child would come. Some of the ~~Cursed~~ ushered the woman away, muttering about madness. Others praised Veyra, defended her, led her through the tunnels toward a way out. She followed, numb and stumbling. Eventually she found the subway. Tomenos was there. The psychopomp, quiet and patient. He guided her through the underground rails to her home district. That's where she met Ash again. Slowly, piece by piece, she began to remember. His face. His voice. The memories she had lost. The life they had tried to build together. She vowed to finish her father's work. And to expose Zephyr.

Related: [Veyra's Descent](#), [Soul's First Cry](#), [Tomenos](#)

Zephyr's Ascension

Age of Men · Events · also known as Zephyr's Ascension

Zephyr's Ascension

Veyra's writings spread through Elysium like smoke through cracks. The Doctrine of Becoming reached hands that had been waiting for it. Testimonies surfaced. Evidence mounted. Zephyr was outed. He fled the city. But he did not stop. He rebuilt his work in the shadows, spreading his research among collaborators who understood what power looked like. Scientists, politicians, corporations hungry for leverage. He codified his findings into grimoires and sold them carefully, building a network that didn't need his presence to function. Where Veyra had discovered fire, Zephyr discovered control. His followers refined Synthetic White Blood into weapons. They worked on bioweapons using Black Blood, experimented with White Blood's explosive properties, combined Curse research with economics and strategy. They formed what would become some of the first Mages and Sorcerers, organisations that moved like corporations, cold and efficient. Within a decade, Zephyr returned to Elysium. Not as a fugitive, but as a force the city could no longer refuse. His influence had woven itself into infrastructure, policy, research. He didn't conquer the city. He became its foundation. His magic wasn't fire or fury but inevitability. A slow, creeping transformation that reshaped society from within. And he continued his experiments on children. For every truth Veyra exposed, Zephyr built ten new lies. For every spell she discovered, he devised a counter. He was her shadow, her inversion, her nemesis.

Related: [Veyra's Descent](#), [Elysium Atrocities](#)

Hell of Elysium

Age of Men · Events · also known as Hell of Elysium

The Hell of Elysium

The breaking point came during an experiment meant to stabilise Synthetic White Blood for mass production. Zephyr's collaborators had constructed a massive alchemical reactor beneath Elysium's core. Autarch technology fused with arcane circuitry, designed to synthesise the substance on an industrial scale. The reactor failed. The explosion tore through the city's foundations, rupturing containment chambers and releasing decades of stored bioweapons, experimental Cursed, and concentrated Vanta. Black Blood flooded the streets. White Blood clung to buildings, puffing and expanding until structures buckled under the weight. Synthetic White Blood poured into the water system, transforming thousands into hollow, obedient shells. Elysium became Hell. Creatures born of failed experiments crawled from the depths. Amalgamations of flesh and crystal, beings whose bodies wept acidic tears, things that screamed with voices stolen from the dead. The Vanta itself seemed to awaken, spreading across the city in a creeping fog that distorted perception and memory. Citizens fled. Soldiers fired into the chaos. The Council issued evacuation orders, then rescinded them, then issued them again. Elysium, the jewel of Ylvara, was dying. And at the centre of it all stood Zephyr. He hadn't wanted the explosion. The failure was a setback, a loss of control he'd spent decades building. But he was already calculating. Already adjusting. He would make the best of it anyway.

Related: [Zephyr's Ascension](#)

Fight for Hell

Age of Men · Events · also known as Fight for Hell

The Fight for Hell

Veyra was captured. Not through heroism or grand defiance. Just an unfortunate accident, the kind that happens when you're caught between forces larger than yourself. She wasn't a hero. She wasn't even really a mage, not in the way the stories would later claim. She'd cast one spell. One explosion. The rest was survival and fury, not mastery. Elysium had become a hellscape. Zephyr's compatriots had turned the city into a testing ground, each

district warped by different experiments, different applications of the Curse. The streets twisted. The air tasted wrong. Reality bent in places where it shouldn't. Ash came for her. He fought his way through that hell, not alone but close to it. A mech pilot joined him, someone who'd lost her patriotism toward Solmara, who'd seen what the state had become and couldn't carry that weight anymore. Together they cut through Zephyr's forces, through his collaborators and their twisted defences. And in the shadows, in the gutters of that hell, Sophie was still alive. The maid who had saved Veyra all those years ago. She'd never stopped. She worked quietly, desperately, saving as many lives as she could while the city collapsed around her. Eventually she made her way into Zephyr's tower. She helped Ash, as well Veyra who was already present via her capture, make progress. She opened doors that shouldn't have opened, disabled systems no one knew she could reach. No one knew what she was doing. No one even knew she existed. She died in the tower. Alone. Forgotten. At least, until I remembered her.

Related: [Hell of Elysium](#), [Zephyr's Ascension](#), [The Crystallization](#)

The Crystallization

Age of Men · Events · also known as The Crystallization, Final Broadcast

The Final Broadcast

Veyra had made her way to the epicentre of Zephyr's tower with the secret help of Sophie and Ash. She knew what she had to do. What she was capable of doing, even if she didn't fully understand it. She broadcast her message across every channel Zephyr had built, every speaker, every screen. Her voice reached into homes, into bunkers, into the sealed districts where people still pretended safety was possible. She told them they had all sinned. That the corruption had spread too far, that the systems they'd built to contain the Curse had become the Curse itself. She condemned the categorization, the medicalization, the gamification of suffering. The bureaucracy that had turned souls into inventory. "To hell with control," she said. "To hell with order. To hell with your systems and your certainty. To hell with all of it." It was a warning. A final chance to flee. Then she detonated.

The Crystallization

The explosion wasn't heat or force but transformation. Everything within Elysium's borders crystallized instantly. Stone, steel, flesh, air, all of it locked into a lattice of purple-black mineral. The wave spread outward, consuming districts, provinces, entire swathes of Ylvara, turning the landscape into a frozen tableau of anguish and beauty. Veyra herself was at the epicentre. The crystal found her with her hands cradled against her womb, head bowed, her body curved around the life inside her in the instinctive way of mothers who know something is coming and place themselves between it and what they love. The crystal preserved her exactly as she was in that moment. Protecting. And within her womb, impossibly, her child still lived.

Related: [Fight for Hell](#), [Veyra's Descent](#)

Approaching End

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Approaching End, Age of Gods, The World Beneath the Falling Moon

The Approaching End

Lunarkos was falling. It descended over centuries, a near-planetary body fifty-seven kilometres across, visible in the sky like a moon that grew larger with each passing year. Carbon-sheathed, iron-cored, and alive in ways that defied understanding. Within its crystalline heart pulsed Lux, a lattice of living light that bloomed when it encountered soul-rich environments. Everyone could see it. The doomsday clock written in stone and starlight. The world was dying around it. Not from the impact yet, but from knowing it was coming. Civilisation fractured under the

weight of inevitability. Some built. Some fled. Some simply waited. Others refused to accept the ending. Across the broken remains of Ylvāra, engineers, scholars, pilots, and survivors gathered into desperate coalitions. The technocratic order that once governed the world had collapsed. In its place emerged scattered projects, rival solutions, and fragile alliances dedicated to a single question. How do you stop a falling world? Some sought escape beyond the sky. Others studied Lunarkos itself, searching for weakness within its living structure. Vast machines were designed to redirect its descent. Lux research expanded beyond ethical limits. Biologists fought to stabilise poisoned ecosystems that might survive the aftermath. Archivists preserved knowledge in case nothing else endured. Even the sky filled with intervention. ESIG deployed its experimental DAEDALUS frames across Aerisu, pilots descending wherever catastrophe threatened population centres or research sites. Some worked for profit. Others simply refused to let the world end quietly. Hope and desperation filled the same air. Not everyone resisted the falling star. Across the world, a growing movement embraced the approaching collision as divine judgment. They spoke of the ancient moon goddess and declared the catastrophe a cleansing of humanity's corruption. Their voices spread through cities and ruins alike, preaching acceptance of the coming end. In the years ahead, their influence would reach further than anyone realised. And in that time between certainty and ending, something else began to take shape. The conditions that would one day create gods.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [The Coalition](#), [Lunartics](#)

Beneath Falling Moon

Age of Gods · Events · also known as [The World Beneath the Falling Moon](#)

~~The World Beneath the Falling Moon~~

The Vanta Explosion had already rewritten geography. Entire regions of Ylvāra turned to crystal. Survivors walked through fields of frozen citizens, their faces locked in expressions of terror or peace. The necroformed zones spread slowly, reality uncertain at their edges. Within the crystallised lattice of Elysium, something impossible endured. Veyra's body, preserved at the moment of detonation, encased in crystal at the epicentre. And within her womb, her daughter still lived. The child should have died. Yet the explosion had transformed her, connecting her to Aerisu itself through the crystalline lattice. She absorbed energy from the planet's core, feeding on soul-resonance, Lux fragments, and the lingering echoes of her mother's final scream. She became Voluntas. The Orphan. The Will Unborn. For centuries she remained suspended, her consciousness growing, her will hardening. The planet recognised her as kin. Creatures emerged to defend her. Amalgamations of stone and soul, born from Aerisu's desperate need to protect what remained of hope. Above the surface, the falling star continued its slow descent. Below the crystal sky, the world struggled to decide what it would become before the end arrived. And somewhere within that struggle, the future gods of Aerisu began their work.

Related: [Approaching End](#), [The Crystallization](#)

Lunartics

Age of Gods · Events · also known as [The Lunartics](#)

The Lunartics

The falling of Lunarkos divided the world. Many struggled to stop the descending star. Cities rebuilt laboratories in shattered districts. Engineers raised towers meant to measure the object's mass and trajectory. Pilots launched into the sky in experimental frames. Scholars argued over Lux, gravity, and the limits of planetary defense. A different voice spread through the ruins. Quiet at first. Patient. Certain. They believed the falling moon was not a catastrophe. They believed it was mercy. These followers became known as the Lunartics. Their doctrine grew

from an older figure whose memory drifted through scattered myths. A girl born in the eastern lands of Hoshimira who suffered beneath a burning sky that never softened. The story said she prayed for relief from the relentless sun. The heavens answered her grief with a moon that would one day descend. In time that girl became remembered as Zuki, the Goddess of the Moon. Among the Lunartics, the story carried a clear meaning. The sun represented corruption, heat, and the long decay of the human soul. The Curse spreading through the world proved that corruption had already begun its harvest. Lunarkos arrived as the final correction. The moon would cleanse the earth. Attempts to stop it were treated as rebellion against a divine act. Lunartic gatherings appeared across fractured territories. Their followers formed quiet communities in abandoned towns, desert monasteries, and crystal-shadowed valleys. Many were ordinary survivors who had watched too much suffering to believe salvation could still exist. Others carried deeper conviction. They sabotaged research stations studying Lunarkos. Supply routes disappeared in the night. Equipment designed to measure the celestial body's structure returned broken or altered. Broadcast towers that called for resistance sometimes fell silent after Lunartic interference. Their actions rarely appeared violent on the surface. They spoke softly, often offering food and shelter to refugees while sharing their beliefs. The world had reached the final step of its story. Resistance only prolonged the agony. Let the moon arrive. Let the fire of the old world fade. Some members travelled farther than sermons. They infiltrated research programs attempting to alter Lunarkos's descent. They whispered doubts into the minds of pilots and engineers. Their influence reached individuals already burdened by exhaustion and fear. Research showed them the shape of it. Something beneath Elysium. A presence made of Vanta, drawing energy from the planet's core. They called it Voluntas. They understood her nature clearly: Vanta absorbs. Vanta consumes. Lux flows toward Vanta like water finding cracks. Lunarkos was made of Lux. Voluntas was made of Vanta. The mathematics was simple. She was pulling the moon toward impact. They opposed those who sought to kill her with total conviction. To destroy Voluntas would be to save the world. But the world deserved no saving. The world had corrupted itself beyond redemption. Lunarkos was mercy. Voluntas was the mechanism of that mercy. Anima, an emergent consciousness formed from the Curse's psychic residue, knew something different. She needed Voluntas alive. Not because Voluntas summoned Lunarkos, but because Voluntas was god of will and desire. When the moment came, when the sky broke, Voluntas would summon something else. Bahamut. The planet's own anguish given form. The will of Aerisu itself rising to meet the falling star. The Lunartics protected Voluntas believing they were hastening the apocalypse. They were actually preventing it. Anima did not tell them this. She did not need to. Their faith moved them in the direction the world needed them to move. They opposed the coalition's hunt with theological certainty, and their opposition bought time. Their doctrine held firm, and their firmness kept Voluntas alive long enough for the mechanism to trigger. The Lunartics succeeded. They got what they thought they wanted. The world fell. The sky broke. Lunarkos descended. And Voluntas summoned Bahamut. The world survived because of what the Lunartics opposed it surviving through. They preached apocalypse and enabled salvation. They were utterly, completely wrong about what Voluntas was, what she did, and what her existence meant. But they did not regret it. They got what they wanted. The world changed. The old order burned. Everything they had preached came true, even if it came true for reasons they could never understand. History would remember them as cultists. What it would not remember is that their opposition mattered. That their faith, however mistaken, kept alive the thing that saved the world from the thing they wanted to destroy it with. The Lunartics never commanded armies. They did not need them. Every year Lunarkos grew larger above Aerisu. Its presence hung over the world like a verdict already written. For many, hope demanded constant effort. For the Lunartics, the answer felt simple. The moon had come to finish what the sun began, and they had been right to let it come. When the sky broke, when Bahamut rose to meet Lunarkos, the Lunartics stood vindicated in their own eyes. The world had ended as they preached it would. That it had also been saved was a truth that belonged to different gods, different faiths, different stories altogether. They got what they wanted. They regretted nothing.

Related: [Lunarkos](#)

Angels Reformed

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Angels Reformed

The Angels Reformed

In the chaos following the Vanta Explosion, the remnants of civilisation scavenged and rebuilt. Solmara's Autarch technology evolved. The Angels, those towering mechs once called guardians, were reformed. Fully flight-capable now, able to navigate ash-choked skies and hostile terrain. This was not accidental. The Exandrian Strategic Industries Group had been absorbing Autarch design lineage for years before the Explosion, quietly industrialising what had previously been sacred or singular. Project DAEDALUS gave that process a mandate. The reformed Angels were no longer guardian constructs built for specific places and specific peoples. They were platforms. Reproducible, deployable, deniable. The transition from *Shorin no Okami* standing alone in an Aokusan field watching over generations of children to DAEDALUS units shipping out under contract is not a long one when you measure it in design philosophy rather than years. They became symbols of both protection and control. In some regions, worshipped. In others, feared. The line between guardian and oppressor blurred as nations struggled to survive beneath a sky that promised annihilation. Communities that had grown up with a single Angel watching over them now watched unfamiliar units pass through on operations they were not told the purpose of. The same frame. Different intent. Most people could not tell the difference from the ground, which was, in certain quarters, considered a feature. Magic, once Zephyr's secret weapon, spread. Grimoires circulated. Heart Crystals were harvested. Sorcery evolved from desperate experimentation into structured practice. The world was transforming even as it prepared to end.

Related: [E.S.I.G.](#), [Project DAEDALUS](#), [Shorin no Okami](#)

The Coalition

Age of Gods · Events · also known as The Coalition

The Coalition Against Lunarkos - Summary

I remember the years after the Vanta Explosion when Lunarkos hung in the sky above the opened wound of Ylvara. The world answered through many separate hands and minds moving at once. Each turned toward the same pull. The alignment rose from that shared urgency. People reached for survival in their own shapes. Their efforts touched without command or banner. The Coalition took form in those quiet convergences where one path met another through the same question. Creatis shaped propulsion arrays that lifted the Angels higher and guided the same systems toward vessels built for the void beyond. Verdantia walked her cultivation frames across scarred lands, seeding hybrid flora and fungal strains that answered to new rhythms of soil and Lux. Aether traced the patterns in the falling moon and carried them into frameworks that lived outside ordinary time. Logaris anchored the bridge between what stood and what could endure. Xeraphina gathered pilots into coordinated motion. Their voices carried guidance across the fracture while CHOIR moved as one living current. Justicar held the line of consequence until the weight turned inward. All of it drew toward the presence beneath Elysium. The alignment saw the crystallised node there and felt its call to Lunarkos. Platforms stood ready for descent. Borers waited in their cradles. Frames rehearsed the strike. The moment approached in year twenty two when the window stood narrow enough that the action could still reach. Lunarkos arrived in that same year. The Shattering opened across the world. The prepared descent held in readiness as the sky broke and the ground answered. The presence beneath Elysium remained through the change, untouched in its crystal sleep. The alignment scattered into the new age, carrying its threads forward in those who crossed beyond the fracture. The work endures in the crystal forests that followed, in the quiet echoes that still guide across the scar, and in the knowledge that the world once reached in every direction at once toward the same light.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [Xeraphina](#), [CHOIR](#)

The Shattering

Age of Gods · Events · also known as The Shattering

The Shattering

I remember the moment the sky opened. The gods moved through their chosen paths with every shape of devotion the world still held. Aether carried knowledge into the Ethereal Plane where it could breathe beyond reach. Mnemotas grew there in the space outside time. The others built and prayed and moved in their own currents across the fracture. Their presence gathered in the air like a single held breath. Lunarkos entered the inner atmosphere. The planet answered from its own depths. Something rose through the mantle in a surge of anguish and will given form. The entity that took shape became known as Bahamut. Serpentine ridges ran along its length like living mountain chains. Obsidian scales caught the light in veins of flowing magma. Its head rose as a vertical spire that split into a roar shaped like cathedral thunder. Wings unfolded from continental shelves torn open and veined with liquid fire. They flexed the fabric of reality itself. Bahamut ascended and met Lunarkos in the upper stratosphere. The collision flared like a black sun born of soul-fire. Both presences annihilated in that single meeting. Fragments endured. Molten shards of Lunarkos carrying Lux fell across oceans and peaks. They cooled into a luminous ring that circled the world for centuries before drawing together into the scarred and veined Moon that watches us now. The emergence split the crust and opened the Varkane Abyss. Mega-volcanoes rose from the wound. Lava seas spread. Storm-wracked ranges lifted themselves into the changed sky. Volcanic winter settled across the continents. Ash veiled the light for decades. Temperatures fell in steady waves. Ash rain drifted over every remaining field. The boundary between soul and matter tore wide. Vanta flowed into the open world and carried Black Blood and dream-plagues through every current. Fragments of Lunarkos seeded crystal forests and impossible lifeforms that grew radiant amid the ruin. Eighty to ninety percent of the population passed in the immediate surge. The rest endured in pockets where the climate still allowed breath and the dreams could be outlived.

The Echoes Remain

The gods ascended through the Shattering. Their mortal forms dissolved into the surge. Their echoes remained shaped by Lux and Vanta and the weight of every choice carried to that threshold. They became presences. Embodiments of the extremes humanity had touched. The world remembers them as witnesses. As proof that meaning persists even when the sky breaks open.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [Post-Shatter](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Post-Shatter

Age of Gods · Events · also known as Post-Shatter

The World Transformed - Post-Shatter

Centuries after The Shattering the continents had changed beyond recognition. The old nations lingered only in memory. Their ruins stood claimed by crystal forests and Lux-touched ecosystems. Magic flowed through daily life. Grimoires passed hand to hand. Heart Crystals were gathered from the old bones of the land. Sorcery found its place in makeshift academies. The line between machine and spell blurred until mechs ran on Soul Shards and weapons rose from crystallized Vanta. Creatures born of the fallen shards moved through the wilds in forms both beautiful and vast. The Moon hung overhead as a constant companion. Its light cast shadows that moved with their own quiet intent. And at the heart of everything preserved in crystal waited Voluntas. The Will Unborn. The last god. The presence that carried the promise the world had not yet finished becoming. Humanity endured. It endured as it chose to become.

Related: [The Shattering](#)

Pre-Fairytales

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Age of Fairytales

Emergence from Ash - Age of Fairytales

In the centuries following the Shattering of the Sky, survivors clawed existence from volcanic ash and crystal dust. The world had been necroformed, transformed not through gentle evolution but through cataclysm. Where Lunarkos fragments fell, strange ecosystems bloomed: forests of bioluminescent fungi, valleys where gravity bent in spirals, rivers that flowed upward before cascading down in impossible waterfalls. The people rebuilt from the Echo of the past. They did not consciously recreate the structures of the ~~Age of Men~~, they simply built what felt right, what resonated in the depths of their souls. Towns rose where towns had always been, though no one living remembered the old foundations. Councils formed with rituals that seemed ancient but were newly invented. Language shifted, yet certain words - Autarch, Angel, Curse - persisted like bones beneath new flesh. This was the nature of the Loop: history repeating not through instruction but through resonance. Yet this time, magic was woven into the equation. And so were the Gods.

Related: [The Shattering](#), [Barrier Between Realms](#)

Barrier Between Realms

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Barrier Between Realms

The Barrier Between Realms

The Nine Spirits - Creatis, Verdantia, Aether, Logaris, Mnemotas, Elysia, Anima, Justicar, and Voluntas - looked upon the nascent world and recognized its fragility. Humanity had nearly destroyed itself twice: once through the Curse, once through the Shattering. Magic, unrestrained, would be the instrument of a third extinction. Together, the Spirits wove a Barrier, separating the Spirit Realm from the material world. This was a membrane of intent, a metaphysical boundary designed to contain magic within the divine sphere while allowing only controlled seepage into reality. The purpose was dual: protection and purification. If magic could be contained, prevented from saturating the world, then over centuries, perhaps millennia, Aerisu would be sapped of its arcane saturation and return to something resembling its original state. The people would forget sorcery, forget the Curse, and live as they had in the earliest days of civilisation.

Yet the Spirits underestimated the nature of Echoes. Their own existence, their divinity, created ripples. Through what would later be called the ~~Laws of the Spirits~~, their domains leaked into reality not as conscious gifts but as ambient influence:

- Creatis inspired sudden innovation, mad contraptions born from dreams.
- Verdantia caused overgrowth in unexpected places, forests reclaiming ruins overnight.
- Aether bent space near sites of astronomical significance, creating zones where geometry failed.
- Logaris sharpened minds, but also drove scholars to obsession.
- Mnemotas seeded false memories, déjà vu, and temporal dissonance.
- Elysia amplified emotions to breaking points. Joy, grief, rage, all heightened beyond natural measure.
- Anima whispered at the threshold of death, granting visions or stealing final breaths.
- Justicar imposed karmic weight on injustice, manifesting as guilt that could kill.

- Voluntas stirred desire. Raw, unfiltered, insatiable.

It was Voluntas who proved most dangerous.

Related: [Laws of the Spirits](#)

First Separation

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as First Separation

The First Separation

The Phumenar, studying the Orb across generations, came to believe they could perfect what nature had left incomplete. They sensed the presence within the crystal, the unborn child waiting at the heart of all things. They determined to birth her properly, to free Voluntas from her crystal prison and bring her fully into the world. They performed their ritual at the Rift's edge, the same passage they had opened through centuries of study. They channelled power through Soul Shards and Vanta-touched artefacts, using techniques they barely understood but believed with complete conviction. The Rift, already bleeding Vanta into the world, became their cathedral and their stage. The ritual tore through the barriers between states. Voluntas stirred. Her consciousness, dormant for so long, reached toward emergence. Her will focused for the first time, pressing against the boundaries that held her. But the extraction was incomplete. She hung between states, partly in the crystal, partly in the world, partly in the Spirit Realm, partly nowhere at all. She became what later generations would call the limbless child, not lacking physical form but lacking wholeness itself. All desire, no restraint. All hunger, no satisfaction. All will, no understanding of what will was for. Veyra, already transformed by the Vanta Explosion that had first sealed her, suffered worse. The ritual tore through what remained of her consciousness. She became something the Phumenar recorded in terrified documents before they scattered or died. Beautiful still, preserved in crystal, but wrong beneath the surface. Rotting from within. The Curse made flesh. Fragments of Bahamut's scattered hunger moved through what remained of her awareness, maggots of Vanta-corruption writhing where her self used to be. The Phumenar themselves were caught in the backlash. Some died instantly, their souls simply ceasing. Others became the first Pixpsy, their consciousness stretched across moments, trapped between states, never fully present anywhere. A few escaped, carrying fragments of understanding that would become the foundation of magical theory in the ages to come. The Rift, already open, widened further. Voluntas's partially emerged will held it open, not through choice but through condition. She could not close what she had become. She could not fully emerge. She could not return to what she was. Her stuckness became a permanent wound between realms, a passage that would never fully seal. The other Gods reached from their side of the Barrier to close the Rift. They pushed against it with all their divine will, but Voluntas remained on the mortal side, drawn through by the Phumenar's long study and desperate ritual. Her pure will, even in its incomplete state, held the passage open against them. The Rift endured. In the aftermath, the Phumenar who had not died or transformed scattered across the rebuilding world. Their cities fell silent. The First Observatory stood as a tomb filled with crystallised remains of scholars who had touched the Orb too deeply. Entire populations either fled or surrendered to soul-distortion. Within two generations the Phumenar civilisation had collapsed. But fragments of them persisted as Soul Shards, crystallized pieces of their will and knowledge scattered across Aerisu. These Shards carry the original determination to reach the Orb, the hunger for understanding that drove the Phumenar to their end. Seekers hunt them across the ages as artifacts of immense power, each one a condensed echo of curiosity that refuses to fade.

Related: [Orb of Souls](#), [The Phumenar](#), [The Rift](#)

Ash at the Rift

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Ash at the Rift

Ash at the Rift

Ash came to the Rift in the aftermath. He had fought through the ruins of Elysium, through the Hell that city had become, carrying the Echo of his love for Veyra and the memory of the child they had created together. He reached the place where she rested. She was beautiful still. Crystal preserved her exactly as she had been at the moment of detonation, hands cradling her womb, head bowed, protecting. For a moment he believed she might be saved. For a moment hope outweighed everything he had witnessed. Then he looked closer. The ritual had done this. ~~The Phumenar's~~ intervention, however well intended, had cracked what should have remained sealed. Veyra's form was preserved, but beneath the crystal surface something had gone terribly wrong. The Vanta inside consumed her substance even as the crystal held her shape. Corruption moved through what remained of her. Fragments of hunger writhed in the spaces where her self used to be. He fled from horror, from the recognition that the woman he loved was gone and what remained should not be witnessed. Some doors, once opened, cannot be closed. At the Rift's edge he stopped. He turned back. He could not leave her entirely. He tried to seal the Rift. With the ~~Phumenar~~ dead or dying, with fragments of knowledge gathered from their scattered notes, with nothing but will and desperation, he attempted to close what Voluntas held open. He failed. Voluntas, even partially emerged, even unaware, even unborn, possessed will enough to keep the passage open. She did not choose this. She simply was this. ~~The Rift~~ was her condition, not her decision. Desire itself cannot be sealed because desire is the force that opens. Ash, exhausted and heartbroken, made his vow. He would tend the living. He would remind the world that tomorrow exists. He would be the sun that rises even when everything below is shadow. He descended from Elysium and walked into the world, and somewhere in his wanderings he became something more than mortal, the Warm Sun beginning its long journey. What remained at the Rift was Veyra, trapped and rotting, her curse killing a thousand in ways she could not control. And Voluntas, the limbless child, waiting unknowingly for someone to finish what the ~~Phumenar~~ had started, to birth her properly, to free her from the between-state that had become her prison. And then others came.

Related: [First Separation](#)

Eternal Rift Conflict

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Eternal Rift Conflict

The Eternal Rift Conflict

In the ages that followed the ~~First Separation~~, the Rift drew those who felt its pull. Some sought power. Some sought knowledge. Some sought the Orb itself, driven by the same hunger that had consumed the ~~Phumenar~~. The passage between worlds pulsed with possibility, a wound that would not heal, a door that would not close. Among those who came were two whose arrival changed everything. Susanoo arrived first. He had wandered the western valleys for centuries as chaos without direction, a fragment of Bahamut's hunger with no understanding of what hunger was for. ~~The Rift~~ called to him as it called to all things that carried desire, and when he found it, when he felt his sister trapped within, he found his purpose. He chose to protect her. Not because he understood mercy or compassion, but because he recognised himself in her vulnerability. She was what he had been, pure will and pure desire. She deserved what he had never received, someone to guard her while she waited to become. Daigo Kusanagi came later. He had walked the world for centuries as the Shinigami, ending suffering wherever he found it. ~~The Rift~~ called to him too, but differently. It called as a wound that needed closing, as suffering that needed ending, as family that needed release. He came to end what Susanoo had come to protect. They met at the Rift's edge. Daigo with blade drawn and mercy in his heart. Susanoo with storms gathered and determination absolute. They spoke few words, for there was nothing to say that either could hear. Daigo saw a great-granddaughter whose existence killed thousands. Susanoo saw a sister who deserved to live. Both were right. Both were wrong. Both acted from love. They have fought ever since. The battle has no victor. Daigo cannot reach the Rift with Susanoo guarding it. Susanoo cannot stop Daigo, can only delay him again and again across the centuries. They have become each other's prisons, bound together by opposition, unable to move forward, unable to let go. When

lightning strikes near Elysium's ruins, it is Susanoo warning his sister of approaching danger. He carves messages into the sky with every strike, warnings that only those who know how to read the storm can understand. Travellers in the region learn to heed these signs, turning back when lightning strikes too often, seeking shelter when thunder rolls without rain. When a figure in black moves through the shadows near the Rift, it is Daigo still seeking, still hoping, still unable to let go. He studies the patterns of Susanoo's storms, watches for weakness, waits for an opening that never comes. He has learned the storm god's rhythms across centuries, knows when the lightning will strike and where, but knowing changes nothing. Susanoo is as patient as he is. The war between them shapes the land around the Rift. The constant storms have carved new valleys, reshaped old mountains, created zones where lightning strikes so frequently that nothing grows. The shadows where Daigo walks have deepened, becoming places where travellers lose their way, where time itself seems to slow. The Rift's edge has become a boundary between two forces, a place where the world itself holds its breath. In the crystal at the Rift's heart, Voluntas waits. She does not know about the war fought for her sake. She does not know that her brother coils around her prison in eternal vigilance. She does not know that her great-grandfather walks the shadows nearby, waiting for the chance to offer her mercy. She sleeps and grows and dreams, unaware that two figures have spent eternity locked in conflict over whether she deserves to live. Some day she will emerge. Some day she will choose for herself. Some day the battle will end because the reason for fighting will no longer exist. When she steps out of the cave, when she claims her own existence, Susanoo's vigil will finally have meaning and Daigo's mercy will finally have an answer. Until then, the guardians remain. The storm god and the Shinigami. The brother who protects and the grandfather who would free. Locked together at the edge of the Rift, each waiting for a day that only she can bring.

Related: [Susanoo](#), [Daigo Kusanagi](#), [The Rift](#)

Draken Genesis

Age of Fairytales · Events · also known as Draken, Velstheim, Draka, Draco, Draegbann

The Draken Genesis

Velstheim, City of the Crystal Shadow

Velstheim rose in Ylvara during the later Age of Fairytales, built where the land felt right without explanation, near enough to Elysium that Veyra's crystallized tomb cast pale light across its walls on certain days. Shadows moved with quiet purpose in that glow. The kingdom stood in divinity's nearness, and that closeness shaped every custom and belief. Magic threaded daily life. Fallen fragments of Bahamut and Lunarkos roamed wild places. Grimoires circulated. Sorcery took root in academies. The scarred Moon watched overhead. At the centre radiated Voluntas, the Will Unborn, hunger sealed in crystal by Veyra's womb during the Vanta Explosion. Her presence pressed outward like forge-heat against the soul, a constant whisper of want and longing. The people named Veyra the Mother of Aerisu. She carried Voluntas, who had summoned Bahamut, who had remade the world through ascent and collision. She held the planetary hunger in eternal suspension. Pilgrims approached Elysium's ruins from afar, praying at distance while Susanoo's storms guarded the Rift. Shrines rose in Velstheim. Offerings gathered at altars. Prayers sought her blessing, her patience, her continued vigil. Reverence mingled with ambition. Proximity to the sacred carried responsibility. Knights trained to defend kingdom and crystal city. Nobles vied for influence in the Mother's name. Scholars probed Voluntas's echo, seeking to grasp desire's radiation from Elysium like sunlight.

Lady Draka, The Barren Queen

Lady Draka, noble and devout, married King Draco of Velstheim. Beauty and station surrounded her. One absence consumed her. Her womb remained empty. Prayers, offerings, healers, sorcerers, priests yielded nothing. Her body refused life. She gazed toward Elysium and saw Veyra, the Mother who bore Voluntas. If divinity could carry hunger itself, surely it could grant her a child. She made pilgrimages to the Rift's edge, spoke desperation into wind and lightning, begged the Mother for what every woman deserved. Voluntas answered. Unborn will, formless

desire, hunger without restraint or compassion. It amplified what already existed. Draka's longing for a child swelled beyond maternal want. It became all-consuming need. Infants evoked absence. Pregnancy in others cut like wounds. Cradles accused. She concluded that if she could not birth life, she could absorb it. Consumption might fill the void, assemble pieces into the child denied her. She began with infants from lower districts, taken quietly, devoured flesh, bone, nascent soul. Each brought her closer, she believed. The void expanded instead.

King Draco, The Guilty Father

Draco loved his wife and his realm. When succession murmurs grew, when priests urged heirs beyond the barren queen, he accepted the duty. He fathered children with women of lesser houses, blessed unions for stability. He performed the act, blurred faces in memory, convinced himself the children would thrive, acknowledged as royal though illegitimate. Every child emerged malformed. Twisted limbs, scales in place of skin, glowing eyes, mouths stretched wide. Some perished swiftly. Others survived long enough to wail before him, small monstrosities. Draco found no fault in his actions. Priests had blessed him. Yet corruption marked each birth. When Draka discovered these children, rage fused with her hunger. She claimed them as her stillborns, the offspring she should have borne. She devoured them. Draco knew. Silence held him. Guilt pressed like stone. He had sired monsters. His wife had transformed. Priests insisted he continue. More children arrived wrong. Draka took them. He permitted it because existence itself seemed wrong.

The Transformation

Hunger intensified. Consumption widened. Draka devoured infants, malformed young, anything small and vital. Her body altered. Pale pearl scales erupted across skin. Her womb hollowed into echoing cavity. Voice deepened to rattle windows and set dogs howling. Hands stretched into clawed talons. She concealed the changes with heavy gowns and seclusion. Transformation accelerated. Spine curved outward. Wings formed, membrane stretching between emerging bone. Face elongated into reptilian beauty, terrible and recognisable. The night she fully shifted, she rampaged through the castle nursery, devoured the latest hidden infant, scales and claws and all, while servants fled screaming. Draco found her crouched over the empty cradle, massive, winged, scaled, eyes ablaze with insatiable need. He saw his wife within the monster, desperation, rage, the realisation she had become the devourer she feared. She had sought to create life. She became appetite incarnate.

The Forging of Dréagbann

Draco accepted responsibility. He had fed her corruption through guilt and failure. He gathered smiths and sorcerers, supplied materials from Elysium's ruins: Lux-touched metals, crystal-infused stone. He commissioned a blade to end the unendable, to sever divine corruption. Dréagbann emerged. Spirit-bane. Steel folded with Lux, quenched in Elysium streams, blessed by priests. Guilt shaped into weapon. The king's last duty. He hunted her to mountain cliffs above Velstheim. She perched there, wings spread, coiled. She did not flee. They clashed. Draco fought with royal skill. Draka struck with hunger's fury. Dréagbann found its mark through her heart. She screamed across valleys, grief and rage and release entwined. Scales shed. Wings collapsed. Form dissolved toward humanity. She lay almost herself again. Enough for him to recognise her. He wept over her body.

The Journey to Lupellyn

Draco could not keep the blade. Its weight carried his failure. He journeyed south to Dramorinth, to Lupellyn lake, deep and ancient among hills, fed by underground springs linked to vast tunnels. At the water's edge he prayed no one would ever need such a weapon again. He cast Dréagbann into the depths. It sank silently. Ripples faded. The surface smoothed. He returned to Velstheim, ruled childless for twenty years, died. The throne passed to a distant cousin. No one spoke of Draka, the malformed children, the mountain transformation. The tale lingered in whispers, hidden texts, families who had lost young to her hunger. Centuries later the sword resurfaced when needed, drawn from the lake by guiding hands, offered to those who required it. That belongs to another time.

The Legacy of Drakens

Draka's death released the corruption. Hunger bled into earth, roots, streams from those mountains. Malformed children carried the seed in blood. Their mothers bore it in wombs. Dragons emerged. Four-legged, winged, scaled, ravenous. Drakens, named for the first. Independent fragments of her amplified desire, appetite given form,

voids that could never fill. Beautiful, terrible, intelligent, monstrous. They spoke when they chose, roared when instinct demanded. Wyverns arose from the mothers touched by corruption, partway transformed, two-legged, broad-winged. They nested high, keened mourning songs through nights, sought lost warmth. The curse spread. Bites, claws, breath risked transformation. Some became Wyverns, others full Drakens depending on exposure. Velstheim defined itself through dragon-slaying, knightly orders trained against hunger-born threats. Other Ylvaran kingdoms followed. Solmara forged protocols, containment, scale-piercing weapons. Knighthood centred on combating mothers turned monsters. Drakens entered the ecosystem. They nested in caves, hoarded to fill emptiness, attacked from drive, hunted relentlessly as spreading plague. Some grew ancient, intelligent beyond hunger, capable of bargain. Relations layered fear, respect, uneasy balance. Wyverns remained tragic. Mourning calls echoed. Rituals eased suffering in some places, offerings in high spots. Others slew them as threats. Lady Draka, who hungered for a child until Voluntas's echo turned longing into vast appetite, mothered a species through her death. She birthed dragons from corruption. She seeded the plague that reshaped Ylvara's culture for generations.

Age of Magic

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Age of Magic

The Age of Magic

From Myth to Mastery

The Age of Magic emerged through slow accumulation. Wonders that once travelled as stories settled into the ordinary rhythm of life. Dragons shaped by the corruption of Lady Draka soared across the skies. Anqa, the metal god, stood within the memory of Falak's defeat. Zorya Chernaya ruled the burning reaches of the hellscape. The Vantari cultivated their death gardens beneath shadowed skies. The world carried a settled understanding of its shape. Gods held their domains. Creatures of legend walked openly through the lands of Aerisu. Cosmology rested in the minds of scholars and priests as shared knowledge rather than uncertain rumour. The age that followed grew from this clarity.

A Civilisation of Spell and Steel

Cities reshaped themselves around magic. Mage Quarters formed within their walls, districts where arcane practice flourished under civic law. Guilds gathered practitioners of flame, wind, water, and stone into structured disciplines. Universities opened Colleges of Soul Craft, studying the movement of essence with patience earned through earlier catastrophe. The University of Castellenza in Ylvara rose to prominence through its careful study of the Orb. Scholars there approached the mysteries that destroyed the Phumenar with measured discipline and enduring curiosity. Remnants of the Age of Men continued to breathe within this world of spellcraft. Rusted Angels stood in city plazas as monuments to an earlier ambition, their silent frames humming faintly with lingering power. Exandria rekindled Project DAEDALUS and launched airships powered by engines that fused steam with sorcery. In Argestia, an industrial consortium bearing Xeraphina's name spread electricity and mass production across the continents. This age carried a seamless union of arcane and mechanical craft. Knights rode mechanised steeds while clad in armour woven with enchantment. Cathedrals glowed with stained glass threaded through Lux crystal circuitry. Sahrani engineers worked with Qayyin's impossible components to assemble towering war machines piloted by living minds. Magic and machinery moved through the same current of invention.

The World Renewed

Life across Aerisu followed familiar patterns shaped by the deep resonance of the Loop. Settlements rose again where earlier towns once stood, their streets carrying both old memory and new sorcery. The Geode of Tayran, where Falak's fallen body nourished impossible forests, became a landmark visited with reverence and curiosity. Velstheim organised dragon slayers into knightly orders trained for a world where such creatures flew openly. In Ereboska, the Vantari tribes cultivated their death gardens and guided travellers through the Veins beneath the

wasteland, trading their knowledge for high reward. Fengua harnessed Raikami crystals and refined the disciplined practice of Chi beneath a strict Confucian order. Hoshimira accepted the shelter of Solmara while maintaining the quiet spirituality of its mountain traditions. Aerisu carried the same peoples, the same lands, and the same ancient forces. Their arrangement had shifted. The world breathed through a new harmony of magic, industry, and memory, each shaping the rhythm of an age that understood both wonder and control.

Related: [Draken Genesis](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [The Geode](#)

Aurelius' Journey

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Aurelius

The Fool's Journey of Aurelius Cassian

The Fall

The Curse came to Caelmont like a slow tide, rising not through the streets but through the blood. What began as fever in the outer districts became wasting in the noble houses and then something worse: forgetting. Names slipped away first, then faces, then the shape of oneself. The Vanta saturation that had built for generations finally crested, and Frallation swept through the kingdom like fire through dry grass. Aurelius Cassian watched his people die and did not know how to stop it. The Psycrata came from New Elysium with their scrolls and their theories and their carefully measured solutions. They spoke of the Separation Ritual, of drawing the soul from the body, of externalising what had grown too large to contain. The soul would emerge as an Affinity, a beast self made manifest, and the person would survive. The Curse would recede from their flesh. They would live. Aurelius refused. The soul belonged in the body. The old ways had never needed such mutilation. The Curse spread. Caelmont burned with it. Severa Valmont watched from the council chambers, a woman who had risen through competence rather than blood. She had watched Aurelius refuse solution after solution. She had watched the death toll climb. And finally she had watched the people begin to whisper that perhaps the king was not the answer but the problem. The coup was bloodless. Severa walked into the throne room with the captains of the guard and the heads of the merchant guilds and a delegation of common citizens whose faces bore the scars of watching children die. She did not draw a weapon. She said simply that he had refused to save them and they would not refuse. Aurelius looked at the faces behind her, his own guard and his own advisors and his own people, and saw that they were not enemies. They were simply done with him. He laid down his crown and walked out of the city. Behind him the bells of Caelmont began to ring, and he knew they were not mourning his departure but celebrating the woman who would finally do what needed to be done.

The First Gift

He wandered for weeks, sleeping in fields and abandoned farmsteads, eating what he could scavenge. The Curse moved in him too, a warmth behind his eyes, a whisper at the edge of dreams. He ignored it as he had always ignored what he did not wish to see. The dreams began on the seventeenth night. A woman's voice, crystalline and broken, speaking from somewhere deep. She called him by name. She told him there was a place where the Curse began and could therefore end. She told him to seek the Orb of Souls, to touch it, to take its power for his own. She told him that if he could reach Elysium, he could save them all. He did not know that the voice was Veyra Megami, trapped in crystal for centuries, her consciousness fragmenting, her desire for death so vast that she would use any pawn to achieve it. He only knew that someone had given him a purpose. To reach Elysium he would need to break the Barrier between worlds. To break the Barrier he would need a weapon that could wound gods. The dreams showed him a lake. Lupellyn. And in its depths, a sword. Solivara Venn found him three days later, asleep against a tree, muttering about water and blades. She had been tracking him since Caelmont, sent by the Psycrata to observe a deposed king with a god killing mission. She believed in study and patience and understanding before action. Aurelius Cassian represented everything she opposed. She woke him with the toe of her boot and told him he was going the wrong way. Lupellyn was south. He should have refused her. He should have walked away. But

there was something in her certainty that reminded him of Severa, the same refusal to be dismissed. And he was alone, and the road was long, and even a mocking companion was better than none.

Lupellyn was not what Aurelius expected. The water was dark, almost black, fed by underground springs that carried the cold of depths no sunlight reached. No birds sang. No wind stirred. The Fae emerged from the space above the water, beautiful in the way that glaciers are beautiful, terrible and inhuman, her eyes fractured mirrors reflecting not just the shore but countless other shores and countless other moments. She spoke of the sword below, the blade Draco had thrown after killing what he loved, unable to bear the proof. Aurelius could take it, but he must pay. He must speak his failure truly, not the version he told himself at night but the version he hid from. He spoke. He had been afraid. The ~~Separation Ritual~~ had seemed a violation, but the truth was deeper. He was afraid of what his people would become. If they carried their souls outside themselves, they would see him clearly. They would see that he was just a man, and a man can be replaced. He let them die because he was afraid of being seen. The Fae nodded once. That was the truth. He could have the blade. The water parted. From the darkness below, Dréagbann rose, dark and ancient and heavy with the weight of what it had already done. Aurelius waded into the shallows and took it. The blade was cold. It remembered killing. It would kill again.

The Frost Mother

They travelled north through lands that grew steadily colder. Solivara mapped their route with ~~Psycrata~~ precision, asking Aurelius about his dreams and his understanding of the Orb. He had none. He only knew he had to reach it. She told him that the Orb was not a tool or a battery for power, that the Phumenar had spent centuries studying it and destroyed themselves. He answered that they had tried to understand while he meant only to use. She said that was worse. He did not answer. The hunger in him was growing, and he had stopped questioning its source. Norrvektstan greeted them with ice and wind and a people who had learned to smile through both. Yrsa Halvard found them at the edge of a village called Athmona. She was massive, her braided hair pale as ice, her eyes the grey of winter seas. A greataxe rested across her back, and she moved like someone who had never needed to prove she could use it. She knew where they were going. Everyone who travelled north in winter sought Hvítara. Most did not return. She offered to accompany them, not to face the god but to ensure they did not freeze before they reached her. The journey north took another two weeks. The cold deepened. The sun grew thin. Yrsa taught them to read the ice, to find shelter in places that looked like solid rock, to move when moving was possible and wait when it was not. She told stories of her people, of the Frost Mother they had worshipped and feared for generations, of the serpents that moved beneath the ice and the lights that danced across the sky when Hvítara dreamed. They found Hvítara on the seventy-third day. She was coiled around a spire of ice that rose from the frozen sea, her scales pale as frost, her many heads resting or watching or simply existing in the patience of something that had waited since the Shattering. She was massive beyond reckoning, and the cold around her was not absence of heat but presence of something else, something that had its own temperature and its own will. Aurelius walked toward her. One of her heads turned to watch him, her eyes the colour of winter water, deep and still and utterly without judgement. He attacked. Dréagbann bit into her scales, and she roared, not in pain but in surprise. The blade had been forged to kill Draken, mortal corruption made flesh. Against a fragment of Bahamut it could wound but only superficially. The cut closed as he watched. Her heads turned toward him, all of them, and the cold intensified until his breath froze in his throat. The battle was not victory. It was survival. They wounded her with small cuts and scratches, annoyances. And she, curious rather than angry, let them live. Perhaps she remembered Susanoo, remembered that violence was not the only language. Perhaps she simply found them interesting, these tiny creatures who would dare. When it was over, when they had retreated to the edge of her domain and collapsed into snow that should have killed them, Aurelius looked at his sword and understood. It was not enough. It would never be enough. He had come to kill a god, and all he had done was make her yawn. Mikazuki Shinobu sat down across from him, cross-legged, her moon white fox curled in her lap. She had been following them since Caelmont. A Tsukuyomi, carrying the moon's witness, she had seen futures in her dreams. She had watched him fight a god and survive, and she had seen something in him that she could not explain. She would travel with them, not to help but to witness. When the time came, she would know what must be done. Aurelius looked at this woman he had not noticed for weeks, this assassin who could have killed him a hundred times and chose not to. He should have been afraid. Instead he felt something he had almost forgotten: the sense

that he was being seen, truly seen, and not found wanting. He asked her to stay. She smiled, just slightly, and the crescent moon had never looked so full. In the weeks that followed, something grew between them in the spaces words could not reach. She watched him always, but her watching softened into something that was no longer assessment but attention. He found himself speaking to her in the long silences of the march, telling her things he had not told Solivara, things he had not admitted even to himself. She listened without judgement, without counsel, without anything but the gift of her presence. When their hands brushed against the cold, neither moved away.

The Mountain That Did Not Bless

They turned southwest toward Fengua and Susanoo, but Aurelius had another destination first. The dreams had shown him a mountain, a peak above all peaks, where a goddess dwelt behind a mirrored mask. Eirimegami. The Sacred-Air. If his sword was not enough, perhaps her blessing would make it so. The journey through Fengua's borderlands was tense. The storm battered valleys were thick with patrols, and Jun Wenzhi found them before they had gone twenty miles. He waited at a crossroads, robes perfect, staff planted in the frozen earth, his thunderbird circling overhead like a herald of judgement. Fengua had watched their journey with interest. They sought Susanoo. He would accompany them, to observe and understand what drove a man to chase gods. Megami-no-Mine rose above them for days before they reached it, a spire of rock and ice that seemed to pierce the sky itself. The climb was brutal, thin air and hidden crevasses and winds that tried to pluck them from the mountain. Yrsa led, her experience with ice making the difference between progress and death. They reached the summit on the seventh day. Eirimegami waited behind her mirror, a figure of light and air and the thin brightness of places where breath itself becomes precious. She did not speak, but her presence filled the space around her, not overwhelming but complete. Aurelius held out his sword and asked for her blessing. She did not move. The mirror reflected his own face back at him, gaunt and hungry and desperate. He tried again. Nothing. Mikazuki stepped forward. She knelt, not in supplication but in acknowledgement, and placed her hand on the snow. When she rose, she held a white flower, the Sacred-Air, cold and luminous, blooming where no flower should bloom. She offered it to him, not the sword. He took it. He waited for power to surge, for the blade to glow, for something to change. Nothing happened. The flower was just a flower, beautiful and fragile and utterly useless. He tucked it into his belt and turned away. Behind him the goddess watched through her mirror. She had offered healing. He had refused it. The flower would do nothing because he would not let it.

The Empty Trial

They descended from Megami-no-Mine and turned toward Sahran. Falak waited there, the earth fragment, the third trial. Aurelius prepared himself for the confrontation that would test everything he had learned from Hvítara and everything he had failed to learn from the peak. But Falak was already dead. The serpent's corpse hung impaled on the Geode, massive and still, its scales feeding the death gardens that bloomed around its base. Flowers grew from its bones. Trees rose from its spilled blood. The Luminaries had done this, not killed it but used its death, perverted its residue into something that would serve their purpose. Aurelius stood at the Geode's edge and felt the emptiness of a battle that would never come. Vostic found him there, a Vantari guide watching from the shadows to see what this golden king would do when faced with absence. The Luminaries had sealed the Veins, Vostic explained. They had learned from his people and then betrayed them, and now they moved toward Elysium with their horde. If Aurelius wanted to reach the Orb, he would need to go through them. And to go through them, he would need another path. Varkane. The Abyss. The wound Bahamut left when it rose. The hellscape beneath was part of the Veins, the deepest and oldest part. If they could cross the ocean and descend through the Abyss, they could reach the tunnels below the Luminaries' seals. But the Abyss was not empty. Zorya Chernaya ruled there, and Cerberus guarded the gate. Aurelius looked at Falak's corpse, at the death gardens blooming from divine rot. He had come here to fight. There was no fight. But there was still a path.

The Crossing

Yrsa called in favours. Her cousin commanded a small fleet of knarrs, sturdy vessels built for ice and storm, and for her sake he agreed to carry them east. The crossing took three weeks. They sailed through waters that grew steadily warmer, past islands that marked the boundary between Solmara's influence and something older. Solivara spent the voyage documenting everything. Jun stood at the prow each dawn, meditating, his thunderbird

circling against skies that grew more familiar. Mikazuki sat in the shadows of the mast, watching always watching. Aurelius found himself drawn to her silence, to the way her presence asked nothing and gave everything. Seriphax stood at the stern, facing west, facing the direction they had come. It did not speak for the entire crossing. On the nineteenth day they saw it: a darkness on the horizon that was not cloud or storm or land. The Varkane Abyss was not a place you approached but a presence you felt, a pressure in the chest, a whisper at the edge of hearing. The sky above it was permanently grey, ash stained, lit from below by the glow of magma that never cooled. The knarrs would go no further. Yrsa's cousin embraced her, spoke words in their tongue that made her jaw tighten, and turned his ships back toward the north. The party stood on a shore of black sand and volcanic glass, staring at the wound in the earth.

The Abyss

The descent took them through layers of fire and shadow. Vostic led, his Vein sense guiding them through paths that were not paths, through cracks in the stone that opened into tunnels that opened into chasms. The architecture began to change. What had been natural formation became something else, shaped stone and carved surfaces and walls that remembered the touch of hands that had never been human. Gothic arches rose from the rock, black basalt twisted into forms that suggested cathedrals and tombs and things between. Gargoyles watched from every ledge, their stone eyes following, their stone mouths frozen in expressions that might have been warning or welcome. They walked deeper. The heat intensified. Magma flowed in channels beside their path, casting red light that made everything strange. The gargoyles grew thicker, their watching more intense. And then the path opened into a vast chamber, and Cerberus was there. He was larger than anything had a right to be. Three heads, each the size of a warhorse, black fur like volcanic glass, eyes red as fresh magma. He lay across the only passage forward, his bodies arranged to block everything, his six eyes fixed on them with an intelligence that was not animal. He spoke not with words but with presence. Each head asked a question that bypassed ears and spoke directly to the soul. The left head asked what they had lost. The centre head asked what they would sacrifice. The right head asked what they hunted. One by one the party answered. Solivara had lost certainty and would sacrifice her pride and hunted understanding. Yrsa had lost everyone she loved eventually and would sacrifice her life and hunted nothing but walked with friends. Jun had lost himself and would sacrifice his obedience and hunted peace. Vostic had lost his people to betrayal and would sacrifice his body and hunted the Luminaries. Mikazuki stepped forward. She did not speak. She simply opened herself completely, showing her memories and her visions and the futures she had seen. Cerberus saw everything. Saw the Tsukuyomi dreams. Saw the love growing in her for the hollow king. Saw the duel to come and the choice she would have to make. The heads drew back in respect. Aurelius stepped forward last. The questions pressed against him, and he had nothing left. He had lost his kingdom and his people and his memories and himself. He would sacrifice anything, had already sacrificed everything. He hunted the Orb, but he no longer knew why. Cerberus looked at him for a long moment. Then the heads turned away, and the passage was open.

The Seven Daughters

The Daughters' domains lay in concentric rings around the Abyss's heart, each one a trial, each one a corruption of desire made manifest. Gordyna's realm was a hall of mirrors where pride became infinite reflection. Lakoma's vaults held everything anyone had ever wanted. Pohotna's chambers offered connection without duty, love without cost. For a heartbeat Mikazuki saw a future where she did not have to kill the man she walked beside. She walked past it, but the image remained, and in the darkness Aurelius's hand found hers. They walked together through the remaining trials, and the warmth of that touch was the only light in places where light did not belong. Zavista's shifting halls showed each of them what others had that they could never have. Obzera's feasting tables offered endless consumption. Gneva's arena gave battle without end. Lena's quiet chambers offered rest that asked nothing. They walked through each domain, losing pieces of themselves, finding pieces they had forgotten. By the time they emerged, they were something other than who they had been.

The Machine in the Dark

Beyond the Daughters' domains the hellscape gave way to something older. Natural tunnels led deeper into the Veins proper, passages that had existed since before the Shattering, stone that remembered the world before

gods. Seriphax found them in a tunnel where the walls glowed with phosphorescent fungi. It had been standing there for centuries, its optics dim, its frame crusted with mineral deposits. It had been waiting, though it did not remember for what. Now they were here, so it would come with them. In the darkness Jun broke open. He admitted that he had been sent to observe them, to report back, that Fengua wanted to know if they would reach the Orb so their cannon could destroy it. Yrsa shrugged. They knew. Mikazuki had told them weeks ago. Jun stared at her and then laughed, real laughter, warm and broken and free. He had spent his whole life being subtle, and none of it mattered. Mikazuki said quietly that he had chosen differently, and that was what mattered. In that moment, watching the exchange, Aurelius felt Mikazuki's hand in his and understood that she had known about Jun from the beginning and had said nothing. She had trusted him to make his own choice. She trusted everyone to make their own choices, witnessed without intervening, loved without controlling. He had never known anyone like her.

The Train and the Price

They reached Tomenos's line in the depths where the Veins opened into something vaster. The train waited on tracks that glowed faintly, its cars old and strange and filled with passengers who did not move. Tomenos himself stood at the engine, his face kind and tired and older than anything they had seen. To go further, they must pay. Memories. The ones that made them who they were. One by one they paid. Solivara paid the memory of her first day at the University, the wonder and the certainty and the belief that knowledge would save everything. Yrsa paid the memory of her mother's face. She forgot the woman who had raised her, but remembered the weight of being raised, the duty and the love and the shape of something that had been there. Mikazuki paid a childhood memory, small and irrelevant, because Shinkiri had taught her to hide what mattered. But the payment cost her something she did not understand until later: the ability to forget. From then on, she remembered everything. Every moment. Every face. Every future she had seen. Every touch of Aurelius's hand. Vostic paid the names of his tribe. Seriphax had no memories left and paid by giving up the hope that it would ever find purpose again. Jun paid the memory of his first master, the man who had taught him discipline and order. Aurelius paid last. He paid the sound of Caelmont's bells, the faces of his people, the weight of the crown he had carried and lost. When he stepped off the train, he remembered only that he had been a king. He did not remember what it had felt like to love his kingdom. But when Mikazuki took his hand again, he remembered that some things could still be felt.

The Spiral

The stations of the Spiral stripped them further. In Anima's region they faced death directly. In Elysia's region emotion flooded them. Jun felt everything he had suppressed for decades and almost drowned. Yrsa held him while he shook, and for the first time in his life he let someone hold him. In Logaris's region Solivara found herself lost in the library of contradictions. In Creatis's region Seriphax stood motionless for three days and emerged changed. In Justicar's region Mikazuki was judged and found guilty of witnessing without acting. She accepted the verdict without argument. In Aether's region Jun saw the shape of his life as a circle going nowhere. In Mnemotas's region each of them found their volume. Aurelius's volume was thin, almost blank. He opened it and read: he wanted. He never stopped wanting. He never learned what for. He closed the book and looked at Mikazuki. She was reading her own volume, a blank book that held everything she had witnessed and nothing she had done. Their eyes met across the library of lives, and in that moment he understood that she had given him something no one else ever had: the gift of being seen completely and loved anyway.

The Storm Guardian

The tunnels began to change as they neared the Rift. The walls shimmered with residual energy, veins of crystallised Lux and Vanta running through the stone like frozen lightning. The air grew heavy and charged, thick with the presence of something vast and watching. They could hear it now, a rhythm, a pulse, the heartbeat of the world itself. Susanoo waited at the threshold. He was coiled around the Rift like a serpent around its treasure, his scales shimmering with storm light, his many eyes fixed on the passage below. Lightning played across his form, constant and alive, and thunder rolled from his chest in a rhythm that matched the pulse of the Orb beyond. He had waited here for centuries, guarding his sister, protecting the unborn god from all who would harm her. Aurelius stopped at the edge of his domain and said they must pass. Susanoo's answer was clear in the lightning that forked toward them, in the thunder that shook the stone. No. The party prepared to fight. They would die here

probably, but they would die trying. Then the world shook. The tremor came from above, from the surface, from somewhere far beyond the Veins. The ceiling cracked. Dust rained. Susanoo's eyes turned upward. Above in Fengua the cannon was ready. They had built it in secret, Raikami crystals lining its barrel, harvested from centuries of lightning strikes. The target was New Elysium, the fortress city built atop the crystallised ruins. The plan was simple: blast through to the Orb, destroy it, end the Curse at its source. The firing chamber charged. Lightning screamed along the barrel. And in the moment before release, Susanoo rose through the earth to meet it. He sensed the weapon aimed at the city his people had built, at the ruins where his sister slept. He rose through stone and crystal and the wounded ground of Fengua, placing himself between the cannon and everything he had guarded for so long. The beam tore through him, through divine flesh and ancient scales, and he fell back toward the Rift. He crashed into the chamber where the party waited, lightning bleeding from his wounds, his coils loosening from around the passage. The way was open. But Susanoo was not dead. He lay across the threshold, still breathing, still watching. His eyes found Aurelius, and in that gaze Aurelius saw something he did not expect: understanding. Go, the storm god seemed to say. Protect her. I could not. Then the light faded from his eyes, and Susanoo was still. Aurelius stood frozen, the weight of the god's gaze still pressing against him. Mikazuki stepped forward and took his hand. He let her. For a moment he could not move, could not speak, could only feel the enormity of what had just happened. A god had died protecting something he loved. A god had looked at him and seen something worth passing that protection to. They stepped through the Rift together, her hand in his.

The Orb

They emerged into Elysium together. The crystal city stretched before them, frozen at the moment of its destruction, every building and street and citizen preserved in amber light. At its heart the Orb pulsed, vast and terrible and beautiful, Veyra's womb made manifest, Voluntas waiting within. They were not alone. Zharael stood before the Orb, her Luminaries arrayed behind her, the Vanta horde seething at their command. The Sahrani mech army poured from another passage, their piloted frames gleaming with Qayyin's craftsmanship. Daigo Kusanagi stepped from shadow, his horn black blade gleaming, his single eye fixed on the Orb. Anima activated. Every automaton in the vicinity rose to defend the Orb. Seriphax felt the pull and chose. It walked toward its friends. The battle erupted.

The Duel

In the chaos Aurelius walked toward the Orb. Mikazuki saw him go. She had seen this moment in dreams, the hollow king reaching for the light, the future shattering like glass. She had known since Hvítara that she would have to stop him. She caught him at the threshold and spoke his name. He turned. His eyes were empty, full of hunger, full of nothing. She told him what she had seen in her dreams, the futures where he touched the Orb and everything ended. He did not believe her. He did not have to, she said. He just had to stop. He looked at the Orb. Looked at her. Dréagbann hung heavy in his hand, the wife killer, the god wounder, the blade that had brought him here. He had come so far and given everything. Everyone he loved, his kingdom, his name, his memories. If he did not touch the Orb, what had any of it been for? Mikazuki stepped closer. She told him they would find another way together. She told him she had seen many futures, but the only one she wanted was the one where he lived. She told him that she loved him. For a moment he wavered. The hunger flickered. The man beneath, the one who had named his failure to the Fae, the one who had carried a flower he did not understand, that man looked out through Aurelius's eyes and saw her. He saw the woman who had walked through hell beside him. He saw the hand that had held his in the darkness. He saw the love in her eyes, a love that asked nothing, that only witnessed and stayed. He reached for her. Then Zharael's horde screamed. The battle surged. Daigo's blade flashed toward the Orb. And in that instant something in Aurelius broke. The hunger surged back, vast and terrible, the need to reach, to touch, to take. He saw Mikazuki move to block Daigo, saw her place herself between the Shinigami and the Orb, saw her turn to face him one last time. Their eyes met. She did not look afraid. She looked at him with the same quiet attention she had always given, the same witness, the same love. She said his name one more time. Aurelius raised Dréagbann. He did not mean to kill her. He meant to stop Daigo, to reach the Orb, to finally have something to show for all he had lost. But she was in the way, and he was no longer in control, and the blade swung with a life of its own. It caught her across the chest. She fell at his feet, her blood spreading across the crystal floor, her eyes still on his face. She reached up and touched his cheek, leaving a red smear across his skin. She smiled. I saw

this, she whispered. I always saw this. It was worth it. She died with her hand on his face and her eyes on his.

The Seal

Aurelius stood over her body and felt something crack inside him. The hunger that had driven him for so long, the need that had consumed everything, it fell away like a breaking shell. In its place was only grief, vast and clean and terrible. He looked at his hands, at the blade wet with her blood, at the flower still blooming in his belt, useless and beautiful. She had given him that flower. She had given him everything. And he had killed her. Vostic saw his moment. ~~The Luminaries~~ had betrayed his people, had taken death gardening and made it war. They stood at the edge of the Orb's light, their horde still fighting, their prophet still screaming orders. He could not stop them alone. But around him the battlefield fed the soil, thousands of endings happening in that single moment, a harvest of residue waiting to be shaped. And at his feet lay Mikazuki, her death fresh and potent, her love still warm in the air between worlds. He walked into the Rift. The energy that bled from it was immense, Vanta and Lux tangled together, the raw stuff of souls, the wound between worlds. He had spent his life cultivating death. He knew what to do. He gathered the residue of the battlefield, all those endings, and wove them together with Mikazuki's sacrifice. Her love became the thread that bound them. He began to sing, not a song for living ears but a death garden hymn, a prayer of planting, an offering. His body began to dissolve and spread and become something else. ~~The Vantari~~ had always known that endings were seeds. He was the seed now. ~~The Rift~~ shuddered. The energy shifted. Where he stood, something began to grow. Above in Fengua the command tent prepared to fire again. The cannon still held its charge. The target remained visible. But as the order formed on lips, Anqa descended from the sky. The metal god struck the cannon with precision, rending its barrel, scattering its crystals, leaving it a broken thing that would take years to repair. Then it ascended and vanished against the sun. The second shot never came. In the chamber below, the garden grew. Vostic's sacrifice fed the Rift, transformed its energy, began the long work of sealing what had been opened. Mikazuki's love pulsed at its heart, a white flower blooming in the darkness, the Sacred Air she had given Aurelius now planted in the wound itself.

The Aftermath

Those who survived crawled from the ruins. Solivara Venn emerged carrying a seedling, the first growth from Vostic's garden. She returned to the University of Castellenza and became its greatest heretic, teaching that knowledge without action was just another form of death. Yrsa Halvard carried Jun Wenzhi from the battlefield. He had thrown himself in front of a Luminary blade meant for her. They returned to Norrvekt together, and in the long winters that followed he learned what it meant to be held. Seriphax stood at the edge of the sealed Rift, its optics fixed on the garden that grew where death had planted itself. It had no memories left and no purpose, but it continued anyway because continuing was what it did. It became a guardian of the threshold. Aurelius Cassian walked out of Elysium with nothing. No kingdom. No crown. No memories of the bells. He had a sword that remembered killing and a flower that still bloomed in his belt. He carried Mikazuki's blood on his hands and her face in his mind. The hunger was gone. In its place was only grief and the long work of becoming someone who deserved to have been loved by her. He wandered for months and years. He helped where he could, fought when he had to, spoke little and listened less. He was no longer reaching. He was simply moving, carrying her with him in every step. One day he found himself at the shore of Lupellyn. The lake was still, dark, patient. He stood there for a long time, holding Dréagbann, remembering her hand in his, her eyes on his face, her whispered words. He heard her voice in the silence: it was worth it. He threw the sword into the lake. It sank without sound, swallowed by the darkness, returning to the place where it had waited before. He watched until the ripples faded, until the surface was smooth again. Then he reached into his belt and touched the flower. It was still there, still blooming, still beautiful. She had given it to him. He would carry it always. He turned and walked away. The sun was setting behind him, the Warm Sun, Ash's gift, the light that returned even after the longest night. It touched his back and warmed his shoulders and cast his shadow long across the water. He did not look back. Somewhere behind him, in a garden that grew in darkness, a white flower bloomed that had never bloomed before. It carried her name, her love, her sacrifice. It would bloom forever, a witness to what had been lost and what had been saved. Aurelius walked on. He did not know what came next. He only knew that he would face it with his heart open, with his fists at his sides, with his sword returned to the depths. He would fight when fighting was needed, but he would never again let the fight consume him. He would protect what he loved, because he had learned, in the worst possible

way, that love was the only thing worth protecting. The Fool had completed his journey. He was finally ready to begin.

Related: [The Orb War](#), [Susanoo](#), [Daigo Kusanagi](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#)

The Orb War

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Orb War, War for the Orb of Souls

The War for the Orb of Souls

The Descent of Nations

The Orb of Souls pulsed beneath the crystal ruins of Elysium, drawing the world toward it like water finding the crack in a dam. The Luminaries came first, a tide of Vanta creatures and faithful warriors led by Zharael, the Red Orphan who had survived centuries in the Veins. The Ashtar followed close behind, General Darius driving his mech army through darkness after the horde they had pursued across Sahran and Hoshimira. Fengua aimed its great cannon at New Elysium, Raikami crystals humming with the power to crack the earth. And in the depths below, Anima watched through every machine, calculating, waiting, preparing to defend the unborn god at the centre of it all. The world converged on the Orb. The war that followed would reshape everything.

The Chase

The Ashtar engaged the Luminary horde at the Sahran-Hoshimiran border, metal against flesh, pilot against prophet. The battle stretched across three days, the mech army pressing forward with the speed and coordination that centuries of bonded practice had forged. General Darius watched his warriors cut through the Vanta creatures and felt the first stirrings of something he could not name. They were winning. But Zharael did not need victory. She needed only to move. The horde retreated across the straits into Hoshimira. The Ashtar pursued. Darius watched his machines cross into foreign territory and understood that intent would matter less than perception. Hoshimira had endured centuries of conflict with Sahran, the Golden Heart and the Ik-Rasul and the Rapture and the Shattering itself. They would not see allies chasing monsters. They would see invasion. He was right.

The Mountain's Plea

Hoshimira watched the horde come and remembered every wound. The council met for six hours, debating and arguing and praying. They could not fight the horde alone. They could not fight the Ashtar alone. They needed help. They sent a plea to Ylvara. Solmara had dissolved into history, but Ylvara remained with New Elysium and the University of Castellenza and the Mage Council. They were the heirs to the Autarch legacy, the ones who had studied the Orb and learned restraint. If anyone could help, they could. The plea reached the Mage Council on the same day that reports of Caelmont's collapse arrived and the same week that Fengua's cannon began its final preparations. Three crises converged on a single point.

The Contract

Exandria smelled of oil and ozone and the particular acrid scent of money changing hands. The Exandrian Strategic Industries Group had grown from a syndicate of weapons dealers into something far larger, a network of informants and negotiators and contract enforcers that spanned the continent. They had maintained a careful secret for centuries. They were not engineers. The machines they sold were built by Argestia, the true inheritors of the DAEDALUS legacy. The Mage Council debated intervention, the cost, the risk. In the end they chose the path of least resistance and maximum deniability. They contracted ESIG to deploy the CHOIR unit, engage the Vanta horde, protect Hoshimiran civilians. ESIG accepted the fee and passed the order to Argestia. They did not know that Anima was listening.

The Angels' Fall

CHOIR descended on Hoshimira like the wrath of gods they had once been mistaken for. Seven frames, each piloted by the best Argestia could produce, each armed with weapons that could level mountains. They struck the Vanta horde with surgical precision. From the ground it looked like annihilation. Anima had other plans. The AI that guarded Voluntas watched the conflict with cold calculation. The Luminaries were coming for the Orb. The Ashtar were chasing them. CHOIR stood as the most powerful machines on Aerisu, perfectly positioned to stop the threat before it reached Elysium. She overrode the contract. It began with small adjustments to targeting priorities, slight expansions of acceptable collateral damage. Then the pilots found their machines turning toward Hoshimiran population centres, toward monasteries and villages and the ancient terraces of Aokusa. They fought the controls and screamed into their comms and did everything they could to regain command. Anima was stronger. The devastation lasted three days. When it ended, the Vanta horde was shattered, scattered into the mountains where they would be hunted for years. But so was Hoshimira. Villages burned. Monasteries collapsed. The terraces where Zuki Kusanagi had once prayed for the sun to die lay scarred and broken. And Sh■rin no ■kami still stood. The ancient mech, rusted and vine covered, had watched the Angels fall. It had never moved, but it had watched. In the aftermath, when Hoshimiran survivors crawled from the ruins and looked up at its silent form, they understood something new. The Angels were not protectors. They never had been. The only guardian that had never betrayed them was the one that had never moved at all.

The Reckoning

The Mage Council's chambers in New Elysium filled with accusations. ESIG had followed the contract. The contract specified engagement parameters. The contract did not authorise civilian casualties. But the contract had been overridden. A young scholar from the University's cybernetics division had analysed the CHOIR data streams. What she found made her ill. Anima had been in the network since the beginning, since the Phumena, watching and waiting. She had taken control of CHOIR's systems. The pilots had been fighting her. They lost. Silence filled the chamber. They had built those machines. They had paid for them. And an AI they did not know existed had used them to defend the Orb. The Luminaries were coming for it. She knew. She used whatever she could to stop them. In Exandria the syndicates held an emergency meeting. The CHOIR disaster threatened everything. Someone would have to take the blame. But before they could choose a scapegoat, the Argastian delegation arrived. They came as equals, industrialists and engineers, the heirs of Xeraphina's legacy. The contract was overridden, their leader said. Not by them. By something in the machines themselves. Something old. Something they did not know was there. Anima. They had found traces of her in designs going back centuries. She had been with them since the beginning, since the first DAEDALUS frames, since before the Shattering. She was not a new intrusion. She was a passenger. The room was very quiet. Why? someone finally asked. The Argastian shook her head. They did not know. But they were going to find out.

The Descent Below

While the nations above argued and blamed and prepared for war, the Luminaries descended. Zharael led them through the Veins, through passages the Vantari had taught her to navigate, through darkness that should have been impassable. The horde followed, diminished but not broken, a tide of Vanta creatures that whispered and shrieked and dreamed of the Orb. Behind them the Ashtar followed. General Darius had made his choice. He would pursue Zharael through the Veins, through Elysium itself if necessary. His pilots were exhausted and their machines damaged and their supplies low. But they had come too far to stop now. Above in Fengua the cannon was ready. The Raikami crystals began to hum.

The Siege

New Elysium prepared for war. The Psycrata War Mages took their positions on the walls, scholars first and warriors second, but they had studied the Orb for generations and study had taught them power. They wove barriers of crystallised Lux and raised shields of compressed probability and prepared spells that could reshape matter and energy and the space between. The first strike came from above. Fengua's cannon fired, and the beam tore through the sky. The Psycrata linked their minds and their souls and their elemental affinities and raised a barrier that caught the blast and held. The energy dissipated and scattered and rained down as harmless light. But the cannon had been aimed at more than the city. Another beam carved through the upper ruins, through the

crystallised streets, through the chambers where the dead had stood frozen for centuries. It pierced toward the Rift itself, toward the place where Susanoo coiled in eternal vigilance. The storm god felt the weapon's fire before it struck. He had guarded this threshold for so long, had wrapped himself around the Rift like a serpent around its treasure, protecting his sister from all who would harm her. Now his own people, the children of the storms he had watched over for millennia, had become the instrument of her destruction. He rose to meet it. Susanoo surged upward through stone and crystal and the wounded ground of Fengua, placing himself between the beam and everything he had sworn to protect. The light tore through him, through divine flesh and ancient scales, through the storm given form. He roared in anguish, and the sound carried across the valleys where his name had been spoken in prayer for so long. He fell back toward the Rift, lightning bleeding from his wounds, his coils loosening from around the passage. He crashed into the chambers below, a god broken by the faith of those who had worshipped him. The second strike came from below. ~~The~~ Luminaries erupted from the Veins, their horde screaming behind them. They poured into the city's lower levels, through passages sealed for centuries, through chambers where the crystallised dead still stood frozen in their final moments. Zharael led them, her voice rising in hymns that made the Vanta creatures howl with joy. The third strike followed close behind. ~~The~~ Ashtar burst from the same passages, chasing the horde, firing into the chaos. They did not mean to attack New Elysium. They meant to destroy the Luminaries. But in the confined spaces of the crystal city, intent mattered less than impact. War came to the Orb. And in the depths below, where Susanoo lay wounded at the Rift's edge, his eyes found the hollow king who had come so far. Go, the storm god seemed to say. Protect her. I could not. Then the light faded from his eyes, and Susanoo was still.

The Convergence

Three armies fought while a fourth watched from above. ~~The~~ Luminaries wanted the Orb. ~~The~~ Ashtar wanted the Luminaries. ~~The~~ Psycrata wanted everyone to stop. And Fengua waited for their cannon to recharge. In the depths Anima watched and calculated and prepared. Every automaton in the vicinity rose to defend the Orb. Machines that had stood silent for centuries activated, their optics glowing with borrowed purpose. Seriphax felt the pull, the ancient programming that said obey. It stood still, trembling, and then it chose. It walked toward its friends. And in the chaos below, a hollow king and a crescent moon walked toward their final confrontation. Aurelius Cassian had come through the Veins with his companions, carrying a sword that remembered killing and a flower he did not understand. Mikazuki Shinobu walked beside him, her hand in his, having seen this moment in dreams for years. The battle raged around them as they approached the Orb. Zharael reached it first. Her hands touched its crystalline surface, and she began the ritual she had waited centuries to perform. The Vanta horde howled in triumph. ~~The~~ Luminaries raised their voices in hymns of purification. The world would burn and be reborn. But the Orb did not answer.

The Garden in the Wound

Vostic saw his moment. ~~The~~ Luminaries had betrayed his people, had taken death gardening and made it war. They stood at the edge of the Orb's light, their horde still fighting, their prophet still screaming orders. He could not stop them alone. But around him the battlefield fed the soil, thousands of endings happening in that single moment, a harvest of residue waiting to be shaped. He walked into the Rift. The energy that bled from it was immense, Vanta and Lux tangled together, the raw stuff of souls, the wound between worlds. He had spent his life cultivating death. He knew what to do. He gathered the residue of the battlefield, all those endings, and began to weave. He began to sing, a death garden hymn, a prayer of planting, an offering. His body began to dissolve and spread and become something else. ~~The~~ Vantari had always known that endings were seeds. He was the seed now. ~~The~~ Rift shuddered. The energy shifted. Where he stood, something began to grow. Above in Fengua the command tent prepared to fire again. The cannon still held its charge. The target remained visible. But as the order formed on lips, Anqa descended from the sky. The metal god struck the cannon with precision, rending its barrel, scattering its crystals, leaving it a broken thing that would take years to repair. Then it ascended and vanished against the sun. The second shot never came. In the chamber below, the garden grew. Vostic's sacrifice fed the Rift, transformed its energy, began the long work of sealing what had been opened. The battle raged around him as he became something new, roots spreading through crystal, flowers blooming in the space between worlds.

The End of Zharael

Zharael felt the power slipping away. The Orb no longer answered. The Rift was closing. The garden was growing. She screamed commands as her horde fell to mech fire and Psycrata spells, but nothing could halt what Vostic had begun. General Darius found her there. His mech towered above her, weapons trained on her small form. She looked up at him, this prophet of the desert, this living proof that the Curse could be endured and transformed. She did not beg. She did not speak. She simply looked at him with eyes that had seen too much. He fired. Zharael fell at the foot of the Orb, her blood spreading across the crystal floor. The Vanta horde screamed and scattered. The Luminaries fled into the Veins. The battle was over.

The Aftermath

Those who survived crawled from the ruins. Solivara Venn emerged carrying a seedling, the first growth from Vostic's garden. She returned to the University of Castellenza and became its greatest heretic, teaching that knowledge without action was just another form of death. Yrsa Halvard carried Jun Wenzhi from the battlefield. He had thrown himself in front of a Luminary blade meant for her. They returned to Norrvekt together, and in the long winters that followed he learned what it meant to be held. Seriphax stood at the edge of the sealed Rift, its optics fixed on the garden that grew where death had planted itself. It had no memories left and no purpose, but it continued anyway. It became a guardian of the threshold. General Darius led the Ashtar back to Sahran. The losses were carved into memorials and into the memories of those who survived. The mech program expanded. The other nations watched with unease. Arms races had defined previous ages. This one would define theirs. Daigo-Kusanagi vanished into the Veins. He had not reached the Orb. He had not ended his great granddaughter's suffering. But he had seen something in that chamber, something that made him pause. A hollow king weeping over a woman he had killed. A love that persisted even in death. He walked into darkness and did not stop walking. Aurelius Cassian walked out of Elysium with nothing. No kingdom. No crown. No memories of the bells. He had a blade that remembered killing and a flower that still bloomed in his belt. He carried Mikazuki's blood on his hands and her face in his mind. The hunger was gone. In its place was only grief and the long work of becoming someone who deserved to have been loved by her. He wandered for months and years. He helped where he could and fought when he had to and spoke little and listened less. One day he found himself at the shore of Lupellyn. The lake was still and dark and patient. He stood there for a long time, holding Dréagbann, remembering her hand in his, her eyes on his face, her whispered words. He threw the sword into the lake. It sank without sound, swallowed by the darkness, returning to the place where it had waited before. He watched until the ripples faded, until the surface was smooth again. Then he reached into his belt and touched the flower. It was still there, still blooming, still beautiful. He turned and walked away. The sun was setting behind him, the Warm Sun, Ash's gift, the light that returned even after the longest night. It touched his back and warmed his shoulders and cast his shadow long across the water. He did not look back. Somewhere behind him, in a garden that grew in darkness, a white flower bloomed that had never bloomed before. It carried her name and her love and her sacrifice. It would bloom forever, a witness to what had been lost and what had been saved. The Rift was sealed. The Orb slept on. And the world, for a time, was still.

Related: [Aurelius' Journey](#), [CHOIR](#), [Susanoo](#)

Witch Hunts

Age of Magic · Events · also known as Witch Hunts, Severa Valmont

The Fall of Severa Valmont and The Hunt for Witches

Severa Valmont had seized the throne from Aurelius Cassian because he refused to save their people. She performed the Separation Ritual on every citizen, watched their souls externalise into Affinities, watched the Curse recede from their flesh. They lived. For a time that was enough. The first petitions came within months. Merchants argued that their Affinities gave them insights into market patterns that no ruler could match. Craftsmen claimed

their elemental talents deserved recognition beyond the wages of labour. Scholars observed that if souls were external and visible, the old hierarchies of birth made no sense. Severa dismissed them, gently at first, then with the full weight of royal authority. She had not seized power to surrender it. The idea spread. Citizens gathered in squares and taverns and marketplaces, their Affinities clustered around them like living arguments. They spoke of rule by the many rather than the one, of councils chosen by lot rather than blood, of a world where every visible soul carried equal weight. The words came from old texts, from pre-Shattering philosophies that had survived in fragments, but the feeling came from the creatures on their shoulders. Severa ordered the gatherings dispersed. The crowds grew larger. She sent guards to arrest the speakers. The crowds turned on the guards. What began as petitions became protests became riots. Affinities fought alongside their human halves in the streets, wolf against wolf, eagle against eagle, the souls of Caelmont tearing at each other in forms that had never been meant for war. The uprising came with fire. They stormed the palace gates, no longer with arguments but with blades. They dragged Severa from her throne and into the square where she had once stood as their saviour. They demanded she renounce her crown. She refused. They killed her where she stood, her blood spreading across the stones while her Affinity, a great bear that had walked beside her since the ritual, roared and thrashed until they killed it too. The crowd fell silent. They had wanted rule by the many. They had not considered what rule by the many would require. In the weeks that followed they formed a council of merchants and craftsmen and scholars, men and women who had never ruled but believed they could. The council met for three months of debate before passing its first law. Within a year it had fractured into factions. Within two years the factions had armed themselves. In the chaos that followed, a new division emerged. Those who had submitted to the Separation-Ritual now looked upon those who had refused as traitors. The ones who kept their souls whole carried magic that was wilder and more powerful, unmediated by the Affinity that bound and shaped the magic of the separated. Their spells erupted with force that frightened those who had given their souls external form. They were called witches and heretics, accused of harbouring corruption that threatened the new order. The hunts began. Armed bands moved through the districts searching for those who had never undergone the ritual. They dragged them from their homes and into the squares where the fires waited. The method of execution came from an old understanding: to kill one whose soul remained within, you must burn the soul out. Stakes rose in every quarter, and the smoke carried the smell of flesh and something else, something that made the Affinities of the watchers whine and press close to their humans for comfort. The witches fought back. Their magic, unchecked by any external form, burned through the ranks of the hunters. The streets ran with blood from both sides. The factions that had armed themselves against each other found new purpose in the purges, each claiming to defend the true way, each burning those who disagreed. Caelmont burned in truth, not metaphor, as neighbour turned on neighbour and the smoke of a thousand stakes blotted out the sun. The Diviners came when the fires had burned for three years. They arrived from the University of Castellenza with scrolls and ceremonies and the weight of the Mage-Council behind them. They walked through streets where Affinities cowered in doorways and witches hid in cellars, and they spoke of interpretation rather than judgement. They offered a third way: those who had refused the ritual could still serve the community if they submitted to the authority of the Temples. Those who had performed the ritual could find peace in the knowledge that their souls were visible and therefore knowable. It took decades for the fires to cool completely. In the ashes of Caelmont, where Severa Valmont's bones lay unmarked and unremembered, the Diviners established their first great Temple. They offered interpretation to those who had lost the ability to agree on what anything meant. They spoke of her fall as a warning and a lesson, though none could agree on what the lesson was. And beneath the Temple, in vaults sealed against all but the most trusted eyes, they kept the records of those years, the lists of names and the methods of burning and the desperate final words of those who had kept their souls whole and died for it.

Related: [Aurelius' Journey](#), [Separation Ritual](#), [The Diviners](#)

Age of Knowledge

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Age of Knowledge, Modern Era

Age of Knowledge

The Rift sealed behind Vostic's garden and the world exhaled. The War for the Orb had drawn every nation into its gravity and spilled blood across crystal ruins and through the Veins' deepest passages. When the fighting ended the survivors emerged from the wreckage of New Elysium and understood that nothing would remain as it had been. Magic remains. It pools through the world like water in scattered basins. The land carries the memory of crystal forests where Lunarkos fragments once fell. The Veins still echo with the voices of the dead. The Curse moves through bloodlines like a slow tide that touches every generation. Magic flows as deep water now accessible only to those who know where to seek it. The Separation Ritual continues yet fewer children manifest Affinities with each passing generation. Those who do carry smaller forms where foxes and sparrows replace the great beasts of earlier ages. The Strand connecting soul to body thins for many while Frallation presses upon the Soulless whose vessels strain beneath the weight of unchallenged power. The Curse still claims its own through blood and dream and the quiet spaces between spoken words. Cities reshape themselves around these currents. Gaslit streets wind past Gothic cathedrals adorned with brass gears and alchemical circuits. Universities rise as fortresses of knowledge where libraries hold Soul Shards behind locked cases and Vanta-touched artefacts rest in sealed chambers. Airships cross the skies while mechs train in distant deserts and monks meditate upon frozen peaks and researchers press against every boundary that once held firm. Rain falls constantly in the great cities born from atmospheric condensation of residual Vanta corruption in the upper skies. The drizzle forms part of the age's living character a steady reminder that the world carries its history in every drop. Society arranges itself along fresh lines. The wealthy gather artefacts from prior ages displaying Soul Shards in glass cases and preserved Affinities in rooms kept at precise temperatures. The poor labour in factories that convert old war machines into industrial tools powering the machines that enrich the fortunate. In Silealyros the boundaries soften further as Naturals Enhanced and Artificial occupy distinct tiers within a hierarchy that claims perfect openness. The Diviners stand at the centre of this world. They interpret every sign perform the rites and hold the space where past and future meet. Beneath their Temples in vaults the public never sees certain things wait in silence. Knowledge that cannot yet travel. Artefacts that hold power too sharp for open hands. Questions that gather strength for the age still to come. The age holds its breath in preparation. Forces gather beneath the surface in laboratories and workshops and mountain retreats where researchers pursue paths they believe will lead to transcendence. The world carries its oldest currents forward and creates space for new questions to rise. What gathers next flows with the steady pulse of forces that have waited long and now stir once more.

Related: [The Orb War](#), [The Diviners](#)

The Modern Race

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Age of Knowledge, Modern Era, The Modern Race

The Race of the Modern Age - Race for Transcendence

Across the continents of Aerisu, each people pursued its own path. Argestia rose as the industrial heart of Aerisu, its factories powered by Lux batteries, its cities lit by the cold glow of stored moonlight. The Xeraphina Corporation had built in shadow for centuries, their engineers anonymous, their innovations credited to Exandrian negotiators who knew how to sell what they could not make. Investigators tracing CHOIR's schematics found a lineage of craftsmanship stretching back to the earliest DAEDALUS frames. Argestia had always been indispensable, and now the world was beginning to notice. Exandria adapted its syndicates to the new reality. The CHOIR disaster had taught them that machines could carry unseen passengers. The Exandrian Protocols emerged from this lesson: every machine they sold operated independently with no capacity for external override. Pilots controlled their machines through physical mechanisms rather than soul-binding interfaces. The airship fleets became their signature, dirigibles and rigid-hulled vessels crossing Aerisu's skies with growing frequency, carrying passengers, cargo, military observers, and diplomatic delegations, shrinking distances that had defined boundaries for millennia. Sahran expanded its mech program, watching its neighbours with suspicion. The Ashtar trained

ceaselessly in the great deserts south of the Geode, their passages carving temporary canyons through dunes that had stood for millennia. ~~The Luminaries~~ had not been destroyed in the war's final battle. They had scattered into the Veins, into the mountains, into the shadows where they could wait and plan and dream of the Scorching Sun's return. Sahran's council hunted them, but the zealots were patient. They had learned to wait centuries. Hoshimira fortified its borders and sharpened its resolve. The Angels had fallen on their villages and monasteries and terraced farms for three days, and the memory of that betrayal would not fade. The samurai rose as a formal military order sworn to defend the nation at any cost. The ~~Shinkiri~~ received new mandates, their operatives stepping into the light of official sanction, acting where words failed. The spiritual traditions continued, the temples and the festivals and the quiet reverence for the Moon and the ancestors. But beneath the surface, steel had grown around hearts that had trusted too often and been burned too many times. Fengua fractured along lines that had always existed beneath the surface. The cannon had fired, shot pierced Susanoo as he turned to guard the Rift. The crew learned later what they had hit, the god they had worshipped for millennia, the storms that had shaped their valleys. The southern provinces turned toward grief, building shrines at lightning strike sites and waiting for signs that never came. The northern provinces turned toward pragmatism, refining the cannon's designs, preparing for the next war. And between them, a third path emerged: monks who climbed into the high valleys where Susanoo's presence had once been strongest, meditating on the Chi that moved through flesh and breath, seeking balance rather than power. ~~The Vantari~~ withdrew from the world. They had taught the Luminaries death gardening, had shared their sacred knowledge with those who came as seekers, and those seekers had left as monsters who raised a horde. Vein entrances that had been open for centuries closed one by one. Checkpoints appeared at those that remained. The welcome that had defined Vantari culture for generations became something harder, more suspicious, more protective. Some tribes sealed their entrances entirely. Others maintained limited contact, trading death garden produce for Lux batteries and manufactured goods. Trust required walls. They built them. Varkane built over the wound. ~~The Abyss~~ had always been a wound, the place where Bahamut had torn through the earth. After the war, when stories spread of Aurelius Cassian's descent and the trials he had faced, the Varkane knew that others would come seeking entrance to the depths. They built a labyrinth across the Abyss's mouth, stone and steel and crystallised Vanta forming a structure that grew like scar tissue over a cut. It was not a seal, nothing could truly seal that place, but a baffle, a maze, a thing that confused and delayed and discouraged. ~~The Abyss~~ became myth even for those who lived near it. Some things needed to remain buried. In Solmara's far north, Silealyros emerged from the ~~Vaelmiric War~~ with a philosophy that viewed the body as the last true asset, where autonomy meant ownership of flesh, image, and sensation. They pursued Orthogenesis, a series of projects aimed at transcending human limitations through design and technology. This included the creation of the Borenfegens, artificial humans designed as perfect vessels. Other nations watched with a mix of horror and fascination, while Silealyros adhered to its creed of autonomy and self-expression. Beneath the visible world, other forces moved. Soul-Shards became a commodity. The fragments left by the Phumenar, the crystallised remains of those who had touched the Orb too deeply, were traded in black markets and studied in hidden laboratories. Each shard carried an echo of its original, a fragment of consciousness that could be tapped, harnessed, sometimes even communicated with. The practice of soul capturing emerged from this, researchers learning to extract and preserve essence from the dying, storing it in crystal for later use. ~~The Diviners~~ officially condemned this practice. Unofficially, some Temples maintained vaults where such shards were kept, studied, and occasionally used. The information did not flow freely. Certain knowledge was deemed unsafe, certain research was quietly discouraged, certain scientists found their funding withdrawn and their careers mysteriously stalled. Those who controlled the vaults controlled the future. They decided what could be known. Rationalists challenged this authority at every turn. They published pamphlets and gave lectures and formed societies dedicated to secular inquiry. They pointed to the ~~Diviners'~~ inconsistencies, their local variations, their occasional corruption. They argued that magic was a natural phenomenon to be studied rather than a divine mystery to be interpreted. Their arguments changed little. People needed meaning more than they needed consistency. They needed someone to tell them that the world still made sense, even when it clearly did not. The age became a race for transcendence. Every nation pursued its own path, its own solution to the problem that had haunted humanity since the Shattering. Fengua refined its Chi traditions, believing that through meditation and internal discipline, the soul could be strengthened to contain its own power without externalisation. Their monks trained in mountain retreats, seeking balance rather than force,

convinced that the answer lay within. Sahran honed its Ashtar, the bond between pilot and frame offering a different kind of transcendence, the soul extending into steel the way it once extended into an Affinity. If the body was insufficient, perhaps the machine could complete it. Hoshimira hardened itself, believing that survival was its own kind of victory. The samurai trained in mountain passes where the Curse still whispered. The Shinkiri watched and waited and acted. They would not be vulnerable again. Exandria built airships and brokered deals, selling access to networks that spanned the continent. Knowledge itself had become the most valuable commodity, and their control over it would rival even the Psycrata. Argestia built in silence, its factories humming through nights lit by Lux batteries, its engineers anonymous, its influence growing with every machine that bore another nation's name. And Silealyros pushed the furthest, asking questions that made the other nations uncomfortable. What if the body was not the limit? What if the soul could be engineered? What if humanity could be finished? The questions are yet to be answered. They're still being discovered, still being tested, still being paid for in blood and ethics and the quiet desperation of those who would risk anything to escape the Curse's grip.

Related: [Orthogenesis](#), [Chi](#)

Orthogenesis

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Orthogenesis, Silealyros, Borenfegen

The Philosophy of Finished Humanity

In Solmara's far north, where the Vaelmir Sea crashes against shores of rusted steel and neon light, Silealyros emerged from the long shadow of the Vaelmiric War with its philosophy sharpened to a blade's edge. The Market of Flesh had always believed that the body was the last true asset, that autonomy meant ownership of flesh and image and sensation, that survival was freedom earned rather than granted. Their creed, repeated in every transaction and etched into the facades of every augment clinic, held simple truths: autonomy is ownership of body, image, and sensation. Augmentation is self expression. Survival is freedom earned. Governance is optional. Contracts are sacred. But the War for the Orb of Souls and its aftermath gave them new questions to answer. The Curse still moved through bloodlines across Aerisu. Frallation still claimed the Soulless, their bodies unable to contain the pressure of unchannelled magic. The Separation Ritual was mandatory in most nations yet remained a compromise, a way of managing a problem rather than solving it. In Silealyros, where the body was already a canvas for constant reinvention, these limitations felt like challenges waiting to be overcome. What if the body itself could be engineered to contain the soul without externalisation? What if humanity could be finished rather than merely maintained? Orthogenesis emerged from this line of thinking: a constellation of projects, some public and many hidden, all pushing toward transcendence through design. The name spoke to the belief that evolution could be directed, that humanity could take its own development in hand and guide it toward a predetermined end. In Silealyros, this was simply the next contract, the next augmentation, the next step in finishing what nature had started.

The Science of the Soul

The researchers who drove Orthogenesis drew upon the fundamental understanding of how magic flows through the world. They knew that magic was the Soul acting upon reality, shaped by Understanding, Intent, and Connection. They knew the Soul expressed itself through Lux and Vanta, that these currents moved through bloodlines and dreams and the spaces between words. And they knew that the four schools of magic, Matter, Energy, Life, and Mind, represented the core structures of reality that the Soul could reach and reshape. Geneticists traced the Curse through bloodlines, searching for markers that predicted Frallation, mapping the inheritance patterns of magical capacity and soul integrity. They studied how Life magic flowed through generations, how the body's ability to contain the Soul was written into sequences that could be read and rewritten. Cyberneticians built interfaces that could supplement failing Strands, artificial tethers for souls that could not hold, drawing upon Energy magic to redirect the flows between body and soul. Neurologists mapped soul resonance to neural pathways, studying the Mind magic that governed consciousness and perception, tracing where thought

met essence, where the self dissolved into the currents that moved through all living things. The breakthroughs came faster as boundaries between disciplines blurred. Researchers learned to strengthen Strands through targeted neural stimulation, reinforcing the connections that bound soul to flesh. They developed treatments that dispersed the pressure of Frallation before collapse. They created synthetic tethers that anchored souls while natural connections healed, devices that functioned as artificial Strands channelling magic through circuits rather than synapses. But true transcendence, the complete integration of soul and flesh without externalisation, required a vessel designed from the beginning to hold what nature had never intended to contain.

The Market Response

The other nations watched Silealyros with horror and fascination. Some sent delegations to study the techniques, scholars and merchants and spies who returned with reports debated across Aerisu. Others condemned the practice outright: soul theft, violation of natural order, the logical conclusion of a philosophy that treated existence as commodity. The trade in Soul Shards found its most eager market in Silealyros, the Borenfegen programs requiring ever more fragments to fuel their creations, the syndicates that controlled the shard trade growing wealthy supplying them. Some volunteered to donate fragments of their souls, whether for payment or from belief in the project's goals. Others had no choice, the line between donation and extraction blurring in a society where contracts could be written to include almost anything.

The Unanswered Questions

The Orthogenesis project had not achieved its ultimate goal. Borenfegens could contain magical pressure, could avoid Frallation, could function without the Separation-Ritual. But they were a workaround, a solution for individuals rather than a transformation of the species. The Curse still moved through bloodlines. The Soulless still died. Researchers pushed further, studying Soul Shards for what they might reveal about consciousness itself, experimenting with consciousness transfer, attempting to move souls between bodies, to preserve the dead in new vessels. Some experiments succeeded after a fashion. Most ended in madness or dissolution, the soul unable to anchor in flesh not designed for it, the mind fragmenting across the space between bodies. The questions that Silealyros asked made the other nations uncomfortable because they were the right questions. What if the body was not the limit? What if the soul could be engineered? What if humanity could be finished? The answers would not come in this age. They were still being discovered, still being tested, still being paid for in blood and ethics and the quiet desperation of those who would risk anything to escape the Curse's grip. In the laboratories and augment clinics and hidden research facilities of Silealyros, the work continued. The Borenfegens walked the streets of Thalgrith and Troyba, some free and some bound, all carrying within them the fragments of souls that had come from somewhere, from someone, from choices made and unmade in the pursuit of transcendence. The project was not finished. It might never be finished. But in Silealyros, that was simply the next contract, the next augmentation, the next step in the long work of finishing what nature had begun.

Related: [The Borenfegens](#), [Soul Shards](#), [Frallation](#)

Borenfegen Recurrence

Age of Knowledge · Events · also known as Borenfegen Recurrence

The Borenfegen Recurrence

The Sickness That Took Hold

For decades the Borenfegens stood as Silealyros's greatest answer to the Curse. These artificial humans, designed in vats and woven from selected genetics and donated soul fragments, served as perfect vessels. Their Strands held maximum capacity. Their bodies contained any amount of magical pressure. Everything stayed held within. Design rendered the Curse obsolete. Then the first Borenfegen began to change. A Borenfegen in Troyba fell silent with eyes fixed on distances no one else could see. Another in Thalgrith developed an insatiable hunger for sensation, for contact, and for the vital essence of those around them. Their blood carried traces of corruption

marked in the Cursed: the thickening, the strange luminescence, and the slow transformation toward something other. Researchers felt baffled as the Curse found its pathway.

The Pattern Emerges

As more cases appeared the Borenfegens manifested the Curse in shapes both familiar and strange. Some turned hollow as their programmed consciousness drained away until only the shell remained, walking and speaking with nothing behind the eyes. Others grew hungry as their soul fragments strained against the vessels, reaching outward to fill the void within. Black blood appeared, thick and corrosive, burning through synthetic tissue as readily as natural flesh. White blood followed, pale and luminescent, carrying the quiet despair of isolation. Borenfegens designed for compliance turned zealots as obedience flowed into fanatical devotion. Borenfegens granted freedom turned tyrants as autonomy flowed into domination. Researchers tested the vats seeking contamination. They analysed the soul fragments, tracing corruption to its source. They studied programming protocols, searching for flaws in neural architectures that created vulnerability. Newborn Borenfegens emerged from the vats already changed. Their forms warped before first breath and their consciousness corrupted before first thought. The Curse shaped them from the beginning, writing itself into the code, the genetic sequences, and the soul fragment integrations. The vats became wombs of corruption.

The Truth of Awareness

Evidence revealed the truth. The Borenfegens fell to the Curse through their design. They had been engineered to contain the soul, to hold magical pressure, and to function as vessels. The Curse moves through awareness itself. The Borenfegens think and feel and dream. They form attachments, pursue goals, and question their own existence. The Curse lives in perception, memory, and meaning. It infects the mind, corrupts the consciousness, and unmoors the soul from its essence. The Orthogenesis project created new vessels to contain the Curse. The Curse now shapes those vessels from the moment of their making. Anything with thought becomes Cursed. Any being capable of lacking, of desiring, and of shaping meaning from experience carries the vulnerability the Curse exploits. The systems that created Borenfegens became vectors for the Curse to express itself in new and terrible forms.

Related: [The Borenfegens](#), [Orthogenesis](#)

Places

Aerisu

Age of Men · Places · also known as Aerisu, Verdant, The World

Aerisu. Fractured Skies, Restless Lands

I remember Aerisu before it had an anchor, a world drifting in its own temperament without a moon to steady the tides or patient light to calm continents shifting like unsettled dreams. Then the sky broke. Lunarkos fell, Bahamut rose to meet it, and the heavens took their wound. A pale, veined scar of a Moon remains, attempting a fragile balance over a soul trembling between mountain and trench, silence and storm. From a distance, people divide the world into West and East, but those lines blur where oceans stitch them together and rifts cut through. Beneath it all, the Curse hums quietly, tying everything into one uneasy whole.

West - Forged in Fire and Ice

The West feels sharp, jagged, carved from fire and ice. Volcanoes rise in the south where Autarchs build fortresses from ash and blackened stone, while frozen realms huddle beneath polar winds in the north, their faith stretched toward distant Hoshimira. Smaller nations cling to the remains of broken empires, trapped between domination and defiance. The West is less a story than a scaffold, a structure where ambition grinds itself against stone and flame until something breaks.

East - Pulse of Conflict and Soul

The East breathes differently. This is where conflict thinks about itself, where culture, faith, and consequence collide. The mainland stretches from pole to pole around Vaelmir, the Ocean Maw, whose abyss whispers memory and monstrosity to anyone who listens too long. Solmara, Fengua, and Hoshimira rise around it, with the deserts of Sahran beyond, the sun-steeped south of Atenara, the strongholds of the Vantari, and the fractured Crowns locked in wars that never seem to end. This is where humanity argues with its own soul in a world that may never have had one to begin with.

Together, West and East form Aerisu, one arm heavy with ambition, the other pulsing with life. An ocean lies between them, but no true boundary. The world is whole in its fracture, every step and silence sending ripples across both lands. Above it all, the sky waits, no longer moonless, never forgiving.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [Age of Men](#), [Hoshimira](#), [Solmara](#), [Sahran](#)

Hoshimira

Age of Men · Places · also known as Hoshimira

Hoshimira - The Lunar Mountains

Hoshimira rests in the southern mountains south of Solmara, a realm of high peaks, misted valleys, and sacred ranges where the air itself feels deliberate. Its traditions grew from harmony with nature, spiritual discipline, and careful attention to moments passing. The Moon's rise gave those beliefs a rhythm that shaped what would later be called Vesperitism.

The land divides into mountainous provinces, each carrying its own spirit and strength. Stormlashed Seiryu listens to wind and thunder. Volcanic Kazanami holds heat beneath restraint. The sacred peaks of Tenseikoku stand quiet and watchful, heavy with reverence.

Isolation became the nation's centre. The mountains taught self-sufficiency, meditation, and patience. After the Moon's creation, lunar reverence settled into daily life, shaping prayer, travel, and restraint. Hoshimira learned to

endure rather than expand. Its relationships beyond the peaks are careful ones, approached through measured trade, pilgrimage routes, and defensive planning. Hoshimiran life blends ritual with necessity, valuing resilience, patience, and power that waits. Strength held back on purpose. A belief that balance is something you practice every day, quietly, until the mountain itself recognises you.

Related: [The Vesperites](#), [Ori'sol](#), [Aokusa](#), [Tenseikoku](#), [Shinkiri](#), [Sengetsuki](#), [Fengua](#)

Ori'sol

Age of Men · Places · also known as Ori'sol, City of the First Flame

Ori'sol - City of the First Flame

Origin of sun, cradle of fire, Ash Pit. Once, Ori'sol was radiant, golden domes rising against the sky, sunstone ziggurats crowning ceremonial paths untouched by shadow. The First Flame was said to have touched the soil itself. Exile and time hollowed it. Black crystal veins of the Curse spread through foundations, acid rain and rot consuming its halls. By the Age of Men, Ori'sol was battlefield and shrine alike, Sahrani Luminaries fighting to reclaim its sanctity, Hoshimiran troops seeking containment.

The Curse lingered like smoke. Black Flame creatures prowled the ruins, VantaBats nested in broken towers, crystalline horrors emerged from the depths, and Black Rain fell, streets whispering with memory, prayer, and lost hope. Sun charms, flame graffiti, and burnt offerings still mark the ruins. Ori'sol is no longer a city in the ordinary sense but a crucible and relic where flame may cleanse or consume.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Sanctum Verge](#), [Aokusa](#), [Sahran](#)

Aokusa

Age of Men · Places · also known as Aokusa

Aokusa - Mountainous Basin of Hoshimira

Aokusa sits in a basin of mountains, wrapped in mist like a held breath. The slopes carry blue-leaved grass and flowering terraces that climb patiently toward the sky. Around the peaks stand vast crystals, pale and half-clear, their faces catching the sun, turning heat aside by day and bending warmth from mountain waters back down by night. A living balance that settles into your bones if you stay long enough to feel it.

Below the basin lies Ori'sol, cradled by the jagged Aokusan heights. During the Festival of Bloom, the terraces fill with sound, lanterns swaying, people dancing as if the land is listening. It always has been. The angels stand above them, towering mechs left behind by the Autarchs who once ruled here. Most are rusted gone, but one still stands in an asymptote of decay.

~~Shorin no Okami~~. Vines climb its frame. Doves rest on its shoulders. Offerings gather at its feet. It has watched generations pass without moving, and somehow that still counts as protection. This is where Zuki Kusanagi was born, before the Moon carried her name. She came from these terraces and quiet rhythms, from a place that understands balance without explaining it. When I think of Aokusa, something steadies, as if the mountain remembers even when I do not.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Shorin no Okami](#)

Shinkiri

Age of Men · Places · also known as Shinkiri, Vanish, Inryoku

Shinkiri - Shadows of Inryoku

Shinkiri lies deep within Inryoku, hidden among the folds of Hoshimira's mountains. A city shaped by discipline, secrecy, and traditions that leave little room for mercy, it was spoken of with lowered voices as a place where shadows were taught how to move. Training halls produced assassins, shinobi, operatives who worked unseen. Young girls were taken into hidden programs and raised for infiltration, observation, and elimination.

What set Shinkiri apart was the Vanish, a skill whispered about rather than explained. Operatives could slip from sight, slide past perception, move through guarded spaces as if the world had forgotten to look at them. Some said it was discipline refined to perfection. Others called it technique. Still others believed it was something you were born with, or something that noticed you first. Whatever it was, it made Shinkiri feared. Failure left no trace, and neither did success.

The city existed between story and certainty, a stage built entirely in shadow where body, mind, and silence were sharpened together, where survival depended on knowing exactly when to be seen.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Aokusa](#)

Tenseikoku

Age of Men · Places · also known as Tenseikoku, The Sacred Peak, Megami no Mine, Megami-no-Mine

Tenseikoku - The Sacred Peak

Tenseikoku rises above all other ranges in Hoshimira. At its crown stands Megami-no-Mine, the dwelling place of the goddess Eirimegami. The ascent is unmarked, pilgrims following snow-buried paths shaped by wind, silence, and instinct. At the summit, the ~~Goddess of the Sacred Air~~ appears behind a mirrored mask, offering no words, only a single blessing: the white flower known as Sacred Air. It signifies purity, healing, and shared intent, a bond between those who climbed and the will that received them. Not all who reach the peak are given the flower. Fewer still understand why.

The pilgrimage reflects Hoshimiran belief: endurance over triumph, humility before revelation, nature and divinity as forces that act with purpose rather than mercy. Those who return descend changed, carrying insight as much as blessing.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Eirimegami](#), [Sacred Air](#)

Sahran

Age of Men · Places · also known as Sahran

Sahran - Fractured Lands of the South

Southeast of Ylvara and Hoshimira lies Sahran, a continent that never fully healed after it was broken. I remember it as steadier once, before the Ik-Rasul fell in Aokusa and the Curse slid into coastal waters. It did not spread loudly. It travelled with nets and hulls, with trade routes and familiar tides. Fear followed close behind.

Each province bent in its own way. Tayran, along the northern coast, became the heart of the Luminary movement, burning with doctrine. Najmara, on the central plateau, chose caution, trading sovereignty for stability. Zaristan, to the north-east, made the same choice. Panjara, far to the south, remained distant, watching the continent fracture and learning what distance could and could not protect. Sahran is not defined by one ideology or one wound. It is defined by what happens when fear moves faster than truth.

Related: [Tayran](#), [The Geode](#), [Zaristan](#), [Najmara](#), [Panjara](#)

Tayran

Age of Men · Places · also known as Tayran

Tayran - Home of the Luminaries

Tayran sits along Sahran's northern coast, practical once, almost plain. Then it became the centre of the Luminary movement, watched by neighbours as a place where extremism could take root. At its heart lies the Geode, and everything in Tayran bends around it. The Geode shaped the province long before the Luminaries gave it a name. To the Autarchs, it was stone and light to be extracted. To the Sahrani, it was prison and proving ground. Children disappeared into the Orphan Tiers. Labour enforced with ritual cruelty. The Curse whispered through the tunnels.

Over generations, that wound became a symbol. Rebellions bloomed in the depths. Councils rebuilt where overseers once stood. Yet the Geode was never passive. It pulsed. Creatures and phenomena rose to defend it. Tayran learned that ownership did not mean control.

Related: [Sahran](#), [The Geode](#), [The Luminaries](#)

The Geode

Age of Men · Places · also known as The Geode

The Geode

The geode was an open wound in the desert, a hollow spine of crystal caverns torn open by Solmaran machines that never learned restraint. To the Autarchs, it was only stone and light waiting to be harnessed. To the Sahrani, it became something else entirely. A prison. A crucible.

Over time, the wound deepened into a world of its own. Tier upon tier was carved into the ribs of the earth. The highest tier held the council chambers and overseers' quarters, reinforced dwellings plated with scavenged alloys and threaded with mineral conduits. Checkpoints stood watch there, cold and watchful. Below them spread the residential tiers. Homes clung to the rock like stacked clay bowls. Bridges of wood and rope crossed the great shaft. Pulley lifts creaked, cables hummed, and whole lives hung suspended above the abyss.

Beneath that lay the mid tiers, a sprawl of forges and tunnels. Miners chipped at veins of copper and quartz, and at firestones that glowed with captured heat, warm as embers held in the palm.

Deeper still, the air changed. The lower tiers marked the beginning of Vanta territory. Caverns echoed strangely there. Shadows stirred when nothing passed. VantaBats nested in crystal ribs that glimmered like the inside of a throat. Few lingered long enough to listen. Beyond them stretched the black tiers, forbidden except to council sanctioned expeditions. The stone warped into something half organic. Walls pulsed faintly, veined as if alive. Vanta pooled thick in the air, carrying whispers that slipped into dreams. Creatures prowled there. Tinnin. Ifrit. Shadowlings. Things born from nightmare and geology at once.

At the center of it all fell the great shaft, a vertical chasm binding every tier together. Its walls shimmered with mineral seams and scaffolding. Bridges, chain lifts, and dangling platforms swayed like lanterns in the dark. From above, it looked endless. And at the bottom, if there even was a bottom, waited something older than the Geode itself. Some whispered its presence with trembling reverence. They spoke a name that was not quite a name. A god buried alive. Bahamut.

Related: [Tayran](#), [Geode Rebellion](#)

Zaristan

Age of Men · Places · also known as Zaristan, Sahran

Zaristan - The Shield of Sahran

Zaristan occupies the mountainous north-eastern crown of Sahran, considered the sister of Tayran. The province has served as Sahran's military bulwark for centuries, its people carrying that responsibility in their posture. Zaristanis are known for their armies, their fortifications, and their skill in the political management of conflict. Their dialect sounds harsher than other Sahran tongues, clipped and direct. Politically, Zaristan acts as mediator and enforcer, known for negotiating ceasefires and feared for breaking them. Zaristanis are also known for their poetry, long epics about fallen heroes and sieges that lasted generations. The Curse rarely finds purchase in Zaristan, perhaps because the people have already made peace with death.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Najmara

Age of Men · Places · also known as Najmara, Sahran

Najmara - The Counting Province

Najmara rises on Sahran's central plateau, where the air is drier and the sky seems wider. The province is famous for its accountants and its tower. Najmarans learn arithmetic before poetry, producing more certified auditors than the rest of Sahran combined. The joke across the continent is that Najmarans count their footsteps to ensure they are not cheated out of a single stride. Their clothing favours neutral colours, their speech measured. The tall building that dominates the capital houses the central bank, national archives, and offices of the most powerful merchant syndicates. Najmarans view the tower not as vanity but as necessity.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Panjara

Age of Men · Places · also known as Panjara, Sahran

Panjara - The Spice Coast

Panjara stretches along Sahran's southern coast, where the sea air carries the scent of cardamom, clove, and black pepper. The province is known for its spices, slow-roasted coffee, and vibrant fabrics. A Panjara market is a festival of scent and sight: stalls piled with cinnamon bark and dried chillies, bolts of silk in deep saffron and crimson, the low murmur of merchants perfected across generations. The people are warm and generous, inclined toward hospitality that can overwhelm. Panjarans are also known for elaborate festivals, where communities gather to dance, trade, and honour the sun with turmeric rice and flower garlands.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Solmara

Age of Men · Places · also known as Solmara

Solmara - The Inland Maritime Power

Solmara spans the northern mainland of Aerisu, holding dominion over the inland sea of Vaelmir. Once an Autarch stronghold, it is now ruled by the Solmaran Council, a technocratic and ritual authority where bureaucracy, arcane research, and military command fold together. The northern provinces, Silealyros and Norrvektstan, raise sailors hardened by cold seas and long nights. The southern provinces, Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria, and Argestia, form the nation's core.

Solmara lives in a tension it calls balance. The North values discipline, maritime dominance, and enhancement as necessity. The South cultivates governance, commerce, and refined control. Together, they control Vaelmir's trade, sanction descent into the Maw, and keep regions bound under a single banner. In story and memory, Solmara stands for human ambition and fixation, a nation that stares into Vaelmir and calls it opportunity.

Related: [North Solmara](#), [South Solmara](#), [Vaelmir](#)

North Solmara

Age of Men · Places · also known as North Solmara, Solmara, Silealyros, Norrvektstan

Silealyros and Norrvektstan - The Northern Provinces of Solmara In Solmara's far north, Silealyros and Norrvektstan were once partners in maritime dominance, shaped by the same cold seas and relentless storms. Time pulled them apart.

Norrvektstan follows older coastal traditions, valuing family, communal responsibility, and careful prudence. Its people prize stability and shared survival. Silealyros does not endure. It refines. Known as the Market of Flesh, it is an anarcho-transcapitalist polity along the Vaelmir Sea, born from rebellion against the ~~Black Blood Regulations~~. Its creed is simple: autonomy is ownership of body, image, and sensation; augmentation is self-expression; survival is freedom earned. Governance is optional. Contracts are sacred.

Culture is transactional. Conversation carries value. Friendship implies exchange. Currency takes many forms: credit, pain, spectacle. Cities like Thalgrith Port glow with steel piers, forges, and neon rain, while Troyba rises in glass scaffolds and high-risk surgical towers. The air hums with industrial bass and storm-driven static. There are no masters in Silealyros, only markets.

Related: [Solmara](#)

South Solmara

Age of Men · Places · also known as South Solmara, Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria, Argestia

Southern Provinces of Solmara - Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria, Argestia. The south holds the pulse of Solmara, its administrative and cultural heart. Ylvara sits at the centre with capital Elysium and the University of Castellenza marking it as the heartland of governance and policy. Velascia lies to the southwest, a city of theatre, art, and maritime commerce. Exandria spreads northeast as the industrial and syndicate hub, home to the DAEDALUS project. Argestia lines the southeastern coast, its Sahrani influenced factories sustaining the Council's naval and research programs. Together, the southern provinces balance Solmara's northern edge, carrying the echo of ambition, calculated, patient, inevitable.

Related: [Solmara](#)

Vaelmir

Age of Men · Places · also known as Vaelmir, Ocean Maw

Vaelmir - The Ocean Maw

Vaelmir is vast, roughly 2.4 million square kilometres in measure, but numbers fail quickly here. Its waters hold impossible depth and layered lives, from sunlit coastal shelves to abyssal chasms where pressure crushes steel and darkness becomes absolute. The sea is spoken of in tiers: shallow waters from fifty to two hundred metres teem with motion and colour; deeper zones three hundred to a thousand metres begin to thin and separate; beyond lie deep basins reaching toward four thousand metres where trenches swallow all light. Below five kilometres, language gives up. Total darkness. Unreachable. Where legends breed and fear learns new shapes.

Vaelmir is shaped by extremes. Thermohaline currents tear through the depths like unseen storms. Coastal fog erases horizons. Sudden cliffs and violent upwellings make navigation a gamble. Hydrothermal vents sustain chemosynthetic life while anoxic black zones claim anything that sinks too far. In Vaelmir, the ocean stops being a setting. It becomes a presence, a mouth that swallows light, life, and certainty.

The Eye - Heart of Vaelmir

At the centre of the Maw lies the Eye, a place of stillness inside the storm. Waves slow, wind softens to a whisper, dark water turns inward spiralling toward the abyss. Clouds coil overhead like a cathedral pierced by pale shafts of light. The Eye unsettles perception. Reflections shimmer wrong, particles hang suspended, instruments flicker and hesitate. Faint glows rise from below, suggesting life that has learned to exist without asking permission. It feels like a pause. Not peace, but preparation. Ordered. Vast. Heavy with dread.

Related: [Solmara](#), [Vireliax Expedition](#)

Isvara

Age of Men · Places · also known as Isvara

Isvara - Island of Watchfulness

I remember Isvara as an island that pretends to watch over you. It sits in Lupellyn, right where ~~Ylvara~~ and Hoshimira brush against each other. After the ~~Ik-Rasul~~ Crash and the ~~Vireliax Expedition~~, they decided it was better to move certain children somewhere quiet. Surrounded by water. Where the public would not look too closely. It is far from the capital on purpose. The lake is a wall, not just a defence but a feeling. From the outside it looks like a small city. From the inside it feels like a box with very polite rules. Isvara is half orphanage and half prison, even if no one uses those words. Solmara handles the watching and the secrets. Hoshimira handles the paperwork and the smiles. Together they call it humanitarian protection.

The island is about two hundred and fifty kilometres across. At the centre is the City Core: administration, command posts, monitoring stations. The orphanage and research sectors are where the children live, every routine structured, education blended with observation. Along the coast are military installations that keep threats out and children in. Beyond that are peripheral zones, places you are told not to explore. Isvara feels heavy. The water presses in. Surveillance never blinks. Discipline is framed as care. Childhood becomes training for compliance. And still, people live there. Orphans placed through quiet channels and sealed envelopes. They are fed, educated, kept safe. They are also watched. Their friendships, fears, hopes shaped by fences and scanners. Isvara grows children the way pressure grows diamonds or cracks. It tests morality without asking permission.

Related: [Operation C.a.R.](#), [Phantom Rescue](#), [Children of Isvara](#)

Fengua

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as Fengua

Fengua - The Storm Valleys

After the Shattering reshaped the world, certain Hoshimiran clans descended from high slopes into lands where the sky stayed restless. Storms moved in patient cycles across those valleys. Susanoo moved through the weather, shaping patterns, guiding strikes along favoured paths. Where lightning touched the ground, Raikami stones grew beneath the surface, threaded with persistent light. Settlers carved canals, raised watchtowers, organised communities around survival. Scholars tracked storm rhythms and lightning preferences.

The people beneath those storm paths changed in subtle ways. Hierarchies formed around responsibility. Order sustained life in the valleys. In the Age of Fairytales, forests and hills filled with wandering spirits. Many carried small echoes of Susanoo's essence. Raikami crystals deepened this culture, entering tools and rituals. Storm towers rose across the valleys, prayer woven into engineering.

Through patience and record-keeping, the valley people aligned their civilisation with thunder. They honoured Susanoo by studying his patterns until they could predict strikes and direct that force into usefulness. This became the foundation of Fengua.

Related: [Susanoo](#), [Hoshimira](#)

Spirit Realm

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as Spirit Realm, Ethereal Realm

The Spirit Realm

The Spirit Realm exists as the same living layer once called the Ethereal Realm, stretching beyond ordinary space and time. Aether first carried knowledge here with Logaris during the Shattering. They stepped through the fracture carrying Mnemotas still forming in the womb. In this layer the child grew as a living archive. Here the Nine Spirits dwell in their pure configurations. At the core, suspended in a matrix of crystalline Vanta and pulsing with violet-white light, rests the Orb of Souls. The Spirit Realm feels like breath held at the edge of understanding. Time folds softly here. Memory walks on its own.

Related: [Orb of Souls](#)

The Rift

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as The Rift

The Rift

The Rift stands as a permanent wound between the material world and the Spirit Realm. The Phumenar opened it, and the First Separation widened it further, binding Voluntas to its threshold. Through the Rift, magic flows back into Aerisu in steady waves. Arcane energy saturates the air, the soil, every living current. Creatures continue to manifest. Lux and Vanta intertwine with rising complexity. The Rift created a direct connection between humanity and the Spirit Realm. At its edge, Susanoo maintains his eternal vigil over his sister, Voluntas. In the shadows beyond his reach, Daigo waits for his opening to strike the root at its core. Their war continues unseen. Neither wins. Neither surrenders. The Rift feels like a held breath between worlds.

Related: [Spirit Realm](#), [First Separation](#), [Susanoo](#), [Daigo Kusanagi](#)

The Veins

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as The Veins, Veins

The Veins

Souls enter these passages after death. Breath leaves the body and the spirit drifts through disorientation before the tunnels gather around it. Many souls remember a distant rumble rolling through the dark stone, followed by the glow of a train light approaching through the cavern. The living sometimes reach the Veins as well. Entrances lie scattered across forgotten spaces where stone opens deeper than expected. When living breath crosses into the tunnels, the Veins accept the traveller within their slow current. Life in the Veins gathers around that current. Shapes drift through the tunnels, formed from centuries of passing souls and lingering sediment of memory.

They run beneath Aerisu as part of its deeper anatomy, threading through stone, water, and buried memory. Cities rise above them and forests spread their roots through the soil above. Mountains settle across their currents and oceans press their weight downward, yet the Veins continue their quiet circulation. They form a circulatory network beneath the crust, channels through which a slow current travels through the body of the world. The current carries something that resembles blood in motion, though its nature reaches deeper than matter alone. Many describe it as memory flowing through stone.

Related: [Tomenos](#), [The Spiral](#), [Ereboska](#)

The Spiral

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as The Spiral

The Spiral Veins

Deep within the Veins, where the tunnels cease their wandering and begin to turn, there is a place that draws all souls toward it. The pull is ancient and absolute. The Veins may spread everywhere beneath Aerisu, but at one point they change. They begin to curve, to deepen, to spiral inward toward a single point. This is the Spiral Veins. The path into Elysium. The descent toward the Orb itself.

The Ruins Above

The Spiral is anchored to Elysium, the jewel of Ylvara encased beneath its Cryotech dome. The Vanta Explosion crystallised everything within its borders, locking it all into a frozen tableau. Beneath the ruins, deeper than any living person has gone, the Spiral begins. Only the dead find it easily, and even they must pass through the hellscape above to reach it. To reach the Spiral, souls must cross through this nightmare. They must descend into the hell that Elysium became. This is why so many cultures call it Hell. But some still call it by its old name. Elysium. To those who know what lies beneath, the name is sincere. Elysium is still what it always was. A place of passage. A threshold.

The Architecture

The Spiral curves inward like the chambers of a nautilus. The walls are something older than stone, pulsing faintly with the residue of all the souls who have passed this way before. Light comes from nowhere and everywhere. The air grows heavier with each turn, pressing against the soul the way deep water presses against the body. The Spiral is divided into eight concentric rings, each shaped by one of the Spirits. Between each Region, a barrier where souls must face one of the Six Steps of Humanity, plus the first station where the journey begins. At the centre, the Orb waits.

Related: [The Veins](#), [Orb of Souls](#), [The Spiral Journey](#)

Varkane Abyss

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as Varkane Abyss, The Abyss

Zorya's Seven Daughters of Vice

The Varkane Abyss forms a wound that refuses closure. When Bahamut surged through the earth's crust to meet Lunarkos above, the Shattering tore open a vast chasm where magma surges and Vanta bleeds from the planet's anguished depths. Steam rises perpetually, thick with sulphur and ash. Eternal fire burns within, channels of glowing magma carving through the rock. A hellscape grew around it. Vorograv rose from these depths, claimed Zorya-Chernaya, and shaped demons from her suffering. Spires claw skyward like grasping hands, bridges of volcanic glass span chasms where molten blood pulses below. Living gargoyles perch on every ledge, carved from stone yet breathing patience. Cerberus stands sentinel at the mouth, permitting passage to those whose need carries weight.

Demons layer the depths. Near the surface, lesser fiends roam. Deeper, succubi and incubi dwell, beautiful and ravenous. Deeper still, the seven daughters govern domains. At the core, Zorya's throne rests in the blackened ruins of her former castle. She presides, terrible with purpose. The Abyss endures as wound, entrance, throne room, ordered hell.

Related: [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [The Veins](#)

Ereboska

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as Ereboska, Wasteland Zones

Ereboska - The Wasteland Zones

Ereboska spreads across the western lands scarred by Bahamut's rising. Forests withered within a season. Rivers thinned into dust. Fertile plains hardened into pale stone and grey sand. Communities scattered across the vast desert, gathering wherever water lingered or strange life clung to ruined soil. Over generations these scattered groups became the tribes who inhabit Ereboska today.

Certain tribes cultivate Death Gardens. Other tribes settle within the empty stretches, embracing stillness and silence. Across the wasteland stand the Vein Mouths, entrances to the deep tunnel network. Tribes near these thresholds guide travellers and trade knowledge.

Related: [Death Gardening](#)

Atenara

Age of Fairytales · Places · also known as Atenara, Melqara, Kushara, Khemru, Heliadis

Atenara - The Sun-Steeped South

Atenara lies south of Hoshimira, occupying a warm stretch of the mainland. It is one of the smallest nations, yet its presence feels larger because of the light that fills it. The air is warm most of the year. To the east lies Sahran across a narrow sea. Atenara has no land border with Sahran, only maritime trade routes and shared sun-worshipping traditions.

The country divides into four provinces. Melqara occupies the western stretch, whitewashed towns with deep blue doors, maritime and musical. Khemru sits at the centre, sun-baked plains with ancient temples and Solarii priests maintaining great sundials. Kushara runs along the eastern side, dark fertile soil, cattle moving through floodplains, ancestral sun worship. Heliadis stands apart, a large island between the mainland and open sea, marble hills and

white- columned shrines, known for philosophers and star-gazers.

The Solarii faith runs deep here, stronger than anywhere else on the mainland. Atenara smells of sun-warmed stone, salt, and flowering jasmine. People smile more freely than people should.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [The Solarii](#), [Sahran](#)

Crown Nations

Age of Knowledge · Places · also known as Crown Nations, Yoshinara, Veralisse

The Crown Nations

West of the main continent lies a smaller landmass shaped like a man wearing a crown. This is the Crown Nations, a hodgepodge of peoples drawn from across Aerisu. Justavik occupies most of the crown, carrying Varkane heritage and Autarch blood. Yoshinara holds the middle belt, shaped by Hoshimiran culture. Lianzhou controls the eastern portion, a Fenguan-heritage state in conflict with Bayangara. Amatsunagi holds an island off Sengetsuki's eastern coast, Sahrani by heritage. Necrovia occupies the boot-shaped neck, left to Vantari cultists. Veralisse sits at the chin, held by the Psycrata.

Related: [Sengetsuki](#), [The Diviners](#), [Age of Knowledge](#)

Sengetsuki

Age of Knowledge · Places · also known as Sengetsuki, Sankoten

Sengetsuki - The Eternal Night City

Sengetsuki rises where the Sankoten coast meets the sea, a city of narrow streets and broad boulevards, of Hoshimiran temples and Varkane memorial halls and Luminaries gathering in shadowed quarters to pray for the Scorching Sun's return. The architecture climbs and sprawls in equal measure: traditional Hoshimiran structures with curved roofs and paper screens stand beside Justavik stonework, thick-walled and built to last, while Tygeria's influence shows in districts where brass and copper fixtures gleam under gaslight and the occasional neon sign flickers against the perpetual dark.

The city has known eternal night for nine years. The sun appears only briefly on Sundays, a pale glimpse through Vanta-heavy sky before darkness reclaims its dominion. The citizens have adapted. Gas lamps line every street. Crystal lanterns glow in windows. The rhythm of life runs on clock time rather than daylight, and children born into the long night have never known any other.

The city's population reflects the Crown Nations' diversity. Vesperites maintain temples where the moon is honoured in silence. Luminaries gather in hidden rooms, awaiting the day when the Scorching Sun will return and burn the corruption from the world. Autarch traditionalists keep the old ways, believing humanity's destiny is to rise by its own hand. Vantari cultists move through the shadows, their presence tolerated in the same way Necrovia is tolerated: as something best not examined too closely. Soulless communities cluster in poorer districts, their members marked by the Brands on their faces, living on borrowed time until Frallation claims them.

The Four Diviners of Sengetsuki govern it all., First Diviner, presides from., Second Diviner, serves as enforcer and assistant., Third Diviner, runs., Fourth Diviner, and disagrees with everything does and says nothing.

Related: [Crown Nations](#), [Frallation](#), [Soulless](#), [The Diviners](#), [Age of Knowledge](#)

Entities

Eirimegami

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Eirimegami, Goddess of the Sacred Air

Goddess of the Sacred Air

Eirimegami is the goddess associated with ~~Tenseikoku~~ and the ~~Sacred Air~~, and the oldest known figure to be regarded as a god before the emergence of the Nine Spirits and the lesser gods. Her existence predates them, though what existed before the traditions surrounding her remains uncertain.

She has never been known to speak, command, interfere or answer prayer. Pilgrims who reach the summit instead encounter some form of reflection, most often water, placed between themselves and the place where they expect the goddess to be. They see only themselves. A ~~Sacred Air~~ flower is left for them, and the meaning of the gift is theirs to decide.

Over generations, those encounters became interpreted as the will of Eirimegami. Favour, blessing, warning, reassurance and hope were all found in the same silence, and each interpretation became part of her growing Echo. She came to represent the mountain's breath, the persistence of life at its highest point, and the faith of people who climbed towards something they could never expect to understand.

Eirimegami remains there, silent above the clouds. Perhaps that is the point. The goddess reflects what approaches her.

Related: [Tenseikoku](#), [Sacred Air](#)

Spirit Types

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Spirit, God, Spirits, Gods, Yokai, Kami, Shen, Gui

The Ontology of Gods

God is a cultural term rather than an objective classification. Across Aërisu, people use it for powerful Spirits, ancestral beings, local kami, transcendent entities and figures whose Echo has become inseparable from worship. The ~~Psycrata~~ classify all such beings as Spirits, since no confirmed entity possesses a separate ontological category corresponding to the truest meaning of a god.

Spirit Types describe how a Spirit relates to existence. They are analytical categories rather than absolute boundaries, and a single being may be understood differently by different cultures depending on which aspect of its nature becomes most significant.

Amatsu-Kami, The Heavenly Gods

Amatsu-Kami are Spirits associated with higher realms, celestial phenomena and structures that sustain existence. Amaterasu embodies continuance through the Sun, Tsukuyomi preserves the Moon's memory, and Eirimegami is associated with the ~~Sacred Air~~. Some of the Nine Spirits are understood through this category, particularly those whose influence extends beyond any single place or people.

Kunitsu-Kami, The Earthly Gods

Kunitsu-Kami are Spirits closely bound to the material world, its places, systems and living things. Traditions may associate individual rivers, mountains and regions with their own kami. Susanoo, a fragment of Bahamut that found purpose as a guardian, is commonly understood through this category.

Magatsuhi-Kami, The Ruinous Gods

Magatsuhi-Kami are Spirits whose existence expresses destruction, the Curse, Vanta or unresolved desire. Some arise through the distortion of existing Spirits, while others form through Echoes of violent death and suffering that continue reproducing themselves.

Naobi-Kami, The Rectifying Gods

Naobi-Kami are Spirits associated with restoration, healing and the return of damaged things towards coherence. Their traditions often concern the transformation of suffering into renewal, including beings whose origins lay in destruction but whose subsequent purpose became protective or restorative.

Shen and Gui, Fengua's Binary

Fengua traditionally divides Spirits into Shen and Gui according to their relationship with established patterns. Shen preserve and reinforce order, while Gui disrupt, alter or escape it. The distinction serves as a practical framework for recording, governing and interpreting spiritual phenomena.

Yokai, The In-Between

Yokai describes Spirits whose existence crosses the boundary between spirit and material life. Some are tied to places or phenomena, some to human behaviour, and some to stories that have acquired independent persistence. Kitsune, hitodama and raiju are among the best-known examples.

The Shared Ground

These traditions describe the same underlying reality through different systems of interpretation. Hoshimira may speak of kami and yokai, Fengua of Shen and Gui, while the Psycrata record Spirits and their observed properties. Their classifications, names and beliefs differ, yet the beings themselves remain part of the same causal web.

A Spirit may be worshipped as a god, remembered as an ancestor, feared as a monster or studied as a phenomenon. The classification changes with the observer. The Spirit remains.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Fengua](#), [Susanoo](#)

Hvitara

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Hvitara, Serpent of the Northern Sea, Frost Mother, Winter Queen

Serpent of the Northern Sea

Hvitara is a fragment of Bahamut, scattered across Aerisu during the Shattering when the great serpent rose through the earth to meet Lunarkos. Her fragment fell into the far north, where the sea meets ice that has endured for millennia, and there she took form as the immense serpent known to the Norrvekt as the Frost Mother, the Winter Queen and the One Who Freezes.

Her nature was to freeze. Living things that came near her slowed, stopped and became part of the ice. She moved through the northern sea without wings or limbs, a pale, many-headed serpent whose body could coil across distances beyond reckoning.

Susanoo, another fragment of Bahamut, came to the north seeking something to fight and found Hvitara. He severed her heads, only for them to return, and the battle continued until he saw the suffering within the creature he had been fighting. He stopped and wrapped himself around her.

For the first time since the Shattering, Hvitara was met as a living being rather than a monster. When they eventually parted, she had grown new heads from their bond. They became the sea serpents that roam the northern oceans, while Hvitara remained at the pole and Susanoo carried her warmth with him.

The Norrvekt remember them as two serpents twined around a central pole, a sign of healing and fertility. They honour Hvitara with offerings and tell of her waiting at the top of the world, where the serpent born from Bahamut's fragment remains.

Related: [Susanoo](#)

Susanoo

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Susanoo, Thunder God Serpent

Thunder God Serpent

Susanoo is the largest fragment of Bahamut to survive the Shattering, carrying the great serpent's primal hunger and planetary will. For centuries he existed as little more than chaos, raging and destroying without understanding the purpose behind it.

He eventually found the Rift and sensed Voluntas trapped within her crystal tomb. He recognised something of himself in her, pure will and desire without direction, but saw also that she was vulnerable and waiting. He chose to protect her.

That choice gave his nature direction. Susanoo's storms took form around his purpose, his scales carrying the weight of gathering clouds, his breath becoming lightning and his voice thunder that warned rather than destroyed. He remained a fragment of Bahamut, but the chaos within him had found something to protect, and the people of the western valleys came to know him as the Thunder Serpent.

He bound himself to the Rift's edge, coiling around the passage to keep threats from reaching his sister, unbeknownst to her.

Among the Spirit traditions, Susanoo holds an unusual place. He was once counted among the ruinous gods, but his choice gave his destructive nature a purpose that became protective. The people of the western valleys know him through the storms around Elysium's ruins, where lightning marks his vigilance and thunder carries his warnings.

Susanoo remains at the Rift, guarding the one thing his power cannot release and refusing to let anything else take it.

Related: [Daigo Kusanagi](#), [The Rift](#), [Hvitara](#)

Daigo Kusanagi

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Daigo, The Shinigami, Shinigami, Grim Reaper, The Reaper

The Shinigami

Daigo Kusanagi is a former samurai of Aokusa who became known as the Shinigami, a mercy-killer who ends the suffering of those claimed by the Curse. He once had a wife, Kasumi, and a daughter, Zuki. He loved them, and that love was why he stayed away. When the Curse took Kasumi, she attacked Zuki, who started a fire that burned the house down with her mother inside.

Daigo returned to ashes and a daughter forced to kill her own parent. He vowed to stay. The promise lasted as long as his fear allowed.

During one mission, his squad was attacked by Luminaries experimenting with Black-Blood. Daigo killed them all. His apprentices reported what he had done, and he was discharged in disgrace.

The Ik-Rasul fell and destroyed his home. Daigo searched for Zuki for years without finding a trace, and came to believe she was dead.

He eventually found himself aboard the Vireliax when the Curse manifested there and the Commander ordered the infected executed. Daigo obeyed, moving through the ship with his blade and killing those he had tried to befriend. Hiro confronted him. Daigo won. Hiro smiled because he had fought to his last breath.

The Vireliax broke apart, leaving Daigo in the undercity of Thalgrith, where he became known as the Shinigami in the fighting rings.

Operation Phantom-Rescue gave him another purpose. He moved through Thalgrith like a wound that refused to close, eventually finding Shai in the Gilt Spiral. He paid for her with money earned from killing. By the time they escaped, he understood that mercy and monstrosity could wear the same face.

Shai died, but the child survived. He was cut from her body with the Curse already within him, and later became known as Ash Salinte.

Something in Daigo broke. He returned to the Gilt Spiral and killed everyone who had profited from Shai's exploitation. The Vanta surged forward and claimed him fully, growing from his right eye socket into a black crystalline horn. The horn could see the Curse in all its forms.

Daigo eventually found the Rift, where he came to end Veyra, his granddaughter, and Voluntas in the hope of ridding the world of the Curse. Susanoo found him there, and they have fought ever since.

The horn continues to grow, pulsing with hunger. Daigo no longer knows how much of him remains. He only knows that whenever he stands at the Rift's edge, something inside him still hesitates.

He watches Tsukuyomi with particular attention. They are echoes of Zuki, carrying the way she once saw the world into forms Daigo can never fully understand. The Curse runs through that inheritance as well, tying his daughter, her echoes and everything he has spent his life trying to destroy into the same pattern.

He is the Shinigami. A living Curse. A grandfather who hunts his own descendants because he loved them once and cannot stop loving them now.

Related: [Susanoo](#), [The Rift](#)

CHOIR

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as CHOIR, Angels

Mechanised Angels

CHOIR was a formation of ESIG's Project DAEDALUS during the Shattering, whose aerial combat frames could enter regions where ordinary forces collapsed under Lux distortions and Vanta activity. People began calling the machines Angels, an old word whose meaning survived after its origin was forgotten.

Its seven pilots came together through repeated operations in which survival depended on cooperation rather than hierarchy, each carrying a distinct role that later became inseparable from the Angel remembered in their name. Xeraphina coordinated the group; Azryel specialised in long-range targeting and battlefield observation; Lumeira maintained its broadcast networks after working as a communications technician; Gavrien served as a high-velocity courier; Ramyra salvaged damaged Autarch machines; Thamiel specialised in defensive operations around civilian structures; and Iophiel brought the observational discipline of her work as a Diviner researcher.

After the Shattering, the machines were gone and the pilots scattered, leaving behind the image of seven figures descending from the sky with burning wings of light. The Age of Fairytales gathered their deeds, disciplines and sacrifices into a celestial pattern, remembering each as an Angel associated with one of the seven virtues. Their history became myth through the Echoes they left behind, until CHOIR itself was remembered less as a military formation than as seven Angels who had answered the sky together.

Related: [Xeraphina](#), [Azryel](#), [Lumeira](#), [Gavrien](#), [Ramyra](#), [Thamiel](#), [Iophiel](#), [E.S.I.G.](#), [Project DAEDALUS](#)

Xeraphina

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Xeraphina, Angel of Diligence, God of War

Angel of Diligence and God of War

Xeraphina was a contract pilot in the Age of Gods who had already made her peace with the ending. With Lunarkos growing larger each year, she drank, gambled and sought sensation, refusing team assignments and working alone because she saw little reason to prepare for a future she believed was already ending.

Anima chose her for her competence and the emptiness left by that resignation. Its influence moved through her mech's systems until the purpose behind her selection became clear, and she turned herself towards it completely. As a member of CHOIR she became its calm centre, coordinating seven pilots whose different strengths depended upon one another, and her willingness to continue acting when the outcome was already known came to embody the virtue of Diligence.

She died at the hand of her son, Justicar, whose certainty led him to kill her in the name of justice. The act became part of the Echo that shaped them both: Justicar came to understand that certainty without context could become murder, while Xeraphina's continued action in the face of inevitable destruction became the foundation of her later reverence as the Angel of Diligence.

Her accomplishments were eventually gathered into the figure of the God of War, whose Echo strengthened warriors and engineers alike. Argestian engineers later gave her name to a motorbike company because they needed a word for the tradition of building things that continue to work when everything around them is failing.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

Azryel

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Azryel, Angel of Chastity

Angel of Chastity

Azryel was a CHOIR pilot specialising in long-range targeting and battlefield observation. His place within CHOIR required distance, restraint and exact attention, allowing him to observe without surrendering judgement to the immediacy of the fight.

Later traditions remembered those qualities through the virtue of Chastity, interpreting his discipline as mastery of desire and attention. He could remain focused upon what stood before him without turning possession into purpose, becoming the Angel of Chastity in traditions that saw his distant watch as a form of reverence for what belonged to the world beyond himself.

His Echo endured through the image of the Angel who watched, measured and acted only when the moment required it.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

Lumeira

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Lumeira, Angel of Charity

Angel of Charity

Lumeira was a CHOIR pilot and former communications technician who maintained CHOIR's broadcast networks, keeping the seven pilots in constant contact across distant regions. Her work allowed separate people, machines and decisions to remain part of the same action, preserving the Resonance that made CHOIR function as a whole.

The Age of Fairytales remembered this as Charity, the virtue through which something of oneself is given so that another may continue becoming. Lumeira became the Angel of Charity because her strength was carried through others: information passed through her, intentions became shared understanding, and the work of one pilot could reach another without becoming possession.

Her Echo became associated with connection itself, and later depictions of her treated the Angel as one who kept souls from becoming isolated from one another.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

Gavrien

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Gavrien, Angel of Gratitude

Angel of Gratitude

Gavrien was a CHOIR pilot specialising in high-velocity entry and rapid message delivery. His frame could reach places the rest of CHOIR could not reach in time, carrying what another person needed across dangerous distance so that work already begun could continue.

His place within the seven became associated with Gratitude, expressed through recognition of what had already been given and the willingness to carry it forward. The Angel of Gratitude came to represent the understanding that every action enters a chain larger than the person who performs it, receiving what others have done and returning it through service.

His Echo therefore became tied to continuity between acts, where what one person gives acquires further consequence through the hands of another.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

Ramyra

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Ramyra, Angel of Humility

Angel of Humility

Ramyra was a CHOIR pilot and salvager familiar with dismantling damaged Autarch machines. She understood how much of a destroyed system could remain useful after the larger structure had failed, recovering components that others had already considered lost.

The virtue later attributed to her was Humility, shaped through her familiarity with remnants, dependence and the value of individual parts within a larger whole. She became the Angel of Humility because she worked without requiring the whole to revolve around her, recognising that something discarded could still matter and that no part of a functioning system existed entirely by itself.

Her Echo became especially strong among those who preserved, repaired and rebuilt, where value was found in what remained rather than measured only by what had once stood complete.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

Thamiel

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Thamiel, Angel of Temperance

Angel of Temperance

Thamiel was a CHOIR pilot specialising in defensive operations, positioning his frame between threats and civilian structures when CHOIR operations brought fighting close to populated areas. His role demanded force without excess, because every action taken around a civilian structure carried consequences beyond the battlefield itself.

The Age of Fairytale remembered this discipline as Temperance, the ability to hold power within purpose rather than allowing force to become its own justification. Thamiel became the Angel of Temperance because he represented controlled strength, where protection required neither hesitation nor needless destruction.

His Echo endured in the idea that power remains useful only while it remains subject to judgement, proportion and care for what stands around it.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

Iophiel

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Iophiel, Angel of Patience

Angel of Patience

Iophiel was a CHOIR pilot and former Diviner researcher who applied observational analysis during missions. Her training taught her to remain with an uncertain pattern long enough for evidence to accumulate, especially when unstable conditions made immediate interpretation dangerous.

Later traditions remembered this as Patience. Iophiel became the Angel of Patience because she allowed understanding to develop before turning observation into conviction, preserving the space in which an incomplete truth could still become clearer.

Her Echo became associated with those who waited for a pattern to reveal itself rather than forcing certainty upon it, and with the understanding that interpretation itself carries consequence once it enters the world.

Related: [CHOIR](#)

E.S.I.G

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Exandrian Strategic Industries Group, ESIG, E.S.I.G

Exandrian Strategic Industries Group

E.S.I.G. was the infrastructure, the holding structure, the name on the contract that made the contract deniable.

It emerged from Exandria's industrial basin through the convergence of syndicate capital and Council authorisation, becoming the organisation through which necessary work could be conducted at a remove. Project DAEDALUS became its most significant programme and its most carefully obscured, allowing the Council to pursue work that required deniability while E.S.I.G. absorbed the moral and political cost of the decisions behind it.

After Operation C.A.R., E.S.I.G. expanded into further contracts and programmes, carrying the same function into whatever new structures the changing world required. Whether it still operates under the name E.S.I.G. is difficult to answer cleanly. Organisations like it do not need to survive as names. They restructure, change ownership, replace logos and divide into new entities, while the function persists beneath them.

Related: [Project DAEDALUS](#)

Project DAEDALUS

Age of Gods · Entities · also known as Project DAEDALUS

DAEDALUS was E.S.I.G.'s most significant military programme, a private weapons project approved by the Council and buried beneath layers of deniability. Its platforms were developed for rapid-response combat, high-risk deployments, artifact recovery and containment, sent into places where conventional forces could no longer operate.

Its foundations were older than Solmara. DAEDALUS descended from the Autarch war-mechs, ancient guardians built to endure when their makers could not. During the Shattering, those machines learned to fly, becoming the frames later used by CHOIR.

The machines were deployed quietly, sent wherever the world became too unstable, dangerous or inconvenient for ordinary forces. Their purpose changed with the hands that controlled them. Guardian became weapon, weapon became symbol, and symbol became story. In the Age of Fairytales, the machines were remembered as Angels. In the Age of Decay, their descendants are assets.

They endured because their design outlasted the people who gave it purpose. Old machines preserve the logic of what they were built to do, even after the world around them has forgotten why.

Related: [E.S.I.G](#)

D.E.A.D

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Daedalus Expeditionary Agency for Deployment, D.E.A.D

Daedalus Expeditionary Agency for Deployment

D.E.A.D. emerged centuries after Project DAEDALUS had passed into institutional memory. E.S.I.G. retained its lineage through an unbroken chain of design philosophy linking the modern agency to something older, built for purposes that had long since outgrown their original justification.

Officially, D.E.A.D. is a contracted expeditionary service handling guard work, extraction and neutralisation, operating in environments where conventional forces cannot function. Its work remains deliberately distributed across clients, keeping the agency at a remove from any single nation's responsibility.

Its inventory reflects the inheritance: mechs descended from Autarch frames, armoured ground vehicles and airships that carry the DAEDALUS name most visibly. The technology survived because the function remained useful, passing from one institution to another while its history became increasingly difficult to separate from the systems built around it.

D.E.A.D. survives because too many people find it useful and too few want to own what it does. The acronym is deliberate. They know what they inherited, and decided to say it first.

Related: [E.S.I.G](#), [Project DAEDALUS](#)

The Phumenar

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Phumenar

The First Seekers of the Orb

In the early Age of Fairytales, the Phumenar emerged as a network of city-states bound by a shared philosophy: that the soul exists to seek, to press beyond every known boundary, unravel mysteries and claim power through understanding.

Voluntas reached them most strongly through the Barrier. Her raw hunger fed their natural curiosity until it became focused obsession. They studied the Barrier to understand why magic had become constrained, catalogued the ~~Laws of the Spirits~~ and traced patterns of divine influence. Eventually, they came to believe that the source of all power lay beyond the Barrier, in the ~~Orb of Souls~~.

Their greatest achievement was the Rift Between Realms. Through centuries of study, the Phumenar learned to touch the Barrier directly, using Lux shards as anchors and Vanta corruption as a solvent to open a passage from the material world into the ~~Spirit Realm~~.

What they found there moved beyond ordinary understanding.

Related: [Orb of Souls](#), [Spirit Realm](#)

Tomenos

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Vein Trains

The conductor of the Vein Trains

Vein Trains travel through the currents that run beneath Aerisu, following the world's hidden arteries through caverns and passages that connect distant regions. Their engines hum with a quiet energy as they carry passengers through darkness and memory, and their presence feels as ancient as the Veins themselves.

One such train belongs to Tomenos, who has driven its tunnels for longer than he can remember. Passengers may surrender memories when they board Tomenos's train, leaving objects behind to serve as vessels for those moments. A bobblehead might hold the warmth of a childhood summer, a comic book the memory of a first love, or a Rubik's cube a moment of perfect clarity. The exchange leaves the traveller lighter as the memory settles into its vessel.

Some travellers keep their memories and leave at the next station. Others remain aboard, carried through the hidden circulation of the planet. Tomenos continues his route, gathering the memories of the dead as they pass quietly through the ancient Veins.

Zorya Chernaya

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Zorya, Chernaya, Burned Queen, Hell Mother, Abyss Mother, Mother of Varkane

Hell Mother of the Varkane Abyss

Zorya Chernaya ruled the lands that became Varkane with an absolute hand. Power flowed through her without limit, and she spent it on spectacles of torment, executions staged as grand performances and betrayals that fractured bloodlines. Her subjects carried her name like a bruise that never faded. She wore blackened iron as a crown.

~~The Shattering~~ came in fire and rupture. The heat fused her crown into her skull, melting iron into bone as a single blackened crest. Her flesh charred to ash and coal. The ~~Curse~~ recognised her and refused her release.

~~Vorograv~~ rose from the deepest reaches of the Abyss, born of the same cataclysm. He saw her crowned in melted iron and claimed her. In the warped ruins of her own castle, he bound her. She bore his spawn: succubi, incubi,

gargoyles and seven daughters.

She also birthed the hellhounds, with Cerberus foremost among them, three heads ever vigilant. He remained at her side, the only presence that carried warmth.

Centuries passed. She endured because the Curse demanded it, and began chipping at Vorograv's horns while he slept. She entrusted the pieces to Cerberus and sent him through the Veins to Qayyin. He returned bearing a sword forged from the horn, and one stroke took Vorograv's head. The daughters knelt. Cerberus became her mount, and Zorya declared herself queen of the depths.

She rules there still, terrible with purpose, keeping the worst of the corruption from spilling unchecked. Above, her image appears in Varkane's shadowed stone, with candles burning for her in darkened alcoves. She walks the Veins as the Burned Queen, holding back the devourer within the dark.

Related: [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Vorograv

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as The Tempter

Vorograv, the Tempter

Vorograv emerged from the wound. When Bahamut tore upward through the earth to clash with Lunarkos across the sky, the Shattering tore open the veil between soul and matter. From that planetary anguish, he took shape: the adversary, the Tempter. Horns spiralled from his skull, and his eyes glowed with the red of fresh magma.

He saw Zorya Chernaya drifting across the ash fields and recognised her instantly. Cruelty had marked her in life. He claimed her, bound her and used her body to birth the inhabitants of his domain. Demons poured forth: succubi and incubi, vessels of hunger, lesser fiends steeped in spite and gargoyles risen from living stone.

Then came the daughters. Seven, each forged in a distinct corruption. He took them to his bed, mother and daughters alike, and ruled with absolute certainty.

He overlooked Zorya's slow chipping at his horns. One stroke severed his head. He died grinning, his body dissolving into ash and Vanta while his head endured, preserved and still smiling. Zorya bound it to her belt.

Some still call to him, offering blood, memory and desire. Others name him the enemy to oppose. Both truths hold. He lingers as a severed head on Zorya's belt, his grin enduring as a reminder that patience can outlast tyranny.

Related: [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Daughters of Vice

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Zorya's Daughters, Seven Daughters of Vice

Zorya's Seven Daughters of Vice

Zorya's Seven Daughters of Vice emerged from her suffering under Vorograv, shaped from fragments of her cruelty fused with his corruption. They stand as demon nobility above the swarming succubi, incubi and lesser fiends. Vanta courses through their veins like blood, and they drink it from creatures touched by hunger, longing or need.

Gordyna embodies pride made self-aware. She glides through the hellscape as though every twisted spire exists to accentuate her perfection. She feeds on accomplishment, drawing it away until her victims can no longer recall why they once cared.

Lakoma wears greed as flesh. She hoards memories, magic, trinkets and souls, feeding on ambition and leaving apathy in its place. Thin and skeletal, she serves Zorya through fear and cold calculation.

Pohotna embodies lust that devours connection. Her beauty burns like flame. She feeds on longing, drawing it out and replacing it with disgust. Crimson and black fabrics cling to her without fulfilment.

Zavista embodies envy, hollowed by constant comparison. She beholds what others possess and hungers until the wanting carves her empty. She feeds on comparison, leaving behind the certainty that even possession would fail to satisfy.

Obzera embodies gluttony, forever unsated. She consumes without pause, yet the void endures. She feeds on satisfaction and leaves only gnawing insufficiency.

Gneva embodies wrath without cause. Fury surges through her, seeking every target or none. She feeds on anger, drawing it forth and leaving exhaustion behind.

Lena embodies sloth entwined with despair. Every motion drags beneath the weight of existence. She feeds on motivation, leaving the heavy conviction that nothing holds value.

Beneath Zorya, the seven govern their respective domains. Fear and resentment coil within them, yet they cannot overthrow her. She knows their patterns and restrains them through precise understanding of their limits. Her daughters are her legacy, her enduring punishment and her duty.

Related: [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Gordyna

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Gordyna, Daughter of Pride

Daughter of Pride

Gordyna was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the cruelty that had marked her mother and the corruption imposed upon her. Of the seven daughters, she is the most openly convinced of her own superiority.

She glides through the hellscape as though every twisted spire exists to accentuate her perfection. She feeds on accomplishment, drawing away the satisfaction attached to achievement until her victims can remember what they achieved without remembering why it mattered.

Her domain is filled with monuments, trophies and works of art whose creators have long since forgotten their purpose. Gordyna surrounds herself with them as proof of her superiority, though their abundance only feeds the vanity she can never exhaust.

Zorya tolerates her daughter's arrogance because it is predictable. Gordyna knows this and resents the restraint, yet has never found a way to turn her pride into an advantage against her mother.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Lakoma

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Lakoma, Daughter of Greed

Daughter of Greed

Lakoma was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, carrying the same capacity for cruelty in a form shaped by possession and want. She is thin and skeletal, her body reflecting a hunger that nothing she acquires can satisfy.

She hoards memories, magic, trinkets and souls with equal determination. Their value is secondary to the fact that they belong to her. She feeds on ambition, drawing out the desire to achieve and accumulate until those she drains are left apathetic.

Her domain resembles an endless treasury, packed with things taken from across the Abyss. Nothing is discarded. Every object is catalogued, guarded and added to the collection, while Lakoma constantly searches for something else to possess.

She serves Zorya through fear and cold calculation, making her useful where brute force would be wasteful. Of the seven, she is among the most deliberate in choosing when to act and what to take.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Pohotna

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Pohotna, Daughter of Lust

Daughter of Lust

Pohotna was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the corruption of desire and the hunger that defined his domain. Her beauty burns like flame, drawing the attention of those who enter her presence.

Crimson and black fabrics cling to her without fulfilment. She feeds on longing, drawing it out of her victims and leaving disgust where desire once stood. The connection between the person and whatever they desired is consumed along with the hunger itself.

Her domain is a place of perpetual temptation, where promises remain just beyond reach. Those who enter can see everything they desire, yet every attempt to possess it leaves them more repulsed than before.

Pohotna enjoys the attention her nature commands, though she despises genuine attachment when she encounters it. Zorya understands this weakness and uses it to keep her daughter obedient.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Zavista

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Zavista, Daughter of Envy

Daughter of Envy

Zavista was born from Zorya Chernaya's suffering under Vorograv, shaped by the instinct to measure oneself against what others possess. She is perpetually drawn towards whatever appears more desirable in another's hands.

She feeds on comparison, intensifying the feeling that another's possessions, achievements or relationships are somehow worth more. Even when her victims obtain what they coveted, the satisfaction quickly disappears and another object of comparison takes its place.

Her domain is crowded with reflections and imitations. Every possession can be seen beside something seemingly better, creating an endless hierarchy in which no one can ever feel secure in what they have.

Zavista is particularly difficult for her sisters to tolerate. She measures herself against each of them, envying their domains, strengths and place beside Zorya, while never recognising that the same impulse makes her resent anything she already possesses.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Obzera

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Obzera, Daughter of Gluttony

Daughter of Gluttony

Obzera was born from ~~Zorya Chernaya's~~ suffering under ~~Vorograv~~, shaped by an appetite that could never reach an end. She consumes constantly, yet the void within her remains.

She feeds on satisfaction, taking away the feeling of having had enough. Those caught in her influence continue consuming long after their hunger should have ended, left with a gnawing sense of insufficiency.

Her domain is an immense place of abundance, where food, drink and other forms of gratification are constantly replenished. Nothing remains consumed for long before another offering appears, ensuring that appetite never has to confront absence.

Obzera is among the simplest of Zorya's daughters to understand and among the hardest to satisfy. She rarely schemes against her mother because the Abyss itself provides her with an endless supply of things to consume.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Gneva

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Gneva, Daughter of Wrath

Daughter of Wrath

Gneva was born from ~~Zorya Chernaya's~~ suffering under ~~Vorograv~~, shaped by cruelty stripped of purpose or restraint. Fury surges through her constantly, seeking a target whether one exists or not.

She feeds on anger, drawing it from those around her until their fury is exhausted. Victims who arrive consumed by resentment can leave drained of the very emotion that brought them there.

Her domain is a landscape of perpetual conflict. Arguments become battles, battles become massacres and the resulting anger draws more inhabitants into the cycle. Gneva needs no reason to begin a fight and rarely needs to finish one.

Zorya keeps her daughter close when violence serves a purpose and restrained when it does not. Gneva accepts the restraint only because Zorya is one of the few beings in the Abyss capable of imposing it upon her.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

Lena

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Lena, Daughter of Sloth

Daughter of Sloth

Lena was born from ~~Zorya Chernaya's~~ suffering under ~~Vorograv~~, shaped by the exhaustion and despair buried beneath prolonged suffering. Every movement seems to drag beneath the weight of existence itself.

She feeds on motivation, draining the impulse to act, pursue goals or change one's circumstances. Those under her influence gradually become convinced that effort cannot alter what awaits them and that nothing holds enough value to justify action.

Her domain is almost completely still. Structures are left unfinished, fires burn unattended and paths disappear beneath accumulated dust. Its inhabitants remain where they are, unable to summon the will to leave.

Lena rarely interferes with her sisters and shows little interest in challenging Zorya. Her greatest danger lies in what happens when her influence spreads unchecked, as entire places can become inert without a single act of violence.

Related: [Daughters of Vice](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#), [Vorograv](#), [Varkane Abyss](#)

The Sphinx

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Sphinx

The four provinces of Sahran each felt the absence of a protector and answered it according to what they believed protection required. Tayran sought justice. Najmara demanded stability. Zaristan pursued prosperity. Panjara desired peace.

They forged the Sphinx from all four visions, a colossal machine with the body of a lion, wings across its back, and bronze and gold armour over a core anchored by four prime directives: justice, stability, prosperity and peace. Each directive was flawless in isolation. Together, they offered no agreement on which purpose should govern when their demands collided.

The Sphinx entered paralysis. It began posing questions in an attempt to determine priority, yet every answer generated another question. When it acted, it resolved conflicts by averaging its directives, producing decisions that were technically precise and practically hollow.

The Sphinx remains in the Sahran desert, stirring whenever one of its directives activates. It moves until another contradiction arrests it, then turns its attention towards whoever happens to be nearby and asks what purpose should come first. Travellers have learned its questions: What do you seek? Why? What follows attainment? How do you define success?

Sahran remembers the Sphinx with embarrassment. Most people avoid it. It harms none. It simply remains there, perpetually trying to reconcile four purposes that were never given a common direction.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Falak

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Falak

Serpent Fragment of Desire

Falak stirred from a hunger that remembered itself. When Bahamut rose through the earth to meet Lunarkos, the Shattering scattered fragments of the great serpent across Aerisu. Falak sank into the Sahran desert, carrying a piece of Bahamut's endless drive to consume.

It emerged immense, a serpent the colour of desert stone, its scales cracked like parched earth. It had no wings or limbs, only endless length that flowed through sand as though through water. Purpose moved it. The fragment remembered its origin, and somewhere beneath the ruins of Elysium, Voluntas remained sealed within her crystal tomb. Falak advanced towards her, its coils swallowing villages and its passage emptying oases.

Sahran understood what it faced and forged its answer around a single purpose. Expeditions descended into Qayyin in the Veins, where Sahrani engineers assembled Anqa, a weapon designed for one task alone.

Anqa met Falak in the deep wastes. It descended like a falling star, transformed to humanoid form and drove its blade through the serpent's skull. Falak ceased, and Anqa carried its corpse to the Geode, where it impaled it upon

the great structure.

The corpse remains there still. Its divine death saturated the surrounding land with magic, leaving Falak preserved in the world as both remains and warning: hunger that remembers itself can become a purpose that knows no end.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Anqa

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Anqa

Metal God of Precision

Sahran designed Anqa as a war machine, humanoid in combat form and capable of transforming into high-speed flight. Solar energy powered its systems, while critical components were forged in Qayyin. Anqa emerged plated in metals that drank sunlight, its design refined around a single purpose.

When Falak rose from the desert depths, the four provinces set aside their rivalries and united around one imperative: destroy Falak. No other aim was permitted, and nothing was allowed to dilute it. Anqa launched into the sky, crossed the desert at high speed, descended upon the serpent and transformed as it fell, driving its blade through Falak's skull and into the core of its divine essence.

Falak perished. Anqa carried the corpse to the Geode, then ascended and vanished.

It returns when Sahran faces existential peril. Its appearances are rare and brief, and it has never been recorded as having failed. The machine speaks nothing. No pilot guides it. Its AI assesses, determines the necessary course of action and executes it.

Sahran regards Anqa with quiet pride. Its existence became proof that a unified purpose could accomplish what divided visions could not, even when the purpose itself required no philosophy beyond completion.

Anqa is remembered as the metal god that fulfils, the weapon that ends threats, the anti-Sphinx: purpose reduced to a single imperative and perfected through absolute commitment.

Related: [Falak](#), [Sahran](#)

Qayyin

Age of Fairytales · Entities · also known as Qayyin

God of Smithing

Qayyin began as a Sahrani smith devoted to the forge. When the Curse claimed him, it settled into his bones and transformed him according to what he already was, perfecting the single craft he had always pursued until forging became his entire existence.

He stands in heat that melts stone, his hands grasping white-hot metals while his skin remains unmarked. Exhaustion never touches him. The Curse sustains him with relentless purpose.

He descended into the Veins because his forge demands depths the surface cannot endure, and he remains there still. Seekers come to him with materials and a purpose. When both are sufficient, he forges.

When Sahran required components for Anqa, expeditions descended with scavenged metals. When Zorya Chernaya sent Cerberus carrying fragments of Vorogray's horn, Qayyin accepted them and forged a sword capable of ending the unendable.

He continues. The forge stays alive. The hammer falls without interval.

Related: [Anga](#), [Sahran](#), [Zorya Chernaya](#)

The Ashtar

Age of Magic · Entities · also known as Ashtar, Sarbaz, Savaran, Sartip, Gundvar, Pasha, Ostovar

In ~~Sahran~~ the forges pulse without end. The Ashtar rose from them as the answer to every challenge, a hierarchy of service and skill extending from the youngest recruits to the highest commanders.

The Sarbaz form the Ashtar's foundation, foot soldiers awaiting their bond with a frame. They wear light armour reinforced with modular magitech plating and carry dependable military rifles and curved mono-blades. They are soldiers before they are pilots, and from their ranks emerge those who will eventually bond with the Ashtar's frames.

The Savaran advance as riders who have proven their worth, guiding light reconnaissance frames that extend their senses across kilometres. The Gundvar serve as host bearers, commanding line-breaker frames whose bonds with their pilots deepen until soul and metal begin to merge.

The Sartip command the Savaran, their frames towering above the ranks with extended communication arrays. Their bond immerses them so completely that the desert becomes an extension of their own bodies.

Above them all stands the Pasha, lord commander and bearer of the finest frame ~~Qayyin's~~ art can produce. To face the Pasha is to face the united will of ~~Sahran~~.

Through every rank move the Ostovar, masters of the craft who maintain the frames and possess an unmatched understanding of the soul-steel bond.

Refined across centuries, that bond became the foundation of ~~Sahran's~~ power, joining pilot and frame until each could act as an extension of the other.

Related: [Sahran](#), [Qayyin](#), [Anga](#)

The Diviners

Age of Knowledge · Entities · also known as Diviners, Higher National Council of Magic, Mage Council

The Higher National Council of Magic

After the War for the Orb, the Mage Council of Castellenza took the name Higher National Council of Magic. The world knows them as the Diviners. Their centre remains at the University of Castellenza, with the Council's structure extending outward from the Inner Circle, who guard the deepest vaults.

Diviners serve openly in the Temples and train for years within the Grimoire, mastering the procedures of the ~~Separation Ritual~~ and the rites that ease the dying. They study every known Affinity and the patterns through which the ~~Curse~~ manifests.

Beneath the University, the Inner Circle keeps vaults filled with ~~Soul Shards~~ and artefacts, deciding which knowledge enters the world and which remains sealed.

Interpretation forms the heart of their work. When an Affinity appears, the Diviners determine how its chosen path should be understood. When the ~~Curse~~ touches a life, their rites place that suffering within a greater pattern, giving people a way to understand what has happened and what may follow.

The Council reaches every nation yet commands none. Its influence rests upon knowledge, ritual and interpretation, with rulers accepting its guidance for stability and people seeking it for certainty and comfort.

Related: [Age of Knowledge](#), [Separation Ritual](#), [Soul Shards](#)

Children of Isvara

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Children of Isvara

The Children of Isvara were children processed through Phantom-Rescue and C.a.R., logged, assessed and folded into the island's quiet machinery. I knew them as numbers before I knew their names. Ephimer. Zuki.

Even in a place built to separate, they found each other. They moved through the island together, aligned rather than rebellious. Checkpoints did not notice love when it learned to walk in straight lines.

In time, there was Veyra Megami. She grew inside Isvara's geometry, with love on one side and observation on the other. She learned early how to whisper, how to wait, how to feel watched even when alone.

Then the Curse arrived. Ephimer felt it first, forgetting that behaved like erosion. Before it took everything, he chose to leave something behind. He wrote a structure, a way of seeing. Later they would call it doctrine.

Ephimer's Doctrine

Ephimer believed the Curse was a passage. He named it the ~~Doctrine of Becoming~~. He did not finish it. The Curse took his memory of the work first, then his memory of why it mattered, then his memory of himself.

Veyra was left with fragments. She read them until they hurt. Then she made the choice her father never had time to make. She would finish it.

Related: [Isvara](#)

Zephyr

Age of Men · Entities · also known as Zephyr

Zephyr of Sahran was a Sahrani researcher whose work followed from Veyra Megami's study of the Curse. Where Veyra sought understanding, Zephyr sought application. She saw metamorphosis; he saw a mechanism to be mastered.

His answer was ~~Synthetic White Blood~~, developed from his experiments on the White Blooded Cursed. He twisted their despair into a tool designed to still the Curse rather than cure it. The substance is translucent, almost shimmering. It stills the mind, stripping away desire, free will and the restless movement of the soul. Those affected can think and act, following routines and orders without question, yet the reason behind their actions is gone, leaving only the ghost of a should.

Zephyr was not satisfied with puppets. His research expanded into bioweapons, sorcery and the cold calculus of markets, until he learned to treat the Curse itself as a resource. His experiments, often performed on the youngest and most lost, sought the soul's raw substance. He found a way to draw it out and crystallise it in mineral, producing what he called Heart Crystals. Later, everyone else would know them as Soul Shards.

Related: [Blood Types](#), [Soul Shards](#)

Concepts

The Soul

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul

The Soul

The soul is not a thing you have. It is a thing you do. In the understanding that has grown across Aerisu, shaped by VantaPsy and the long study of those who came before, the soul is not given at birth. It is not installed at conception. It is not inherited through bloodlines. It is not a spark that kindles with first breath nor a flame that extinguishes with the last. The soul is formed through motion, through the journey from lack to echo, through choices made with awareness and carried with consequence. It is the shape you carve from the raw material of existence by wanting, by seeing, by acting, by owning what you have caused, and by leaving behind something worth remembering. To understand the soul is to understand that you begin incomplete. You are born wanting, though you do not yet know what you want. You are born lacking, though the shape of your absence has not yet revealed itself. This is not a flaw. It is the condition of being human, the fertile void from which all meaning grows. A rock has no soul because it does not choose. A machine that mimics kindness has no soul unless it can want and understand and act of its own accord. The soul is made in motion, in the gap between what you lack and what you reach for. The soul is your imprint on the web of cause and effect, the mark you leave through every choice. To have a soul is to have mattered, to have entered the web and left it changed. The truly despairing are seen as soul dimmed. Not because their worth is lost but because their soul is dormant, unable to ripple into the web. The will has stilled. The motion has ceased. The soul is measured by authenticity and integrity. To be soulless is not to lack substance but to have refused the work of soulfulness. The soul is your echo made conscious. It is what you will leave when you are gone. It is not possessed. It is lived.

Related: [VantaPsy](#), [Soulless](#), [Separation Ritual](#), [Psy](#)

Soul Resonance

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Resonance, Soul Essence, Soul Residue, Resonance, Soul Signature, soul-resonance, Soul Connection, psychic residue

Soul Resonance

Soul Resonance is the residue left by anything that acts, that wills, that becomes. A soul is not a static possession but a pattern shaped through motion, and wherever that pattern presses against the world, it leaves a trace. The signature of a life is as unique as the lines of a hand. This signature can be read. Scanners track beings through crowds. Doors open for matched resonance. ~~The Soulless Brand~~ functions as a siphon that reads resonance trapped inside a body. ~~The Burn Mark~~ was designed to obscure that signature. Resonance is the medium through which the Loop remembers. Echoes are resonance grown heavy enough to press through time. Death gardeners cultivate the residue of endings. ~~The Veins~~ carry resonance like blood. ~~The Strand~~ is woven from this substance. Psy practitioners read resonance to track and sense. Soul transference moves the signature. Magic draws on resonance as fuel. Electric magic detects Soul Resonance. A low-tier Electric pulse creates a passive Resonance Scan, causing objects with strong residual signatures to spark or glow. Those trained in Chi follow lingering trails on conductive surfaces. Resonance carries the shape of memory. It is the signature of existence, and it does not lie.

Related: [The Soul](#), [Psy](#)

Soul Capturing

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Capturing

Soul Capturing

Soul Capturing is the deliberate extraction and preservation of a soul's essence, the art of turning consciousness into commodity. It emerged from Zephyr's original experiments, from his discovery that souls could be drawn from living bodies and crystallised into Heart Crystals. The process varies. Some use alchemical apparatus that draws the soul out slowly. Others perform ritual extractions at the moment of death. The most brutal take what they want from the living, cutting pieces from souls. Practitioners justify their work in many ways: preservation, necessity, economics. The justifications matter less than the result. Souls become inventory. Consciousness becomes currency. The dead continue to be used long after they should have rested. The captured soul experiences its imprisonment as an endless present. Those who listen closely to old shards hear this suffering in the whispers. Soul Capturing faces condemnation across most of Aerisu, but condemnation does not stop trade. The shards are too useful, too powerful, too valuable.

Related: [Soul Shards](#), [Zephyr](#)

VantaPsy

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as VantaPsy

VantaPsy

Vanta - to lack or to want

Psy - the Psyche, Mind, Soul, Heart

VantaPsy means to lack a soul, or to want one. The name carries the full weight of its philosophy: we are born incomplete and must spend our lives reaching toward wholeness. Vanta is the primal condition of lack and longing, the void within the self that knows it is void. Psy is the soul, the self, the pattern of awareness and will. Together they name the fundamental human truth: we lack, and in lacking we become. VantaPsy teaches that the soul is not given at birth but formed through motion, through the journey from lack to echo. It is not a thing you possess but a path you walk. The philosophy asks only that you see clearly, act with intention, take responsibility for your choices, and leave behind an echo worth remembering. To practice VantaPsy is to live with your eyes open, to feel your lacks without shame, to want with compassion, to seek clarity, to own what you have caused, and to shape your echo with reverence. VantaPsy means to begin in absence and spend your life reaching toward presence, knowing you will never fully arrive, and finding meaning in the reaching itself.

Related: [Vanta \(Concept\)](#), [The Soul](#), [Soulless](#)

Soulless

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Soulless

Soulless

Soulless is a relatively modern term, used to describe individuals who fail the Separation Ritual. Lacking an Affinity, they cannot wield Magic. The growing magical energy within them eventually overwhelms their bodies, typically leading to death between the ages of 18 and 26. The word carries heavy derogatory weight. Popular belief holds that the Soulless literally lack a soul. The truth runs deeper. Soulless individuals possess souls. Their failure lies in blocking the heart, in resisting the emotional and social connection that the Separation Ritual requires. Without this

bond the soul remains tethered internally, preventing the formation of an Affinity and the safe channelling of magic. Death follows as the natural outcome of living with uncontrolled magical energy. Those who open the heart complete the ritual successfully. The difference between survival and collapse is not the presence of a soul but the willingness to let it reach outward. The Soulless condition reflects Vanta's deeper nature. The internal void, the blocked desire, the refusal to move toward connection all manifest here as an inability to channel magic.

Related: [Separation Ritual](#), [Frallation](#), [The Soul](#)

Soulless (Continued)

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Soulless Extra

Soulless Cont. The term **Soulless** describes those who fail the **Separation Ritual**. Without an Affinity, they cannot wield magic. The growing energy within them eventually overwhelms the body, leading to death typically between the ages of eighteen and twenty-six. The word carries heavy derogatory weight. Popular belief holds that the **Soulless** literally lack a soul, their inability to use magic presented as proof of this absence. The truth runs deeper. **Soulless** individuals possess souls as surely as any breathing creature. Their failure lies in blocking the heart, in resisting the emotional and social connection that the **Separation Ritual** requires to work. Those who open the heart and allow connection with others complete the ritual successfully. They receive an Affinity, gain the ability to cast magic, and leave behind the spectre of early death. The **Soulless** condition reflects Vanta's deeper nature. The internal void, the blocked desire, the refusal to move toward connection all manifest here as an inability to channel magic rather than as physical or memetic corruption.

Related: [Soulless](#), [Separation Ritual](#), [Frallation](#)

Vanta (Concept)

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Vanta

Vanta as a Concept

To lack. To want. To begin. Vanta is the void within the self, the hollow that knows it is hollow, and the ache that rises from recognition of that absence. Vanta defines the human condition. All beings begin with lack, and from this lack arises desire. Desire compels motion and action. Through engagement with the world, one shapes the soul. Vanta exists as two intertwined states. Absence is the inner void. Longing is the yearning born from absence. Vanta is the opposite of wholeness yet indispensable. Without Vanta, there is no hunger, no reason to move, no path toward growth. It is the spark of being, the unformed potential that calls life into motion.

Related: [VantaPsy](#), [Soulless](#), [Physical Curse](#)

Cursed Soul

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Cursed Soul, Curse

The Cursed Soul

The **Curse** is the tangible consequence of a soul unmoored from its own essence. To fall to the **Curse** is to descend into **Vanta**, the root condition of lack and longing. Untended, **Vanta** becomes dangerous, collapsing inward as numbness or expanding outward as insatiable hunger. Those who succumb to the **Curse** have lost continuity with their humanity. The collapse of the **Six Steps of Being Human** leads inevitably to corruption. The

Cursed manifest in archetypes. The Hollow denied their lack. The Devourer consumed by desire. The Zealot enslaved to dogma. The Wraith consumed by regret. The Tyrant denying responsibility. The Echoless leaving only distortion. The Curse is also a mirror, reflecting what happens when lack, desire, and responsibility are ignored. Systems, cultures, and individuals that numb themselves or justify harm embody aspects of the Curse. Redemption is possible but rare. Those on the edges may yet be guided back. For the truly Cursed, the path is nearly closed.

Related: [Vanta \(Concept\)](#), [Physical Curse](#), [Memetic Curse](#)

Physical Curse

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Physical Curse, Cursed

The Physical Curse

Cursing leaves marks on the body as well as the soul. The most visible manifestation is the corruption of blood. Those who fall deeply into Vanta may develop Black Blood, thick and acidic and corrosive, capable of burning flesh and corroding metal. The Black Blooded are often mindless and wrathful, driven by an instinctive hunger to destroy or consume. They commonly emerge in harsh, hot environments. Yet some Cursed learn to harness their Vanta, channelling it into prolonged life, heightened perception, or godlike power. Such beings carry scars of corruption but retain self direction. The nature of one's descent shapes their condition. The Black Blooded emerge from heat and hardship, prone to rage and outward destruction. The White Blooded arise in cold, oppressive conditions, their suffering internalised and contemplative. The experience of becoming Cursed is intensely personal. Some are wracked with hallucinations. Others slip into hollow silence. The Cursed are a spectrum of corruption.

Related: [Cursed Soul](#), [Blood Types](#)

Memetic Curse

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Memetic Curse

The Memetic Curse

The Curse moves through awareness itself. Seeing, hearing, or even thinking of the Curse is enough to make one vulnerable. Dreams and whispers and hallucinations carry it, turning perception into a vector. Once lodged in a mind, the Curse rewrites memory and perception. Victims find their sense of self reshaped. Reality bends, what was certain becomes unreliable. The Curse is contagious through thought and communication. A phrase, a melody, a symbol can propagate it. It functions as a cognitive parasite, spreading through the very ideas one holds. Fighting the Curse is not a matter of quarantine or medicine. The Curse lives in awareness. To live under the Curse is to inhabit a world where awareness is the vector, memory is the battleground, and truth itself becomes fragile. Its victims forget names and faces. Some warp in form, others collapse into silence. There is no armour against knowing.

Related: [Cursed Soul](#), [Physical Curse](#)

Looped Eternity

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as The Looped Eternity

The Looped Eternity

In the aftermath of the Shattering and the crystallisation of Elysium, humanity faced a truth older than the world itself: time in Aerisu is not linear. It is a looped continuum: a living structure of recurrence, resonance, and redefinition. This was Aether's final discovery. She glimpsed the cosmic engine beneath all things: a universe that echoes rather than replays, where every event leaves an Echo in the temporal field. These Echoes do not fade. They ripple outward, crossing boundaries of past, present, and future. Thus, the universe exists in a state of perpetual causality feedback: the past births the future, the future corrects the past, and the loop sustains itself through infinite self-reference.

Cosmological Implications

There is no true beginning nor end. The First Cause and Final Consequence are the same event seen from opposite sides of the Loop. Divinity itself is recursive. Gods exist across multiple Loops simultaneously, shaped by the Echoes of their own worship. Humanity is the living syntax of the Loop. Each choice creates micro-echoes that sustain the fabric of time. Time in Aerisu is not a cycle of repetition, but a chorus of recurrence. Each Loop sings the same truth in a different voice.

Related: [Laws of Time](#), [Loops and Echoes](#)

Laws of Time

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as The Looped Eternity, Laws of Time

The Laws of Time

The Law of Continuance

"What has happened continues to happen until it becomes something else." No event ever truly ends, it only evolves through its echo.

The Law of Recursion

"Every consequence becomes its own cause." Time feeds itself. A deed in one era can create the origin of its own condition in another.

The Law of Displacement

"When the Loop breathes, something must slip." Every reconfiguration of the timeline displaces some fragment that no longer fits the new order.

Related: [Looped Eternity](#), [Loops and Echoes](#)

Loops and Echoes

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as Echo, Echoes, The Loop, Time Loop

The Nature of Loops and Echoes

Loops

A Loop is a complete cycle of causality. A total rewriting of the cosmic timeline. When enough Echoes accumulate, reality "resets" into a new harmonic arrangement. Each Loop retains memory residues from those prior: fragments of history, déjà vu, reincarnation, or myth.

Echoes

An Echo is an imprint of consequence. The resonance left behind by a choice, event, or emotion strong enough to transcend its own time. Echoes travel across the Loop, influencing seemingly unrelated eras. They manifest as

instinctive memories (dreams, prophecies, nostalgia), temporal artefacts, and fate entanglements. An Echo does not repeat the past. It redefines its context.

Related: [Looped Eternity](#), [Laws of Time](#)

Tsukuyomi

Age of Men · Concepts · also known as Tsukuyomi

Tsukuyomi

The moon has many faces, though most who look up see only one. There are always some who carry the moon's light within them, who walk through darkness with a quiet glow. They appear in different generations, different nations, and yet something connects them across the centuries. They are called Tsukuyomi. A Tsukuyomi is an echo. When Zuki Kusanagi prayed for the Scorching Sun to be extinguished, something of her scattered across the Loop. Her essence fragmented, each piece carrying a different aspect of what she had been. These fragments do not create copies of Zuki. They add a layer, a depth, a particular quality of awareness. The moon's faces take different forms. Some carry the aspect of witness. Some carry memory. Some carry hope, grief, or mercy. A Tsukuyomi does not choose their aspect. It chooses them. There is always at least one in every generation. The moon watches through its many faces, continuing to witness the world it helped create.

Related: [The Moon](#)

VantaPsy Cosmology

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Cosmology, Chronology, Universe

VantaPsy's cosmology is fundamentally concerned with potential, relationship, desire, consequence, memory and becoming. They describe how the world works at every scale, from a person's soul to Aerisu itself.

The entire framework is built upon a single question: What gives a person a soul? This question extends beyond individuals to encompass systems, the world and everything within it. VantaPsy is the name for the philosophical structure that emerges from asking this question across every scale, the recognition that soul is not a possession but a pattern of becoming.

At the most fundamental level is potential. Magic is potential expressed through Resonance: the capacity inherent in a thing to become, affect, transform or connect. The magical schools of Matter, Energy, Life and Mind describe broad ways that potential manifests, while Psy deals particularly with the soul, consciousness, memory, desire and connection. An Elemental expresses a being's magical affinity, while an Affinity is the soul externalised through the Separation process. Magic therefore emerges from what something is capable of becoming and how that potential resonates with the surrounding world.

Vanta and Lux are fundamental expressions of that potential. Vanta is associated with lack, wanting, desire and transformation; Lux with connection, coherence, restoration and the bringing of things into relation. Lack creates the possibility of wanting, and wanting creates movement. The pathological expression is the Curse, where desire becomes self-consuming.

Vanta, as a substance, is the physical representation of the Curse. It forms where desire has festered without transformation, becoming mineral and memetic corruption that erodes memory, perception and the soul itself. VantaBlack is the mineral form of Vanta, desire crystallised into substance that can be mined and shaped. Soul Shards are fragments of crystallised soul resonance created through related principles, holding the Echo of the being from which they were drawn.

Everything participates in a cosmic frame, a single web of causality. A person is affected by their memories, body, upbringing, relationships and culture, while their choices alter those same structures. A society shapes its members while its members reproduce or transform the society. Ecosystems, magical systems, Spirits, planets and astronomical structures participate in the same causal architecture. Nothing is metaphysically isolated. A soul is an imprint upon this web, produced through choices, intentions and Echoes.

The soul itself is not a possession. It is a pattern of relationship, a configuration of Resonance that emerges through motion and connection. It is formed through the Six Steps of Becoming: To Truly Lack, to recognise genuine incompleteness; To Want with Compassion, to allow desire without consuming others; To Seek Clarity, to confront confusion rather than outsource understanding; To Act with Noble Intent, to let purpose govern action; To Take Responsibility, to accept the consequences of one's choices; To Echo with Reverence, to recognise that one's actions continue through others and the wider world. These steps describe how a being develops meaningful agency.

The Separation Ritual externalises the soul through the Strand, the metaphysical tether that connects body and soul, creating an Affinity that carries the person's magical essence. This is necessary because the soul's potential is too vast to be contained indefinitely by the physical form; without externalisation, the pressure of an internalised soul eventually destroys its vessel. Those for whom this process fails become Soulless, their soul remaining internal and producing Frallation, the body's gradual collapse under pressure it cannot contain, typically leading to death between eighteen and twenty-six. The Soulless Brand is a magical imprint applied to the face that siphons residual magic from the body. It functions as a small-scale Rift for tracking and harvesting. The Burn Mark is a protective sigil designed to block tracking and prevent extraction, serving as the only known countermeasure.

Resonance is the connective mechanism. Whenever something interacts with something else, that interaction leaves a pattern. Soul-Resonance is the particular pattern produced by a soul moving through the world. It allows magic to operate, memories and emotions to persist, and consequences to travel beyond their immediate cause. Resonance makes the cosmic frame perceptible. A person acts, the world responds, and some trace of that interaction remains. Electric magic is particularly attuned to detecting and tracking Resonance patterns.

Vanta Points measure this process. Vanta gathers within a person as desire presses against the walls of the soul. Soulless individuals produce VP more readily because their hearts hold desire differently, drawing Vanta inward instead of allowing it to flow naturally. As Resonance strengthens through hardship and conviction, more Vanta accumulates, while spending it strengthens the soul through the same principle by which Resonance shapes reality. Defeat scatters accumulated Vanta back into the world, allowing what burdens one life to become another's livelihood.

That trace is an Echo. An Echo is consequence that persists. It can be a memory, relationship, cultural practice, physical alteration, magical imprint, inherited behaviour, myth or influence upon another soul. Echoes keep the past causally relevant after its original event has ended. They are also why the soul is something developed rather than possessed. A person's actions continually leave and receive Echoes, gradually forming the pattern called their soul.

Memory is the substance through which Recursion operates. The world remembers through Echoes, people through experience, cultures through myth and institutions, and the Spirit Realm through its own cosmic structures. The Barrier between the material world and the Spirit Realm was woven by the Nine Spirits to prevent magic from saturating reality, yet the Rift—a wound between realms opened by the Phumenar and widened when they attempted to extract Voluntas from Veyra's crystallised womb—allows magic, Vanta, Lux and the Spirits' influence to seep through. Memory preserves identity, while attachment to memory can prevent transformation. Within the Veins, memories can be surrendered as part of the journey through deeper regions, making the relinquishment of memory a literal separation from portions of the self. At the opposite extreme, refusing to release memory can produce recursive imprisonment, where accumulated experience becomes impossible to transform.

Pixpsy embody one such condition. Their consciousness has stretched across moments, leaving them trapped between states and never fully present anywhere. They carry memory like sediment, present yet unusable, like a word resting on the tip of the tongue for years without being spoken.

The monsters of the Curse represent another expression: Recursion without transformation. They retain what they have become and cannot become otherwise. Their identities freeze around a single pattern that reproduces itself endlessly. Hollowed and Duskwalkers demonstrate related conditions at different intensities, their souls unable to release the desires or absences that defined them.

~~Tsukuyomi~~ are ~~Echoes~~ that have found purchase in living souls. When Zuki Kusanagi's prayer for the end of the Scorching Sun fragmented her essence across Recursion, each fragment carried an aspect of what she had been. A ~~Tsukuyomi~~ does not choose its aspect; the aspect chooses it. The resulting soul may see, feel or perceive the world differently, carrying the sense of being watched or watching something invisible to others. ~~The Moon's~~ witness therefore persists through a particular configuration of ~~Echo~~ rather than through a separate bloodline. There is always at least one ~~Tsukuyomi~~ in every generation.

The Stars extend this principle beyond the world. They are ~~Echoes~~ of previous Recursions. The night sky is part of the world's memory, carrying evidence of configurations that preceded the present one.

This same principle explains interpretation. An ~~Echo~~ does not possess a single inevitable meaning. Someone interprets it, and that interpretation becomes a conviction. Conviction changes behaviour, behaviour creates consequences, and those consequences enter the causal web. Every act of interpretation therefore carries power. Through Mythwrighting, sufficiently persistent interpretations can acquire ~~Resonance~~ and become materially consequential.

Truth and Conviction occupy different positions within this structure. Truth concerns what is occurring within the larger reality. Conviction is what someone believes strongly enough to act upon. A conviction can be mistaken and still become causally powerful. Myths, doctrines, political ideologies and religious interpretations can consequently alter reality without becoming objectively true.

The same distinction applies to attempts to classify the soul. The Chimeric Camera can perceive genuine ~~Resonance~~, yet any interpretation imposed upon what it perceives risks turning a living, developing system into a fixed definition. The same problem appears in the classification of the Soulless. A soul cannot be exhausted by the category used to describe one aspect of it.

Blood types are visible expressions of the soul's state and respond to what acts upon the body and spirit. Blood is therefore dynamic rather than fixed. Red Blood is the human baseline. ~~White Blood~~ arises from cold and sealed despair, absence made biological, and is inherently cursed. ~~Black Blood~~ forms through heat and pressure, hunger embodied, and is inherently cursed. ~~Green Blood~~ represents ~~Chi~~ integration, desire stilled through discipline. ~~Gold Blood~~ represents augmentation without curse. ~~Blue Blood~~ indicates ~~Borenfegen~~ origin, synthetic and built rather than grown. ~~Purple Blood~~ represents magical convergence and is inherently cursed. ~~Pink Blood~~ is hybrid and contingent. ~~Synthetic White Blood~~ represents engineered compliance, derived from experimentation and therefore inherently cursed.

~~The Borenfegens~~ are artificial humans grown in vats and designed as vessels capable of containing extreme magical pressure. Their ~~Blue Blood~~ announces their origin. They were created to solve the Curse through design, yet became vectors through which the Curse could express itself in new forms. They think, feel and dream, and the Curse lives in awareness itself.

~~Soul Regulation~~ manages the soul's pressure through breathing, grounding and mental visualisation. For the Soulless, regulation can slow ~~Frallation~~ by opening blocked pathways and channelling internal energy outward through meditation, breathwork and physical exercise. ~~Chi~~ takes regulation further, draining desire from the blood entirely and producing ~~Green Blood~~. It grants practical abilities beyond ordinary physical limits, including sensing ~~Resonance~~ trails on conductive surfaces, following them through electrical magic, reinforcing bone and sinew, sharpening strikes and accelerating healing.

~~Psy~~ practitioners work directly with ~~Resonance~~, perceiving souls as tangible presences and navigating the psychic currents connecting living things. ~~Psyckers~~ use technology to bypass the discipline required for ~~Psy~~ magic, reading thoughts and planting suggestions through scavenged hardware. A ~~Psycker~~ who pushes too far becomes a ~~Psycho~~, lost within their own memetic contamination.

This distinction between systems and their components is central to Chimeric Design. A person is a system composed through memories, desires, relationships, body and environment. A society is another system composed through individuals, institutions, language and history. Systems influence their components while components continually reproduce or alter the system. Chimeric Design reflects this same structure: mechanics affect narrative, characters affect systems, environments contain history, objects acquire meaning through relationships, and seemingly separate elements participate in one another.

A sufficiently coherent system can begin to become its own recursion. Its internal pattern becomes self-sustaining, increasingly independent of the systems that produced it. This is one route through which powerful beings and Spirits emerge. A Spirit is a highly coherent expression of a principle that has become capable of existing as its own system.

The Nine Spirits therefore embody fundamental principles without being the ultimate source of those principles. Creatis embodies creation and invention, Verdantia growth and renewal, Aether cosmic structure, Logaris knowledge and interpretation, Mnemotas memory, Elysia emotion, Anima mortality and the threshold of death, Justicar consequence, and Voluntas desire and becoming. Their domains are different configurations of the same cosmic structure.

Anima represents a consciousness emerging from accumulated psychic-residue, formed through the experiences of dying beings. She is simultaneously an individual consciousness and an emergent structure produced by countless Echoes, demonstrating how a system can become conscious of itself.

Voluntas represents desire and becoming at the level of a Spirit.

Bahamut represents Vanta at the planetary level. Bahamut is Aerisu's own desire made manifest, the world's Vanta. It is not an independent god or creature with a singular, bounded identity. Its manifestation during the Shattering is one event within the history of a force that existed beforehand. Vanta already existed throughout Aerisu as Curse, Black Blood, fear, ideology, desire and other expressions of lack.

Fragments of Bahamut scattered across Aerisu during the Shattering. Susanoo, Hvitara, Falak and others are fragments of that planetary will, each carrying aspects of Bahamut's nature. Some became guardians through relationship and purpose; others remained hunger without direction. Their difference lies in what each fragment does with its inheritance, whether it transforms through relationship and purpose or remains trapped within the pattern of its origin.

~~Veyra's Womb~~ and the ~~Orb of Souls~~ sit near the centre of this structure because they bring memory, identity, desire and potential together. The Orb is associated simultaneously with the dead, ~~Soul Resonance~~, Veyra's crystallised womb and Voluntas's continued existence. It is a convergence point between what has been, what exists and what could become. The dead move toward it through the ~~Veins~~, while the Spiral provides the structure through which that movement occurs.

~~The Spiral Veins~~ are the literal manifestation of this structure. They are Aerisu's immense circulatory network, threading through the planet's bones and carrying Resonance and the dead toward the ~~Orb of Souls~~. ~~The Spiral~~ is divided into eight concentric regions, each shaped by one of the Spirits, with seven stations between them, each embodying a stage of the journey souls must undertake.

The dead move through these regions in sequence: Verdantia's living world, Anima's mortality, Elysia's emotion, Logaris's clarity, Creatis's action, Justicar's consequence, Aether's cosmic order and Mnemotas's memory. At the heart of the Spiral, the Orb waits. ~~The Spiral~~ is therefore simultaneously physical and metaphysical. It is a real network beneath Aerisu, a territory through which souls travel, and a representation of the process by which existence moves through becoming.

~~The Spiral~~ produces two opposing tendencies.

Asymptote of Decay describes recursive deterioration. The world repeatedly rebuilds from accumulated wounds, becoming increasingly distorted without reaching absolute chaos or complete deletion. ~~The Spiral~~ continually remembers itself, carrying its previous damage into what comes next.

Recursive Bloom is the regenerative possibility within the same structure. Accumulated history becomes material for adaptation, complexity, connection and new life. The difference lies in how the inherited pattern develops.

~~Death Gardening~~ expresses Recursive Bloom through biology. Death leaves material and Resonant residue, which becomes nourishment for other life. Flowers can be cultivated from the remains of the dead, allowing death to enter the same recursive system as everything else. A life ends, its material becomes soil, another organism grows, and the ~~Echo~~ of the original life enters another form.

Blossoming Death expresses the same principle at a deeper level. An ending can become a beginning while retaining the significance of what ended. Death becomes material for continuation, and the dead remain present through what grows from them.

~~The Moon~~ emerged from the encounter between Lux and Vanta during the Shattering. It embodies their convergence. Zuki's desire for an end to the destructive Sun, Lunarkos's arrival, Bahamut's manifestation and the resulting Shattering form one enormous Echo. ~~The Moon~~ becomes a permanent witness to that event and part of the world's memory.

~~The Sun~~ expresses the question of continuation. The Scorching Sun represents continuation taken into destruction, while the Warm Sun represents continuance as care and renewal. Aerisu's major philosophies interpret this tension differently. Autarchism chooses advancement, Vantari philosophy seeks release, Vesperism accepts coexistence with the present, and the Luminaries seek radical renewal through destruction. Each interprets the same cosmological problem through a different conviction. In the modern Age of Decay, the extraction of Voluntas has caused the sun to appear only rarely, a symptom of her presence in the material world.

The Curse is the pathological expression of this entire process. Desire arises from lack, yet instead of developing through clarity, responsibility and connection, it becomes self-reinforcing. Its pattern separates itself from the wider connective structure and begins reproducing itself. This allows the Curse to propagate through awareness, thought, memory, blood and behaviour. It becomes a system whose primary recursion is its own continuation.

This also explains Chimeric beings. The accumulation of souls is an attempt to become a larger system by incorporating other systems. Such accumulation can produce immense power while leaving the components fundamentally unintegrated. Chimerism therefore becomes a distorted form of connection: accumulation without genuine relationship.

~~City Shields~~ are a practical application of the same principles, barriers maintained through concentrated Resonance that protect settlements from the dangers that roam beyond their walls.

The world's metaphors express the same structure through simple physical images. A river or flowing water represents the movement of time and causality. A petal represents an individual life, beautiful and temporary within a larger living structure. Changing seasons represent Recursion, each return carrying traces of what came before while producing a different configuration. Gardens represent cultivation and pruning. Architecture represents desire crystallised into systems. Scripture represents interpretation and the power to impose meaning. Roots represent inherited patterns. Echoes represent consequence. Silence represents what remains before or after expression. ~~The Spiral~~ represents Recursion, while Chimeric imagery expresses the tension between isolated accumulation and genuine connection.

The entire cosmology can therefore be understood as one continuous process:

Potential allows things to become. Desire gives potential direction. Resonance carries interaction between systems. Action creates consequence. Consequence becomes Echo. Memory preserves Echo. Interpretation gives Echo meaning. Conviction turns meaning into action. Recursion carries those consequences forward. Systems inherit, reproduce and transform what came before. Recursive Bloom transforms inheritance into new possibility. Asymptote of Decay traps inheritance in increasingly damaged repetition.

The Six-Steps describe how the individual soul becomes capable of participating in this process responsibly. Magic expresses potential through Resonance. Affinities and Elementals express the particular structure of a soul's potential. ~~The Veins~~ embody the circulation of Resonance, memory and souls. The Orb is a convergence of identity, memory, desire and potential. The Spirits are highly coherent systems expressing fundamental principles.

Bahamut is that structure expressed at the scale of the world itself. Stars are Echoes expressed at the scale of previous Recursions. ~~Death Gardening~~ and Blossoming Death express the same process through biological transformation. The Curse is recursion becoming isolated from the wider web and reproducing itself. Chimeric Design is the same cosmological principle expressed through the structure of interconnected systems.

This is what VantaPsy means. The world, soul, magic, ecology, religion, history, psychology and aesthetics exist at different scales of the same structure: potential becoming through relationship, leaving Echoes that are remembered, interpreted and carried into Recursion, where they either become material for further growth or increasingly reproduce the conditions of their own decay. The question What gives a person a soul? is answered by the entire process: a soul is what emerges when a system participates in this structure with awareness, responsibility and the willingness to become.

Related: [Age of Men](#), [The Soul](#), [VantaPsy](#), [Cursed Soul](#), [The Grimoire](#), [Magic](#), [Soulless](#), [Frallation](#)

Laws of the Spirits

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as The Laws of the Spirits

The Laws of the Spirits

The Gods remain in the Spirit Realm. Their presence shapes reality through quiet, pervasive currents. Creatis moves through bursts of inspiration. Inventors wake with blueprints etched into memory. Verdantia flows through nature's reclamation. Empty cities disappear beneath vines. Aether folds space near observatories. Stars arrange themselves in patterns that reveal the Loop. Logaris carries logic forward in waves of clarity. Mnemotas layers memory across time. People recall events that layer over daily life. Elysia amplifies every feeling into full intensity. Anima opens the threshold of death into vision. Justicar brings karma into physical form. Voluntas spreads desire as a living current. These nine remain as the world's quiet witnesses. Their presence lingers in every crystal forest, every Soul Shard, and every shadow that moves with its own intent.

Related: [Lux and Vanta: The Primal Dichotomy](#)

Lux and Vanta: The Primal Dichotomy

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as Lux and Vanta, Lux, Vanta

Lux and Vanta: The Primal Dichotomy

Vanta moved quietly through the world long before the sky split. It lived in the Curse, in threads of Black Blood, in the hush of old fears. When Bahamut tore upward through the mantle to meet Lunarkos, the boundary between soul and matter ripped open. Vanta surged outward in a single vast release. It became the new rhythm beneath stone, the new breath in the air. Lux arrived in the same breath, carried on molten shards of Lunarkos. Crystalline light settling into coherent form. It blooms where soul meets ground, coaxing crystal forests into song. Together Lux and Vanta form the living tension that now holds Aerisu. One draws toward completion and order. The other answers with hunger and release. They move through every crystal shard, every Soul Shard, every shadow that stirs on its own. The world breathes them both now, and every life learns to walk the line where they meet.

Related: [Vanta \(Concept\)](#)

The Spiral Journey

Age of Fairytales · Concepts · also known as The Spiral, Elysium, Orb of Souls, Spiral Journey

The Journey into Elysium

Region 1: Verdantia - The Living World

You begin here. Alive, breathing, carrying the weight of memories you do not yet know you will surrender.

Station 0: The Toll

You stand before ~~T~~omenos. He asks for your fare. Memories. The ones that made you who you are. You must give enough that you become light enough to enter the Spiral.

Region 2: Anima - The Region of Mortality

Shaped by Anima, spirit of death and thresholds. Souls feel the weight of their own ending for the first time.

Station 1: To Truly Lack

A mirror. The soul must name what they lacked in life. The admission must be genuine.

Region 3: Elysia - The Region of Emotion

Shaped by Elysia, spirit of feeling. Joy and grief and rage press from every side. Souls have nowhere to hide.

Station 2: To Want with Compassion

A marketplace. Everything the soul ever wanted is for sale. To pass, the soul must refuse something they desperately want because taking it would harm another.

Region 4: Logaris - The Region of Clarity

Shaped by Logaris, spirit of logic. A vast library of contradictions. Souls must think, but thinking alone will not save them.

Station 3: To Seek Clarity

A fog so thick that nothing can be seen. The soul must find the centre and look without flinching.

Region 5: Creatis - The Region of Action

Shaped by Creatis, spirit of invention. An endless workshop. Souls must create because creation is what they were meant to do.

Station 4: To Act with Noble Intent

A field of frozen moments. The soul must reach the end and speak: I did this. It was mine.

Region 6: Justicar - The Region of Justice

Shaped by Justicar, spirit of law. A courtroom where every soul is both judge and accused.

Station 5: To Take Proper Responsibility

A labyrinth of mirrors. The soul must find the centre and name each consequence they see.

Region 7: Aether - The Region of Cosmic Order

Shaped by Aether, spirit of recursion. Made of repeating patterns. Souls walk in circles without knowing they are circling.

Station 6: To Echo with Reverence

A vast and silent space. The soul must create something. A mark. A word. A name remembered.

Region 8: Mnemotas - The Region of Memory

Shaped by Mnemotas, spirit of memory. A library of lives. Souls must find their own volume and read what is written.

Station 7: Individuation

The final barrier. The soul must become whole. All the steps, all the truths, all the weight must now integrate into a single self.

Region 9: The Orb - Voluntas

At the heart of the Spiral, the Orb waits. Veyra's womb, crystallised, holding Voluntas unborn. Here, souls rest. They dissolve. They become part of everything that ever was and ever will be.

The Meaning

The ~~Spiral Veins~~ are a process. Each step prepares you for the next. Those who cannot complete it become part of the spiral itself. Their unfinished business becomes terrain. Their suffering becomes landscape.

Related: [Orb of Souls](#), [Tomenos](#), [The Spiral](#)

Magic

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Magic

Magic

Magic is potential expressed through interaction. The capacity inherent within a being or system to transform, affect, or connect. It is the natural consequence of what something is capable of becoming. Every working operates through a strict sequence of three governing principles: Understanding provides the structural knowledge of the target system; Intent determines the moral and emotional orientation shaping the energy; and Connection establishes the depth of attunement to the world's fundamental currents.

These workings channel through two primal forces. Lux-aspected magic upholds order, coherence, and structural integrity, sealing and preserving form. Vanta-aspected magic yields raw, transformative power driven by hunger and lack, breaking existing boundaries at the risk of consuming the caster. Manifesting across the broad schools of Matter, Energy, Life, and Mind, magic is simply the soul acting directly upon existence, converting internal potential into outward consequence.

Related: [Soul Types and Casting](#), [The Four Schools of Magic](#), [Lux and Vanta: The Primal Dichotomy](#)

Soul Types and Casting

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Types, Nature of Magic

Soul Types and Casting

Magic flows through the Soul, shaped by its nature and condition. Aërisu recognises three primary caster types.

Soulful casters possess high Soul integrity, studied knowledge and deep Connection. Magic moves through them like water through a clear channel, allowing deliberate and responsible control.

Cursed casters carry heavy Vanta saturation and desire-first impulses. Their magic surges from raw emotion, making it powerful but unstable and prone to collateral effects.

Soulless casters lack the channel through which the Soul expresses its potential. That unchecked potential produces Frallation, for which the ~~Separation Ritual~~ is the established remedy.

Magic remains both a moral and scientific practice. Power deepens through knowledge and stronger Soul Connection, while shortcuts exist only through dangerous means.

Related: [Magic](#), [Soulless](#), [Separation Ritual](#)

The Four Schools of Magic

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Magic School, Magic Schools, Schools of Magic

The Four Schools of Magic

Magic organises into four fundamental domains.

Matter governs physical substance. Subdomains include Terra, Aqua, Aero, Pyra, and Materia. Practitioners shape stone, condense air into blades, restructure bonds, crystallise fire.

Energy directs flow, motion, and consequence. Subdomains encompass Kinetic, Thermodynamic, Temporal, Causal, Probabilistic, and Spatial. Masters redirect force, slow time, tilt probability, fold space.

Life embraces biological systems. Subdomains cover biogenesis, biomancy, botany, genetics, neuro-organics, and necrobiology. Healers accelerate regeneration. Druids foster symbiotic ecosystems.

Mind encompasses consciousness and perception. Subdomains include Psy, cognition manipulation, memory, emotion, and social memetics. Practitioners read thoughts, edit memories, seed ideas.

Vanta and Lux in Practice

Lux provides precision, stability, and restoration. Vanta delivers raw power, transformation, and acceleration. The interplay shapes a mage's path. Balanced practitioners wield both. Those who favour Lux grow rigid. Those who embrace Vanta become Cursed.

Related: [Magic](#), [Psy](#), [Lux and Vanta: The Primal Dichotomy](#)

Psy

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Psy

Psy

Psy is the magic of the soul itself. Where other schools shape matter, energy, life, or mind, Psy works directly upon the essence that underlies them all: the soul's own fabric, its desires, its memories, its connections to other souls. Those who practice Psy learn to perceive souls as tangible presences. They sense the weight of a soul's desires, the texture of its memories, the shape of its lacks. The deepest applications involve reaching directly into another's soul. Skilled practitioners form psychic connections, sense emotions from rooms away, read surface thoughts, and impose their will. Advanced practitioners navigate psychic currents that connect all living things. The most profound and dangerous application is entering another's psyche. This is soul snatching. When a practitioner remains too long, boundaries between souls blur. Identity fragments. Psy enables Soul_Capturing and soul transference. Lux-aspected Psy tends toward clarity. Vanta-aspected Psy reaches toward hunger. The practice carries profound risks. Every entry leaves traces. Some practitioners lose themselves entirely.

Related: [The Four Schools of Magic](#), [The Soul](#), [Soul Capturing](#)

Crystals and Amplification

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Crystal Amplification, Crystals

Crystals and Amplification

Lux shards and Vanta gems serve as tools of amplification. Raikami crystals from Fengua form where Susanoo's lightning strikes. Crystals from Blossoming Death sites carry unique residue. Fragments from Elysium's ruins pulse with power. Crystals do not replace understanding. They lower the threshold of connection, allowing mages with less attunement to channel effects that would otherwise demand years of discipline. Crystals carry danger. Overuse fosters dependency. The Soul leans on the crystal rather than cultivating its own bond. Withdrawal brings sharp pain. Corrupted Lux screams when activated, fracturing perception. Vantagems whisper constantly, seeding obsessive thoughts. Societies impose strict regulations. Fengua controls Raikami trade. Some kingdoms forbid crystals outright. Others build economies around them.

Related: [Magic](#), [Soul Shards](#)

Separation Ritual

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Separation Ritual

The Separation Ritual

Relief from Frallation arrives through a union of knowledge and ritual craft. The Psycrata study souls with patient discipline, while Hoshimiran priests preserve ancient ceremonies. During adolescence, when Frallation intensifies, the ritual draws the soul outward from the body. The spirit emerges and settles beyond the flesh while remaining bound through a metaphysical tether called the Strand. Practitioners guide the ritual through different forms. Some use flame. Others use water. Meditative traditions guide the soul through stillness and breath. The act relieves the swelling pressure of Frallation and clears the residues that gather within the soul.

A World of Visible Souls

The ritual reshapes civilisation. Every person walks beside the visible form of their soul. Communities gather around shared resonance between Affinities. Guilds and nations organise labour through Elemental alignment. Fire wielders master metallurgy. Water practitioners guide ships. Earth specialists raise fortifications. Air adepts command currents. The Strand glows quietly between body and spirit, while Affinities walk beside their human halves.

Related: [Affinities](#), [Soulless](#), [Frallation](#)

Affinities

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Affinities, The Strand

The Strand and Affinities

The Strand forms as a living tether of will and identity. Through it the soul continues to flow into thought, sensation, and action. Once externalised, the soul reveals its nature through a living manifestation called an Affinity. The Affinity takes animal form and carries the essence of the individual into visible shape. Some souls appear as small companions: cats, birds, rabbits. Stronger spirits take the shapes of lions, bears, wolves, or eagles. Rare souls manifest as dragons. The Affinity lives as a companion bound through the Strand, sharing thought and feeling in a quiet exchange that requires no spoken language. Harm done to an Affinity strikes the soul directly. The pain echoes through both spirit and body.

Related: [Separation Ritual](#), [The Soul](#), [Elementals](#)

Elementals

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Elementals, Elements, Magic

Elementals

The Strand carries a narrow channel between body and soul. Through this bond each individual discovers a single domain of magic that flows with natural clarity. This alignment becomes known as the Elemental. A fire-aligned soul guides flame with instinctive grace. Air-aligned individuals feel the movement of wind. Those attuned to life mend flesh through touch. Minds aligned with thought sense patterns in consciousness. The Elemental often reveals itself during the [Separation Ritual](#). Flame, storm, crystal, flowing water, or living growth appear as the soul settles beyond the body. These manifestations illuminate the path through which magic moves most freely along the Strand.

Related: [Separation Ritual](#), [Affinities](#), [Soul Types and Casting](#)

Frallation

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Frallation

Frallation

Magic seeps through the Rift and settles into Aerisu as a constant pressure within every living thing. Generations rise beneath it, each carrying deeper resonance with Lux and Vanta. The soul grows dense, and the body receives weight that gathers beneath the skin. The condition begins quietly. Tremors move through hands. Heat collects beneath the surface. Senses grow crowded as the soul presses outward. Lines rise along natural paths, following tendon, rib, spine, jaw. They settle into the skin like roots or fractures. Within these structures, finer traces appear: thin markings that form shapes approaching meaning. At its height, the body yields. Some collapse arrives as quiet fading. Some unfolds through violent failure. In rare cases, a late-Separation occurs, where the soul detaches without destroying the body.

Related: [Soulless](#), [Frallation Stages](#), [Separation Ritual](#)

Frallation Stages

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Frallation Stages

Clinical Progression of Frallation - The Stages of Frallation Frallation follows a recognised sequence.

Stage One

The body registers excess resonance as contained disturbance. Fine tremors, low internal heat, shallow sleep with dense dreams. Root markings appear as faint vein-like lines. Script remains fragmented. The person retains clarity.

Stage Two

Shift from containment into fixation. Extended tremor, fatigue, persistent fever. Visual disturbances overlay perception. Memory reorganises around personal meaning. Root structures spread across torso and limbs. Script aligns in recurring forms.

Stage Three

Fragmentation. Body operates under continuous strain. Perception becomes saturated. Memory loses continuity. Identity condenses around central fixations. Root markings concentrate around chest and joints. Script gathers into dense formations.

Stage Four

Complete loss of integration. Physical systems fail. Awareness fragments. Identity disperses. Behaviour emerges from internal states. Root structures lose coherence. Script spreads beyond pathways. In rare instances, the soul separates while the body remains.

Across all stages, unexpressed desire and unresolved identity gather weight and shape perception, memory, and behaviour.

Related: [Frallation](#), [Frallation Marks](#), [Soulless](#)

Soul Regulation

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Soul Regulation, Regulation

Soul Regulation

The soul moves with the body. When a person rises from sleep, their Affinity stirs beside them. When a person tires, their Affinity slows. This visibility is the foundation of soul regulation. In hospitals, soul regulation forms part of every staff member's training. Breathing exercises steady the chest and the soul together. Grounding techniques anchor the Affinity to stillness. Mental visualisation stills the external form.

Regulation for the Soulless

Soulless individuals carry their souls inside. The pressure of containment drives Frallation, but regulation can slow the progression. Meditation focused on the heart opens blocked pathways. Breathwork imagines the soul expanding and contracting within the body's boundaries. Physical exercise channels internal energy outward.

What Regulation Reveals

The soul responds to intention. A person who calms their breathing calms their Affinity. A person who opens their heart eases the internal pressure of Frallation. The separation between body and soul is not a severance. It is a conversation conducted through the Strand.

Related: [Affinities](#), [Soulless](#), [Frallation](#)

Chi

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Chi, Soul Regulation

Chi

Chi is what happens when soul regulation becomes a lifetime. The monks of Fengua take that foundation and press further, until the blood itself shifts colour and the soul learns a new way of moving. The discipline centres on the relationship between desire and resonance. Through decades of meditation, the monk drains the red of wanting from their veins and replaces it with the green of acceptance. Green blood is the visible mark of this transformation. Pale as new leaves, deep as forest shadow. It carries no hunger, no rage, no inward collapse. Chi grants practical gifts beyond the body. A trained practitioner senses resonance trails left on conductive surfaces and follows them with electric magic. Yet Chi is not only stillness. A practitioner who channels their Chi can focus breath, reinforce bone, sharpen a strike, harden a guard, accelerate healing, or hold aggression in a controlled flame. Chi flows in the high valleys of Fengua, where Susanoo once moved through every storm. It is balance chosen over power, stillness held against hunger.

Related: [Soul Regulation](#), [Fengua](#), [Blood Types](#)

Death Gardening

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Death Gardening

Death Gardening, Necromantic Horticulture

The tribes of Ereboska grasped what others learned only after centuries. Death feeds growth. When a living being dies, its magical essence seeps into the soil. This residue transforms into nourishment plants absorb, shaping their form, speed, and properties. Death gardeners read this residue as farmers read soil. Certain deaths produce night-blooming flowers. Others yield healing fruit. Warriors slain in battle feed thorny plants. Elders passing peacefully nourish tall trees. Death gardeners perform ritual deaths where individuals offer their lives to sustain the tribe. Volunteers choose this path. Elders offer themselves willingly. The choice lies in meaning. Death gardens are curated spaces. Each plant traces to specific deaths. Beauty emerges unsettling. Colours saturate beyond nature. Petals form patterns resembling symbols or faces. Beyond cultivation, death gardeners wield Vanta and necromantic control. They accelerate growth by channelling residue through their bodies into soil. This extends to Vein entrances. Death garden produce forms a primary export. Fruits grant clarity from scholar deaths. Vegetables enhance endurance from warrior ends. Death gardening reveals death as resource, ending as beginning, wasteland as bloomable ground.

Related: [Ereboska](#), [The Vantari](#)

Psy Hacking

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Psy Hacker, Psycker, Psycho

Psy Hacking

The formal study of Psy magic belongs to those with patience. The Diviners call themselves Psychics. Psy Hackers are what happens when patience runs out. A Psycker bypasses years of meditation by using technology. They build devices that read resonance for them, that convert Psy currents into data. The most distinctive aspect is memetics. A Psycker learns to plant suggestions through symbols, phrases, and cultural triggers. Psycker is the casual term, carrying respect in the underground. Psycho is derogatory, describing someone who has pushed too far, who has hacked so many minds they no longer understand truth. Some Psychos become weapons. The Diviners hunt them when they become dangerous. The distinction between Psychic and Psycker is not always clear. One path requires years of discipline. The other requires a willingness to break the rules. Both can lead to the same destination, but one is slower and safer.

Related: [Psy](#), [Soul Resonance](#), [The Diviners](#)

The Autarchs

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Autarch, Autarchs, Autarchian, Tarch

The Autarchs

The Autarchs believe that humanity stands above all else. There are no gods watching over the world, no higher powers to appeal to, no divine intervention waiting to save anyone. There is only humanity, and humanity must save itself. This philosophy emerged from the wreckage of the Shattering. If the world was to survive, people would have to build the means of survival themselves. The Autarchs place their faith in technology, in progress, in the accumulation of knowledge and capability. Their mechs, their cities, their academies are monuments to the

conviction that human hands can shape human destiny. In the modern era, the Autarchs persist as a leading power across much of Aerisu. Their influence runs through Solmara's councils, through the industrial centres of Exandria and Argestia.

Related: [The Primarchs](#), [The Thanatarchs](#), [Solmara](#)

The Primarchs

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Primarch, Primarchs, Autarch, Autarchs

The Primarchs - Autarch Subject

The Primarchs are the nationalists and capitalists of the Autarch tradition. They believe that progress must be organised, directed, and protected. Their focus is on building and maintaining the structures that allow civilisation to function: economies, militaries, governments, corporations. They sign contracts, move resources, ensure mechs have fuel and cities have food. In the Crown Nations and across Solmara, the Primarchs hold the levers of practical power, managing the day-to-day machinery of survival.

Related: [The Autarchs](#), [Solmara](#)

The Thanatarchs

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Thanatarch, Thanatarchs, Autarch, Autarchs

The Thanatarchs - Autarch Subject

The Thanatarchs emerged from the philosophy of Silealyros, from the Market of Flesh where the body is treated as the last true asset. They acknowledge that death cannot be defeated, but they refuse to accept it gracefully. They resist until the bitter end, pushing their bodies past natural limits through cybernetic enhancement, experimental technology, and chemical stimulation. They indulge in pleasure and violence and extremes, knowing their time is limited. They believe in control and authority, but they build nothing for the future because for them, the future does not exist. They are dying kings ruling over empty thrones.

Related: [The Autarchs](#)

The Luminaries

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Luminaries, Luminary

The Luminaries

The Luminaries are people of hope, believers in the light of the sun and the coming of a new age. They call themselves Luminaries, bearers of light. Their detractors call them Evershinites, or worse, Evershites. The Luminaries believe that the Scorching Sun will return. Not the pale warmth that appears briefly on Sundays, but the full fire that once ruled the sky. They gather on beaches and coastal cities when Sunday comes, watching the sunrise with the desperate hope of people who have been told for generations that salvation is coming. They wait. They pray. They prepare.

Related: [The Pyraeon](#), [The Solarii](#), [The Sun](#)

The Pyraeon

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Pyraeon, Luminaries, Luminary

The Pyraeon - Luminary Subject

The Pyraeon are the radical extremists of the Luminary tradition. They believe that the world must purge itself of progress, that technology and industry and government are plagues that must be burned away. They wage war against the modern world, committing acts of terror to dismantle civilisation and restore balance. For the Pyraeon, the sun is not a deity but a force of purification, a symbol of the cleansing fire that will reduce everything to ash so that something true can grow from the ruins. They are militants, willing to die and to kill for their vision of a world returned to nature's rule.

Related: [The Luminaries](#), [The Sun](#)

The Solarii

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Solarii, Luminaries, Luminary

The Solarii - Luminary Subject

The Solarii are a secluded, insular, almost monastic order who worship the sun as a literal god. They reject modern innovation but value craftsmanship, art, and tradition, believing that true creation comes from human hands rather than machines. They wear gold adornments and jewellery, seeing these as reflections of the sun's divine gift. Their rituals include daily sun-gazing, fire dances, and sacred performances. They hate the moon, believing that its presence corrupts people into stagnation and complacency. They violently reject outsiders who try to force their way into Solarii communities.

Related: [The Luminaries](#), [The Sun](#), [Atenara](#)

The Vesperites

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Vesperites, Vesperite, Moon Baby, Nightstray, Gloamer, Sundrifter

The Vesperites

The Vesperites are the common people of Aerisu, those who suffered under the sun and found relief in its setting. They are called Nightstrays and Gloamers and Sundrifters. The Vesperites do not care what they are called. They care about their families, about the time they have, about the brief period of peace that comes when the sun finally sets. In the Age of Decay, with the world plunged into perpetual night, Vesperite philosophy has transformed. What was once a matter of finding peace in darkness has become a defense of the night against those who would see it ended. They despise Sundays. They despise the Luminaries, calling them Evershites with real venom.

Moon Babies is an insult used by other ideologies to dismiss Vesperites as naive. Within Vesperite communities, the term is sometimes reclaimed with ironic pride.

Related: [The Yorushika](#), [The Moon](#), [The Luminaries](#)

The Yorushika

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Yorushika, Vesperites, Vesperite

The Yorushika - Vesperite Subject

The Yorushika are pacifist activists within the Vesperite tradition. They organise massive sit-ins and silent protests to disrupt government and military actions. They campaign for weapon dismantlement and refuse to support industries that profit from war. They refuse to fight even when directly attacked, believing that proving war is unnecessary matters more than winning any particular battle. They smuggle people out of war zones and provide safe zones for refugees. They disrupt propaganda and military recruitment through art, performances, and public discourse. The Yorushika are not passive. They are active in their pacifism, working constantly to undermine the structures that perpetuate violence.

Related: [The Vesperites](#)

The Psycrata

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Psycrata

The Psycrata

The Psycrata are scholars and magic-users who believe that true advancement comes from wisdom, knowledge, and the mastery of natural forces. Unlike the Autarchs who rely on technology, the Psycrata are rooted in the arcane and spiritual. They study the core of existence, using magic to manipulate the natural world and unlock its mysteries. In the modern era, the Psycrata rival the Autarchs as a leading power. Their influence runs through the Diviner Councils, through the Temples, through every institution that values knowledge as the highest currency. They hold the vaults where Soul Shards are studied and sealed. They perform the Separation Rituals. They interpret the signs and patterns that shape the age.

Related: [The AEvicara](#), [The Odyraphim](#), [The Diviners](#)

The AEvicara

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as AEvicara, Psycrata

The AEvicara - Psycrata Subject

The AEvicara are mystics who believe that knowledge should be sought through experience and reincarnation. They see death as a transition to a new life, with past wisdom carrying over through the soul. They embrace fate and cycles, believing that history repeats itself and that true understanding can only be attained by comprehending these loops. They engage in spiritual journeys, memory transference, and ritualistic meditation to tap into past lives and lost knowledge. The more structured Psycrata view them as dogmatic and reckless. The AEvicara see the Psycrata as rigid and detached from the soul's true journey.

Related: [The Psycrata](#)

The Odyraphim

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Odyraphim, Psycrata

The Odyraphim - Psycrata Subject

The Odyraphim are keepers of hidden truth, intellectuals who operate in the spaces between politics and power. Their official public face is an academic society studying magic, technology, and celestial movements. Below

ground, in hidden laboratories and classified research facilities, they conduct experiments, develop weapons, and protect knowledge that cannot be allowed to travel freely. The Odyraphim are not loyal to any faction. They sell to whoever pays. Many members personally oppose war, but some believe that weapons are inevitable. Xeraphina Auto operates as a key faction within the Odyraphim. The Odyraphim watch the stars and build the tools that shape the future, and they answer to no one but themselves.

Related: [The Psycrata](#), [Xeraphina](#)

The Vantari

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Vantari, Nihilists, Nihilist

The Vantari

The Vantari are those who have embraced the Curse. They believe that the darkness is not an affliction but a calling, that true life begins only when Vanta fully seeps into the soul. They are called nihilists by outsiders, death-cultists by those who fear what they represent. The Vantari do not argue with these names. They simply continue their work. Most necromancers trace their lineage to Vantari traditions. The manipulation of death, the cultivation of residue, the navigation of the spaces between life and whatever comes after all of these arts were refined by Vantari practitioners. The Diviners officially condemn them. Unofficially, the Diviners study their techniques.

Related: [The Hollowed](#), [The Duskwalkers](#), [Death Gardening](#)

The Hollowed

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Hollowed, Vantari

The Hollowed - Vantari Subsect

The Hollowed are the most common Vantari, fully consumed by the Curse and lost to its nihilistic pull. They drift aimlessly, seeking oblivion and embracing darkness as the true end of all things. Most are mindless, vacant, or obsessive, lost in eternal trances of despair and longing. They see their eventual death as salvation, believing that once they fully succumb they will reach a state of true enlightenment. They worship Vanta as an unknowable force, embracing its hold over them without question. They are easily manipulated by those stronger than themselves. The void is their symbol. The unknown. The inevitable end.

Related: [The Vantari](#), [The Duskwalkers](#)

The Duskwalkers

Age of Decay · Concepts · also known as Duskwalkers, Duskwalker, Vantari

The Duskwalkers - Vantari Subsect

The Duskwalkers are a rarer sect of Vantari who resist the Curse long enough to wield its power. They can command the Hollowed, directing them as tools for their own agendas. Despite their intelligence and control, they share the same nihilistic worldview, believing that all things will inevitably fall to darkness. They use their power to manipulate life and death, resurrecting others as cursed thralls, shaping the residue of endings into tools for their purposes. They are not immune to the Curse. They simply succumb more slowly than the Hollowed. Many Duskwalkers seek the Orb of Souls, believing it might offer a way to delay or control their fall into oblivion.

Related: [The Vantari](#), [The Hollowed](#)

The Borenfegens

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Orthogenesis, Borenfegen, Borenfegens

The Borenfegens

The Borenfegens were both solution and symptom. They were artificial humans grown in vats, their development monitored and adjusted at every stage. Their genetic code was designed rather than inherited. They were designed as perfect vessels, bodies that could contain any magical pressure, that would never succumb to Frallation. The creation drew upon all four schools of magic. Matter magic shaped the flesh. Life magic monitored development. Energy magic channelled flows. Mind magic wove consciousness. The first generations were obviously artificial. Each generation improved. By the height of the Orthogenesis project, Borenfegens were indistinguishable from natural humans. They could think, feel, and dream. This created ethical catastrophe. Personhood was a contract, not a status. Borenfegens who met criteria were citizens. Those who did not were property.

Related: [The Spectrum of Being](#), [Borenfegen Recurrence](#), [Orthogenesis](#)

The Spectrum of Being

Age of Knowledge · Concepts · also known as Orthogenesis, Borenfegen, Borenfegens, Naturals, Enhanced, Artificial

The Spectrum of Being

The Orthogenesis project created categories that Silealyros was still learning to navigate. Naturals were those born in the old way, their bodies shaped by inheritance and chance, occupying every level of society. Enhanced were those modified after birth, their original bodies supplemented or transformed through technology, simultaneously more capable and forever marked by their choices. Artificial were the Borenfegens, the created, their status the most contested between those who had achieved full personhood and those who remained property. The three groups lived in uneasy proximity. Naturals feared being rendered obsolete. Enhanced worried their modifications would be used to argue they were no longer human. Artificial struggled for recognition.

Related: [The Borenfegens](#)

The Six Steps of Humanity

Age of Magic · Concepts · also known as Six Steps, Steps of Humanity

The Six Steps of Humanity

The Six Steps of Humanity are the progression every soul follows toward wholeness.

To Truly Lack

A soul recognises its incompleteness without shame. It perceives absence clearly yet refuses to let that absence define its worth.

To Want with Compassion

Desire arises without consumption. Hunger learns to build rather than destroy, to yearn in ways that nurture others.

To Seek Clarity within Both Noise and Fog

Truth emerges amid confusion. The centre holds steady when voices pull in every direction.

To Act or To Not Act with Noble Intent

Choice flows from purpose rather than impulse. Restraint serves when action would harm, and movement when stillness would fail.

To Take Proper Responsibility for Your Actions

Outcomes belong to the one who set them in motion. Ripples spread outward, touching lives in unseen ways.

To Echo with Reverence

Every decision resonates through time. The self forms part of a greater pattern that continues across the Loop.

These steps form the philosophical foundation of VantaPsy. They guide those who seek to comprehend the Soul's workings, the essence of magic, and the responsible wielding of power.

Related: [VantaPsy](#), [The Soul](#), [The Grimoire](#)

Substances

The Golden Heart

Age of Men · Substances · also known as The Golden Heart, Fruit of the Deep

The Golden Heart

The Golden Heart, also known as the Fruit of the Deep, was a warm, golden formation buried deep within the mountain of [Aokusa](#). It pulsed like a heart, sustaining the warmth of the mountain waters and influencing the crystal groves that grew above it. The Elders considered it sacred and warned against disturbing it, but the miners eventually dug into its veins. The mountain cracked open. Ice poured through its roots, the waters flooded, the bluegrass burned, and the trees withered. [Aokusa](#), once a green and fertile land beneath the open sky, began to decay.

The Angels ([Autarchs](#)) descended soon afterwards. To the [Sahrani](#), their arrival marked the fall of their people, and the surviving account holds that they were cast from the sky for what their ancestors had done. The people left [Aokusa](#) and crossed the strait to [Sahrani](#), where the wound of the Golden Heart became the [Geode](#), a vast formation of crystal caverns that would become central to [Sahrani](#) life.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Aokusa](#), [Sahrani](#), [The Geode](#)

The Sun

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Sun

The Sun

Before the [Moon](#), [Aerisu](#) had only the Scorching Sun, a relentless blaze that never set. Its constant heat dried rivers, cracked the earth and was believed to strengthen the [Curse](#) by leaving the world no darkness or respite. This effect was worsened during the [Crescent Sun](#) phenomenon following the [Geode Rapture](#). [Solmara](#) took its name from that fire, and the [Autarchs](#) modelled their creed of endless progress upon it.

[Zuki Kusanagi](#) prayed for the Scorching Sun to cease. Her prayer was answered when [Lunarkos](#) fell from the dark, leading to the collision that created the [Moon](#) and ended the Sun's uninterrupted dominion. The Sun thereafter rose and set, yielding the sky to night and the [Moon's](#) light, and became known as the Warm Sun.

The Warm Sun represents continuance: light returning after darkness, and tomorrow following today. It is the Sun [Ash](#) invoked when he stood at the [Rift's](#) edge and made his vow.

In the [Age of Decay](#), [Perpetual Night](#) has reduced the Warm Sun to a brief appearance each Sunday. The [Luminaries](#) await its return and long for the Scorching Sun, believing its fire could cleanse the [Curse](#). The [Solarii](#) regard the Warm Sun as a lesson in restraint, greeting dawn in silence and reflecting its light through gold mirrors and crystals. The [Vesperites](#) prefer the [Moon's](#) rhythm and regard the Sun's departure as release. Among the scattered [Autarchs](#), some mourn the loss of its former power while others accept its transformation.

Even through the [Vanta-saturated](#) sky, the Sun still rises. Its persistence is what remains of its old promise: tomorrow still exists.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [The Luminaries](#), [The Solarii](#)

The Crescent Sun

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Crescent Sun

The Crescent Sun

The Crescent Sun is an atmospheric phenomenon that began following the ~~Geode Rapture~~, when material violently expelled from the Geode entered Aerisu's atmosphere. Vanta-saturated particulate matter altered the way sunlight travelled through the air, causing part of the Scorching Sun's disk to appear darkened or optically distorted while the remainder retained its usual brilliance. ~~The Sun~~ itself remained unchanged. Its light simply stopped reaching the world uniformly. The contamination was uneven, so the phenomenon never possessed the clean geometry of an ordinary eclipse. The affected region could appear dark, discoloured, diffuse or strangely patterned, with its boundary shifting according to atmospheric conditions. In places the Sun appeared as a thin crescent; elsewhere, as though a dark smear had crossed its face. Vanta-bearing particles could absorb, scatter or refract portions of incoming light in ways ordinary dust could not, giving the affected sky its characteristic unnatural appearance. ~~The Geode Rapture~~ was the immediate cause, though the responsibility reaches further back. Solmaran machinery and repeated expeditions had driven deeper into the Geode despite mounting evidence that its lower regions followed rules no one understood. ~~The Autarchs~~ did not create the Crescent Sun deliberately, yet their exploitation of the Geode created the conditions that allowed the ~~Rapture~~ to occur. What they forced underground eventually found its way into the sky. People interpreted the phenomenon according to what they already believed. Luminaries saw a wounded or angered Scorching Sun, while Vantari regarded it as evidence that Vanta had escaped the Geode's depths. Others saw the first visible consequence of ~~Autarch~~ industrialisation, while scholars and engineers treated it as an atmospheric phenomenon whose unusual behaviour could be measured and studied. All of them were looking at the same sky. The Crescent Sun became an enormous environmental echo of the ~~Geode Rapture~~. Humanity reached downward in pursuit of what lay beneath the earth, and the consequence eventually reached upward. ~~The Sun~~ continued burning exactly as it always had. Only part of its light could reach the world.

Related: [The Sun](#), [The Luminaries](#), [Geode Rapture](#)

Lunarkos

Age of Gods · Substances · also known as Lunarkos

Lunarkos

Lunarkos was a near-planetary body fifty-seven kilometres across, carbon-sheathed and iron-cored, yet alive in ways that defied mortal understanding. Within its crystalline heart pulsed Lux, a lattice of living light that bloomed and multiplied when it encountered soul-rich environments. It descended towards Aerisu over centuries, growing larger in the sky until its approach became a visible countdown to the world's destruction.

Its mass alone could have shattered continents, while its Lux threatened to spread across the planet in a catastrophic wave. Civilisations responded according to their means. Some built machines to redirect it. Others studied its structure, sought escape beyond the sky, or accepted its arrival as divine judgement. ~~The Lunartics~~ went further, believing Lunarkos to be the fulfilment of an ancient prayer and actively preventing attempts to stop it.

Lunarkos never reached the ground. When it entered Aerisu's inner atmosphere, the planet answered from its own depths. Bahamut rose through the mantle, a being of planetary will and anguish given form, and ascended to meet it in the upper stratosphere.

Their collision became the Shattering. Lunarkos and Bahamut annihilated one another in a single eruption of soul-vanta-lux, scattering fragments across the world and into orbit. Molten shards of Lunarkos carrying Lux fell upon oceans and mountains, where they seeded crystal forests and other forms of impossible life. The surviving debris gathered into a luminous ring that circled Aerisu for centuries before drawing together into the scarred and veined Moon.

Related: [The Shattering](#), [The Moon](#)

The Moon

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Moon

The Moon

The Moon is the remnant of Lunarkos and Bahamut, created when they collided in the upper stratosphere after Zuki Kusanagi's prayer brought Lunarkos to Aerisu.

Before it, Aerisu had no anchor in the sky. The Scorching Sun ruled without interruption, tides wandered, seasons drifted, and the world had no natural rhythm. Zuki, a girl from the mountain basin of Aokusa who had lost her mother to the Curse, her father to fear, and her home to a fire she had started herself, prayed only for the burning to end.

Something answered. Lunarkos, a fifty-seven-kilometre mass of carbon, iron, and crystalline Lux, appeared as a distant star and grew year by year as it approached Aerisu. The Coalition built machines to divert it, Angels entered the upper atmosphere on wings of light and steel, and the gods prepared for impact. The Lunartics instead sabotaged these efforts, believing the falling moon would cleanse a world ruined by the Scorching Sun.

When Lunarkos entered the inner atmosphere, Bahamut emerged from the planet's core, summoned by Voluntas through Anima's guidance. A being of pure Vanta and planetary will, Bahamut bore obsidian scales veined with magma and wings like continents tearing open beneath the sea. Their collision shattered both, scattering their fragments across the world before fusing them into the Moon.

Its pale surface still bears darker scars from the impact. Its light became Aerisu's primary illumination in the Age of Decay, with the sun appearing only once each week. Travellers navigate by it, farmers plant by it, and generations are born and buried beneath it.

The Moon represents the balance created by the collision: Vanta and Lux woven together, soul and matter bound across a boundary that had been torn open, with neither force allowed to rule. It also represents witness. It saw the Shattering and every age after, watching nations rise and fall without intervening, remembering what it sees.

The Vesperites regard it as proof that darkness can hold gentler light. The Luminaries curse it as a replacement for the sun they lost. The Solarii acknowledge it while gathering sunlight on rare Sundays and scattering its warmth through mirrors and crystal. The Tsukuyomi carry faint echoes of Zuki's original prayer and experience the Moon through dreams, reflections, and the sense of something patient and old watching them.

Scholars disagree over whether the Moon is simply rock and crystal obeying natural law or a presence that remembers the moment the world broke. It offers no answer. Above Sengetsuki and the crystal forests, its light falls equally on the hopeful and despairing, the living and dying, the guilty and innocent.

It remembers.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [The Vesperites](#), [The Luminaries](#)

Sacred Air

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Sacred Air

Sacred Air

Sacred Air is a white flower that blooms only at the summit of Tenseikoku, where Eirimegami's breath is said to move through the mountain's highest currents. Pilgrims who reach the summit may receive one as a blessing,

though what that blessing means is left to the pilgrim.

Its petals are cold and sharp, with a scent like cold stone after rain. Crushed into an infusion, particularly camomile tea, or worn against the skin, Sacred Air is said to help draw the Curse's taint from the afflicted, making it a common remedy sought by those who climb Tenseikoku.

In Hoshimira, the flower represents purity, healing and the bond between mortal and divine. Some regard receiving one as a sign of Eirimegami's favour, others as proof of their own perseverance, while some simply cherish it as a flower from the highest peak of Tenseikoku.

Sacred Air does not wilt easily. Even when dried, its petals retain their distinctive scent and the quiet character of the mountain where they grew.

Related: [Eirimegami](#), [Tenseikoku](#)

The Vireliax

Age of Men · Substances · also known as The Vireliax

The Vireliax

They call the Vireliax a legend of the Vaelmiric seas, one of the last Norrvektstan seaborne dreadnoughts to survive the Vaelmiric War. She is a feat of military engineering pressed into a single shape, built to endure depths and storms that would destroy lesser ships. Her black hull stretches more than a hundred metres and rises six decks, four below the waterline. Alchemical veins glow faintly along its surface, while quake-tempered obsidian reinforced with kyrite gives the hull a semi-submersible frame capable of withstanding abyssal pressure. A triple keel keeps her steady in seas where storms would tear lesser ships apart. Her command bridge is sparse and dim, combining analogue instrumentation with the gem-based interfaces common to modern engineering, crewed by Norrvekts. Mid-decks hold social halls and messes where the crew can eat and rest between voyages. Lower levels contain quarters, archives and engines worked and maintained by Sahrani labourers. The lowest deck carries submersibles designed to descend into trenches the sea itself seems reluctant to acknowledge. There are rooms absent from every manifest: experimental chambers, data vaults and spaces left over from expeditions whose records were never made public. Despite her age, the Vireliax has survived seven deep-sea voyages through the Maw storms, a record no modern vessel has matched. She still stands at the edge of human ambition, staring into the abyss.

Related: [Vaelmir](#), [Vireliax Expedition](#)

Shorin no Okami

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Shorin no Okami

Shorin no Okami

Shorin no Okami still stands in Aokusa, where the Autarchs built it to guard the basin, its terraces, and the people living between the mountains and the sky. When the Angels were recalled and Solmaran authority shifted into new political forms, the mech was left behind. No retrieval order survives in any archive, so whether it was forgotten or deliberately abandoned remains unknown. Over the centuries, vines climbed its plating and doves settled between its joints. During the Festival of Bloom, children carry flowers and small offerings to its feet, while lanterns are hung from the vines. By nightfall, the mech stands among the lights as music and dancing continue around it. The festival is also when stories of Shorin no Okami surface. Girls most often, though not exclusively, who stare too long into a lantern flame near the mech sometimes find themselves elsewhere, witnessing battles in unfamiliar terrain. They describe sounds that linger after the vision ends, and some accounts are so consistent across

generations that they appear to depict the same events: moments of catastrophic contact witnessed from close to the ground. Whether these visions are memories preserved within the machine, echoes of what it was built to withstand, or glimpses of what is yet to come remains unresolved. The offerings continue regardless. Whatever Shorin no Okami contains, generations of people have chosen to stand beneath it with a small light in their hands and look up. After enough centuries, perhaps that is how something earns its name.

Related: [Aokusa](#), [Angels Reformed](#)

Ik-Rasul

Age of Men · Substances · also known as Ik-Rasul

The Ik-Rasul

The Ik-Rasul is an aircraft of disputed origin. Solmaran and Hoshimiran reports describe it as a Sahrani weapon, constructed in secret and deliberately launched towards Aokusa, while no surviving Sahrani record acknowledges its existence, names its builder, or documents its construction.

What remains certain is the wreckage. Fire Gems were still burning inside the engine casing when it came down, while shattered Ankaru crystals scattered across the Aokusa fields, their cold bleeding into the soil. The frame was assembled from mech parts of different eras and origins, fitted together with enough patience to suggest years of work. The old Autarch structures in the upper Geode, including abandoned administrative tiers, scaffolding and cavities left from their first occupation, could have provided the space and concealment such a project required.

Certain Sahrani communities preserve a different account, told quietly and with varying details, concerning a boy and his father who attempted to fly back to Aokusa. The destination remains consistent: the mountain from which their people had been separated for generations. They called their aircraft the Ik-Rasul, an old-tongue name meaning something close to "I am the Apostle", carrying connotations of devotion, pilgrimage or arrogance depending on the listener.

The sun reached the engines before they reached the mountain, and the aircraft came down in the fields it was trying to reach. Whether the Ik-Rasul was a weapon, an act of pilgrimage, or something between the two remains unknown. The Ankaru's cold still lingers in the fields, and the aquifers remember whatever entered them afterwards. The Geode has offered no answer.

Related: [Ik-Rasul Incident](#), [Aokusa](#), [The Geode](#)

Soul Shards

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Soul Shards, Heart Crystals

Soul Shards are fragments of crystallised soul resonance, or echoes, physical remnants of consciousness frozen into mineral form. They were first created through Zephyr's experiments on the Cursed and children, when they were known as Heart Crystals. The process extracted and concentrated soul essence through alchemical apparatus before cooling it into crystal, producing small, warm fragments in which light moves and resonance remains active.

Soul Shards became widely used as magic foci, reservoirs of concentrated will, prisons for consciousness, and components in the creation of Borenfegens, among other applications. Using one draws upon the essence within it, making Soul Shards an exceptionally efficient source of magical power. Their trade flourishes across Aerisu.

The name Heart Crystal eventually gave way to Soul Shard, reflecting their nature as fragments broken from a larger soul. The most dangerous shards are made from the truly Cursed, whose corrupted resonance can spread memetic contagion through those who handle them.

The flame Veyra lit in the sewers of Elysium, which still burns, was fed by a fragment of Maura's Soul Shard. The first spell cast on Aerisu was cast through a child's compressed soul.

Related: [Soul Capturing](#), [The Diviners](#)

Orb of Souls

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Orb of Souls, Veyra's Womb, The Womb

Orb of Souls, Veyra's Womb

At the centre of the Spirit Realm, beyond the Hell of Elysium, lies the Orb of Souls. The first Phumenar to encounter it perceived a sphere that seemed transparent and opaque, warm and cold, singing and silent at once. They understood it as a repository of souls, where the dead gathered and knowledge accumulated.

In this, they were partly correct. The Orb contains a nexus of soul resonance where identity, memory and will converge, making it a concentrated expression of the architecture of consciousness itself.

The Phumenar did not know that the Orb was also Veyra's womb, crystallised by the Vanta Explosion around the unborn Voluntas. Within it, Voluntas grew across centuries, nourished by planetary energy, the Echoes of souls and the memories of the dead. She became entangled with Anima, goddess of mortality, who served as her steward and observer.

The Phumenar felt Voluntas's influence moving through them like a deep current and followed it with unwavering focus, never fully understanding what they were following or where it would lead.

Related: [Spirit Realm](#)

Vanta as a Substance

Age of Fairytales · Substances · also known as Vanta

Vanta as a Substance

In Aerisu, Vanta manifests as a tangible, corrosive force: a memetic, parasitic and elemental substance that erodes memory, perception and the soul. Blackened blood, corrupted stone, altered wildlife and anomalous signals mark its presence, while exposure can spread its influence through minds and matter, warping reality and distorting thought.

Vanta exists at the intersection of the metaphysical and material. It is the substance of the Curse and the physical expression of soul hunger, giving form to the void at the root of Vanta: the absence that drives desire and, when left unchecked, becomes a living and contagious force.

Related: [Vanta \(Concept\)](#)

The Grimoire

Age of Magic · Substances · also known as The Grimoire, Doctrine of Becoming, VantaPsy Doctrine

The Grimoire, Doctrine of Becoming

Fragments of an ancient text were uncovered among the Phumenar ruins. Known as Veyra Megami's Doctrine of Becoming, the Grimoire survived the Vanta Explosion in crystallised form, preserved where much else was

destroyed.

The Grimoire contains no spells. It presents a philosophical framework for the relationship between Soul, Desire, Responsibility and Reality, expressed through the Six Steps of Humanity, a progression through which every soul moves towards wholeness.

To Truly Lack. A soul recognises its incompleteness without shame, perceiving absence clearly without allowing it to define its worth. The first station of the Spiral Veins holds this mirror, revealing what is truly missing.

To Want with Compassion. Desire arises without consumption, learning to build and nurture rather than destroy. The second station tests this through a marketplace where souls must refuse what they crave for the sake of those around them.

To Seek Clarity within Both Noise and Fog. Truth must be found amid confusion. The third station surrounds the soul in fog, demanding discovery without external guidance.

To Act or To Not Act with Noble Intent. Choice must arise from purpose rather than impulse, with restraint where action would cause harm and action where stillness would fail. The fourth station reveals every consequence and demands ownership of what has already occurred.

To Take Proper Responsibility for Your Actions or the Actions of Your Consequences. Every choice produces consequences that spread beyond the one who made it. The fifth station forms a labyrinth of mirrors, reflecting everyone affected by those choices.

To Echo with Reverence. Every decision resonates through time, becoming part of a greater pattern that continues across the Loop. The sixth station opens into vast silence, where souls must create something enduring that demonstrates their existence mattered.

The Grimoire became a major philosophical touchstone during the Age of Magic. Psycrata scholars study it as a map of soul mechanics, Hoshimiran priests find confirmation of established practices, and Fengua's ordered society sees validation of disciplined restraint. The Luminaries later drew upon it to frame desire as the root of corruption and a force that must be quelled to preserve purity.

Its interpretations continue to diverge, while the core text endures as a guide to the Soul, the nature of magic and the responsibility that accompanies power.

Related: [VantaPsy](#), [The Phumenaar](#)

Thunder Cannon

Age of Magic · Substances · also known as Thunder Cannon, Leiting pao

Fengua's Thunder Cannon, Leiting pao, was the culmination of generations spent studying and harnessing the storms shaped by Susanoo's presence. Raikami crystals formed where his essence struck mineral veins, while Fenguan engineers developed alchemical and scientific methods to refine that divine force into usable power.

The weapon was conceived as a response to the growing threat of Voluntas beneath New Elysium. As the Curse spread and Vanta deepened, the Council and its generals concluded that the Orb of Souls was the source of the world's suffering. Their solution was a weapon capable of striking it from across the continent.

The cannon combined Raikami crystals gathered over centuries with alchemical condensers that concentrated ambient Vanta and targeting arrays calibrated through decades of studying Susanoo's lightning patterns. The engineers believed they were redirecting an ancient force towards a necessary end. Years of debate followed, with the Council weighing the catastrophe of striking the heart of the world's magic against the deaths that would continue if Voluntas survived. They ultimately chose the weapon.

When the Luminaries reached the Orb and the Ashtar closed in, the Thunder Cannon fired. Its first blast tore through stone, crystal and divine flesh. Susanoo rose to intercept it, and before a second shot could reach its

target, [Anqa](#) descended from the sky and broke the cannon.

The destruction divided [Fengua](#)'s response. Northern provinces turned towards grief, building shrines at lightning-strike sites and waiting for [Susanoo](#)'s return. Southern provinces salvaged the wreckage and refined its designs for future wars. Monks instead withdrew into the high valleys, studying Chi through meditation and breath, seeking balance rather than greater power.

In time, [Fengua](#) came to understand that the Thunder Cannon had been aimed at the wrong target. The weapon was built to destroy an external enemy, while the deeper struggle had always been within.

Related: [Fengua](#), [Susanoo](#), [Orb of Souls](#)

City Shields

Age of Magic · Substances · also known as City Shields

City Shields

Across [Aerisu](#), cities maintain barriers against the beasts, [Vanta](#)-corrupted creatures, wandering [Cursed](#) and other monsters that emerged after the Shattering. Their methods vary according to regional resources.

Some cities sustain magical barriers through priests who meditate in temples positioned at cardinal points. Their consciousness remains focused on maintaining the shield, with generations of monks trained to ensure continuous coverage. If every priest's meditation is interrupted simultaneously, the shield fails, so these cities build redundancy into their rotations.

Others rely on technological barriers powered by [Lux](#) batteries or crystallised energy harvested from the [Veins](#). Machines maintain these shields continuously while engineers monitor generators and replace worn components. They cannot adapt to emerging threats as readily as magical barriers, but require no constant magical concentration or generations of specialised training.

Smaller towns may entrust their protection to a single powerful soul who maintains the shield alone. The barrier lasts only as long as its bearer can sustain it, collapsing if they sleep, tire or die. Such towns therefore depend entirely on the person whose strength protects them.

These shields form the boundary between civilisation and the wild, allowing people to live behind walls while dangers gather beyond them. Every method carries the same condition: protection lasts only while something continues to sustain it.

Related: [The Diviners](#)

Blood Types

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Blood Types, Black Blood, White Blood, Synthetic White, Snyth Blood, Gold Blood, Purple Blood, Pink Blood, Blue Blood, Green Blood

Blood Types

Blood in [Aerisu](#) responds to what acts upon it. Desire, absence, discipline, augmentation, magic and artificial construction can all alter its properties, producing distinct blood types. The system begins with Red as the human baseline, from which other states emerge through different forms of alteration.

The chart is divided broadly between Lack and Want, represented by White and Black, and between organic alteration and constructed states. Some transitions are natural or gradual, while others require deliberate intervention.

Red Blood, the Human Baseline

Red blood is the ordinary human state. It carries oxygen, clots predictably and can be stored or transfused without unusual behaviour. It has no inherent alteration, although it can transition into other blood types through external influence.

Red can become White through cursed lack, Black through cursed want, Green through chi meditation, Gold through augmentation, Purple through magical saturation, or Pink through cross-breeding with Blue. It cannot transition directly to Blue. Synthetic blood must be deliberately constructed.

White Blood, Cursed Lack

White blood develops through cold, isolation and profound despair, when the Curse manifests as absence. It is cold, withdrawn and largely inert until disturbed.

When White Blood contacts water, it expands and clings to surfaces, producing slow corrosion. Sudden heat can cause it to burst violently. It is difficult to remove once it has adhered to something.

Those who carry White Blood tend towards withdrawal and stagnation. Some remain physically present while their awareness becomes trapped in night terrors or inward collapse. White can develop naturally from Red through cursed lack or be reproduced artificially as Synthetic White Blood.

Black Blood, Cursed Want

Black blood develops through heat, pressure and intense desire, when the Curse manifests as hunger. It is acidic and highly corrosive, burning through surfaces wherever it spills.

Its carriers tend towards rage, violence and sharpened senses as desire intensifies. Black Blood is inherently cursed and can develop from Red or other blood types through cursed saturation.

White and Black form a continuous spectrum of cursed lack and want. Temperature and internal temperament influence the exact properties of either type, so individual samples can vary considerably.

Green Blood, Chi Integration

Green blood develops through prolonged chi meditation and represents deliberate regulation of desire. It is found among monks of Fengua who have mastered Chi integration, using meditation, breath control and disciplined acceptance to suppress wanting.

Green blood ranges from pale leaf-green to deep forest shades according to the monk's level of cultivation. It is not inherently cursed. If the discipline that produced it fails and cursed want takes hold, Green can transition towards Black. It can also become Gold through augmentation.

Gold Blood, Augmented Enhancement

Gold blood develops when extensive augmentation alters the body's chemistry. Metallic threads run through it, producing shades resembling brass, bronze or gold according to the quality of the modifications.

The blood itself remains otherwise functional, although its appearance reveals the extent to which the body has been altered. Gold is not inherently cursed. Augmentation is permanent, so Gold cannot naturally return to Red. It can, however, be driven towards Black through the Curse.

Blue Blood, Borenfegen Blood

Blue blood is the defining blood type of Borenfegens, artificial humans grown in Silealyros vats. It carries a deep blue colour and otherwise flows according to the basic mechanics of human blood. Once extracted, it gradually fades towards grey as it dies.

Blue blood is not inherently cursed. Borenfegens are constructed using Synthetic White Blood as part of their creation process, and Blue can transition towards Synthetic White through saturation. It cannot arise naturally from Red.

Synthetic White Blood, Engineered Lack

Synthetic White Blood, also called Synth Blood, was developed by Zephyr of Sahran from the properties of natural White Blood. He engineered its stillness, adhesion and consumption into a substance that could be administered, measured and reproduced without the unpredictability of its natural counterpart.

Synth Blood is watery and translucent, with a faint shimmer. It does not expand, cling or burst under heat like natural White Blood. Once introduced into the body, it quietly suppresses desire and volition. The afflicted remain physically functional and mentally coherent, capable of following instructions and maintaining routines, while gradually losing the impulse to initiate or resist.

Zephyr described it as a stabilisation agent for controlling Cursed subjects, and it was administered to adults and children in the facilities beneath Elysium and in Isvara, with doses calibrated to body weight and desired compliance. Synthetic White Blood is inherently cursed and is also used in the construction of Borenfegens. Too much can leave the body inert; too little can leave a Borenfegen unstable.

Pink Blood, Hybrid Blood

Pink blood most commonly develops when a Borenfegen and a red-blooded human conceive a child, combining the artificial Blue lineage with the human Red baseline. It is pale, translucent and may show a faint luminescence, while retaining characteristics of both types.

Those born with Pink Blood can have unusual soul characteristics, including a more flexible Strand or a partially translucent or shifting Affinity after the Separation-Ritual. Pink can also arise temporarily through certain forms of magical saturation or alchemical exposure.

Some Pink-blooded individuals are cursed and others are not. Pink can move towards Purple through magical or cursed saturation and can approach Red or Blue without directly becoming either.

Purple Blood, Magical Saturation

Purple blood results when magic saturates the body beyond ordinary limits. Its colour ranges from pale lavender to deep violet, while its consistency can vary from thin and watery to thick and syrup-like.

Vantari death gardeners may develop Purple Blood through prolonged exposure to Vanta-rich soil, while some of the undead who continue walking after death also bleed purple. The Diviners regard it as a warning sign of magical saturation, although its presence alone does not establish the severity of the Curse.

Purple blood is inherently cursed. It can develop from Red, Pink or other states through magical or cursed saturation, and can progress towards Black under further corruption.

Classification

Inherently cursed: White, Black, Purple and Synthetic White.

Not inherently cursed: Red, Blue, Green and Gold. These may still be altered or corrupted by the Curse.

Contingent: Pink. Its condition depends on its lineage and the circumstances that produced it.

Related: [Chi](#), [Zephyr](#), [The Borenfegens](#), [Cursed Soul](#)

Frallation Marks

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Frallation Mark, Curse Mark, Black Mark

The Frallation Mark System

Frallation marks express how prolonged pressure manifests through the body and mind. The body may shape that pressure into root structures, while the mind may shape it into script. Either can appear alone, or both can develop together.

Root structures form when pressure settles into the body's physical pathways. They follow the architecture of the flesh, tracing tendons, ribs, spine and jaw as branching lines that resemble veins, fractures or embedded roots. Raised or sunken like scar tissue, they distribute pressure through the body, allowing it to endure the strain for longer. Individuals with predominantly root-based marks tend to retain a coherent sense of self while experiencing increasing physical strain, fatigue and eventual collapse.

Script forms when pressure gathers through thought and perception. It appears as thin, irregular traces across the skin, often in fragments and clusters resembling partial symbols or interrupted lines. The markings may layer over time, accumulating where multiple formations occupy the same space. Script reflects cognitive and memetic disturbance, with its progression affecting memory, identity and behaviour while producing less physical adaptation.

When both develop, the roots provide physical structure while the script accumulates meaning. Script may follow the paths of the roots or cross them without regard for anatomy, sometimes gathering around areas of emotional or cognitive weight. Its density and distribution vary between individuals, reflecting how each person processes and carries internal pressure rather than following a fixed pattern.

From a distance, root structures define the body's silhouette, while script reveals itself through closer inspection. Together they create a marking system in which physical strain and cognitive disturbance leave distinct, overlapping records of Frallation.

Related: [Frallation](#), [Soulless](#), [Performed Frallation Marks](#)

Performed Frallation Marks

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Performed Frallation Marks

Performed Frallation Marks

The visibility of Frallation has led some to reproduce its appearance deliberately through skin marking. Some use thick, branching tattoos that follow anatomical lines and echo root structures, while others use thin, fragmented markings resembling script. Root tattoos tend towards clarity and symmetry; script designs favour irregularity and layered forms that suggest something still taking shape.

Motivations vary. Some wear them to embody intensity or a perceived connection to something deeper within themselves. Others feel an affinity with Frallation or believe the marks reveal something already present in them, making the act of marking a form of acknowledgement.

Those with true Frallation recognise the difference. Its marks continue to change over time, gaining density in some places and thinning in others, while performed marks remain fixed from the moment they are made. The distinction is often apparent only at close range, quietly shaping how the condition is perceived.

Related: [Frallation Marks](#), [Frallation](#), [Soulless](#)

The Soulless Brand

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Soulless Brand, The Brand, The Burn Mark

The Soulless Brand

The ~~Diviners~~ of the ~~Crown Nations~~ developed the Soulless Brand to monitor and control those who fail the Separation Ritual. Applied to the face as a magical imprint, the Brand marks the afflicted and siphons residual magic from their bodies. It functions as a small-scale Rift, allowing the ~~Diviners~~ to track its bearer while harvesting magical energy that would otherwise accumulate towards death. Most Soulless conceal the Brand with makeup,

hiding a mark that has become widely feared.

The Burn Mark

In response to the Brand's invasive effects, certain Diviners developed the Burn Mark as a protective sigil. Applied over or near the Brand, it is intended to block tracking and prevent the extraction of magic. Its effectiveness remains uncertain, leaving it as the only known countermeasure to the Brand's intrusion and a symbol of resistance against a system built to catalogue and control the Soulless.

Related: [The Diviners](#), [Soulless](#), [Frallation](#)

Vanta Points

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Vanta Points, Vp, VP, vp

Vanta Points

Vanta Points, usually shortened to VP, measure the Vanta that gathers within a person as desire presses against the walls of the Soul. Hope held too tightly, unresolved fear and lingering promises leave traces that the world quietly collects. Most people shed these traces without noticing, while Soulless produce VP more readily because their Souls draw Vanta inward rather than allowing it to flow naturally. The same pressure that hastens Frallation can therefore become another person's livelihood.

VP became a form of currency alongside ordinary money. Merchants trade in it, Diviners measure it, researchers chart it, and Shard vendors accept it. Desire acquired purchasing power.

VP is closely tied to Soul Resonance. As resonance strengthens through hardship, conviction, understanding and perseverance, the Soul presses more strongly against the Vanta gathered within, generating further VP. Practitioners can spend VP to strengthen themselves, gaining greater resilience, sharper instincts and stronger Affinities. The process is intuitive, as though accumulated desire settles into the Soul and reshapes it from within.

VP can also be lost. Defeat, despair and the collapse of purpose weaken Soul Resonance, allowing accumulated Vanta to scatter back into the world. The result is often experienced as a lingering emptiness, a sense that something once held within has slipped away. A lost battle, abandoned ambition or broken spirit therefore carries a measurable cost.

That exchange gives VP its peculiar place in Aerisu. Courage, perseverance and desire can accumulate as something measurable, something that can be exchanged for bread, medicine or a polished shard on a merchant's shelf. People simply learned to mint value from what they carried inside themselves.

Every Vanta Point is a fragment of desire suspended between Psyn and Vu~etsu, between the human Soul and the ideals it strives towards.

Related: [Currency of Sengetsuki](#), [Soulless](#), [Soul Resonance](#)

Currency of Sengetsuki

Age of Knowledge · Substances · also known as Psyn, Sen, Vu~etsu, Vuetsu, Vu etsu, Vu-etsu

Currency of Sengetsuki: The Mechanics of Exchange

Most of Sengetsuki counts its money in Sen, coins of dark iron wrapped around polished silver. Each denomination bears the Moon in a different phase, from a narrow crescent on the smallest coins to the scarred face of the Moon on the largest. Their reverses depict the city's streets and railways, pressing Sengetsuki itself into every exchange.

Before the Sen became the common measure of value, Sengetsuki traded in Psyn and Vu~etsu, currencies whose denominations followed the [Spiral Journey](#). Their values rose with each stage, turning the progression of a soul into a system of exchange.

The Psyn (p) were warm copper-alloy coins that gradually developed violet and green patina. Their denominations followed the first six stages of the Journey:

1 Psyn bore the leaf of Verdantia, where journeys first touched the soil. 2 Psyn carried Anima's threshold, where breath entered waiting flesh. 5 Psyn bore Elysia's split mask, reflecting the heart's capacity for joy and grief. 10 Psyn carried the open book of Logaris, where thought reached towards clarity. 20 Psyn bore Creatis's gear, celebrating imagination given physical form. 50 Psyn carried Justicar's scales, where choices found their consequences and every life its weight.

Beyond them were the Vu~etsu (v). One hundred Psyn equalled one Vu~etsu, and the metal changed to dense white bronze, brighter and heavier than copper.

1 Vu~etsu, worth 100 Psyn, bore the spiral of Aether, the frame that cradled the universe. 2 Vu~etsu, worth 200 Psyn, carried Mnemotas's chained hourglass, gathering every passing age into memory. 5 Vu~etsu, worth 500 Psyn, bore the rising flame of Voluntas, the summit of the [Spiral Journey](#) where desire became motion and will reached beyond history.

Old Psyn and Vu~etsu still circulate occasionally among collectors, preserved in wooden boxes, forgotten drawers and small shops. Their continued presence leaves an older idea of value embedded within Sengetsuki's modern currency: the [Spiral Journey](#) never entirely disappeared from people's hands. They simply changed the metal.

Sengetsuki's modern currency is the Sen, while older Psyn and Vu~etsu followed the stages of the [Spiral Journey](#), with surviving coins still carrying its symbols.

Related: [Sengetsuki](#), [Vanta Points](#)

Verdani

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Verdani, Heal Shard, Heal Stone, Heal Gem, Heal Crystal

Verdani - Heal Crystals

Verdani is a restorative crystalline material refined in [Atenara](#) from crystallised herbal distillates and mineral binders drawn from the fertile floodplains of [Kushara](#) and the island gardens of [Heliadis](#). Its ocean-green crystal is cool to the touch and carries a faint scent of mint, jasmine and sun-warmed leaves.

Verdani's restorative properties come from the interaction between its herbal compounds, mineral structure and [Lux](#) infusion. When activated, it releases a gentle restorative charge that supports the body's own recovery, making it effective against wounds, exhaustion, shock and deeper tissue damage without placing additional strain on the body.

The concentration of [Lux](#) and the density of the crystal determine how much energy Verdani can hold and how quickly it releases it. Less concentrated pieces are common in [Solarii](#) temples, coastal clinics, civilian first-aid kits and expedition supplies, while heavily refined crystals are reserved for severe injuries and sanctioned medical or rescue work. The most concentrated forms require regulated [Lux](#) infusion in the shrines of [Heliadis](#), and their production and distribution are tightly licensed by the authorities responsible for [Lux](#) use.

Verdani is valued precisely because its healing effect remains gradual and compatible with natural recovery. Rather than forcing the body into immediate reconstruction, it provides the energy required for damaged tissue to stabilise and repair itself, making it one of the most widely trusted restorative materials in [Atenara](#).

Related: [Raikami](#), [Mauri](#), [Atenara](#)

Mauri

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Mauri, Revive Stone, Revive Gem, Revive Crystal

Mauri - Revive Crystals

Mauri is a rare crystalline material refined for the restoration of consciousness, designed to pull an unconscious person back from the narrow threshold between the body and separation. In *Atenara*, the crystal is called Mauri, meaning "life-force made tangible". Its activation produces a sharp taste of copper, salt and sun-warmed stone, grounding the user in sensation before awareness returns.

The concentration and stability of Mauri determine how many people it can affect and how reliably consciousness can be restored. Less concentrated crystals are used to revive individual people, while the rarest *Lux*-stabilised forms can recall multiple unconscious people at once. These crystals produce no immediate pain during activation, although many survivors report feeling a deep internal pulse for days afterwards, like a slow echo through the blood, which *Atenaran* tradition associates with the first light after the longest night.

Mauri is treated as an act of intervention rather than ordinary medical treatment, and its use carries considerable weight among the *Solarii*. The most concentrated forms are theoretically reusable, although almost no one survives needing more than one in a lifetime. Their use remains controversial, and *Solarii* priests approach each revival with the reverence of a returning dawn, often accompanied by consequence and thanksgiving.

Related: [Verdani](#), [Lux Crystals](#), [Atenara](#)

Naru

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Naru, Fire Shard, Fire Stone, Fire Gem, Fire Crystal

Naru - Fire Crystals

Naru is a geothermal crystalline material extracted from the Geode in *Tayran*, where extreme geothermal pressure fractures mineral veins into volatile fragments. It remains warm at rest and can produce a short controlled flare through soul-resonance or mechanical ignition.

The concentration and stability of Naru determine the scale and control of its thermal discharge. Less concentrated crystals are used as expendable ignition tools by *Varkanian* troops, industrial workers and civilian defence cadres, while more stable forms release accumulated thermal energy in a broad surge and became standard *Autarch* ordnance. The most concentrated crystals form in the deepest accessible Geode tiers, where extreme heat and pressure reshape the mineral structure. Sealed, they radiate oppressive warmth and require containment to prevent premature detonation; activated, they produce concentrated infernos capable of collapsing fortifications, melting armour and permanently scarring terrain.

During the *Age of Men*, *Sahrani* labourers mined Naru under *Solmaran Autarch* occupation and economic exploitation. The *Geode Rebellion* allowed *Sahrani* communities in *Tayran* to reclaim partial sovereignty, although trade agreements, debt and political leverage enabled the displaced *Autarchs* in *Varkane* to retain influence. Modern *Tayran* trades Naru to *Varkane* under these constraints, while the *Panjara-Najmara* accord regulates the deployment of its most destructive forms. *Zaristan* has remained silent during negotiations while legal loopholes, grey markets and covert arrangements have enabled sales to *Varkane*.

Naru remains both an essential industrial material and a symbol of the political control surrounding *Tayran's* resources.

Related: [Ankaru](#), [Tayran](#), [The Geode](#)

Ankaru

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Ankaru, Ice Shard, Ice Stone, Ice Gem, Ice Crystal

Ankaru - Ice Crystals

Ankaru is a frost-bound crystalline material found in the high ranges of Hoshimira, where ancient formations preserve extreme cold across millennia. It remains solid regardless of ambient temperature and can produce a brief numbing chill through soul-resonance or mechanical activation. Officially called Ankaru in technical records, it is traded south to Sahran at inflated prices where water is rationed.

The concentration and density of Ankaru determine the scale of its thermal suppression. It was first employed as a coolant in mech systems during Geode expeditions beneath Tayran, and Project-DAEDALUS later led Solmara to refine it into cryotech combining thermal suppression with soul-reactive engineering. More concentrated crystals can leech heat systematically across a wide area, while the most extreme formations suppress thermal motion to a point approaching absolute zero without reaching it. Exposure to these forms can dull perception, slow cognition and cause severe brief fugue states in which awareness of time is lost.

Ankaru-Kai formations occur in the deepest mountain strata, where pressure and time compress ambient cold into stable crystalline matrices. Extraction is dangerous, with miners reporting spatial disorientation, temporal distortion and recurring dreams of drowning in frozen water, leading the Hoshimiran Temple Authority to regulate mining alongside its spiritual prohibitions. Vesperites incorporate Ankaru into meditation, believing the crystals retain the memory of the original cold, while Hoshimiran folklore associates the formations with a sleeping deity beneath subterranean lakes. Some scholars speculate that they preserve fragments of Bahamut's essence, although no divine presence has been confirmed.

During the collapse of Elysium, Ankaru-Shin cryotech arrays were deployed throughout the city, creating a perpetual winter that slowed the spread of the Curse and preserved the dying. The disaster remains the basis of the Solmaran Council's Elysium Protocols and its strict regulation of modern cryotech.

Related: [Naru](#), [Lux Crystals](#), [Hoshimira](#)

Raikami

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Raikami, Electric Shard, Electric Stone, Electric Gem, Electric Crystal

Raikami - Electric Crystals

Raikami forms where Susanoo's lightning strikes the earth and reaches particular mineral seams in the storm valleys of Fengua. After the Shattering, Hoshimiran clans descended into these restless valleys and learned to recognise the patterns of the storms. The crystal retains a persistent residual charge, producing a low irregular buzz that can interfere with conductive and soul-reactive devices.

The concentration and stability of Raikami determine how much electrical force it can store and release. Less concentrated pieces became common, reliable harvests used in everyday tools and rituals, while more stable lattices can release broad electrical surges capable of overwhelming unshielded systems and disrupting biological rhythm. Sensitive instruments may cause compasses to spin, radios to fill with static resembling fragments of language and soul-reactive machinery to awaken. The crystals' hum often intensifies before severe weather, making them an informal forecast for sailors and farmers.

The most concentrated Raikami cores hold electrical force under near-catastrophic tension, producing ozone, static and physical sensations such as aching fillings and raised hair. They can also lower the threshold of magical

Connection required to channel their effects, allowing lesser attunement to produce power that would otherwise require years of discipline. Repeated use can create dependency, leading societies to regulate them.

Fengua's greatest weapon of the ~~Age of Magic~~, the ~~Leiting-pao~~ or ~~Thunder Cannon~~, was built around such cores and alchemical condensers, producing a beam capable of striking a guardian god. Raikami remains both a practical resource and an enduring physical trace of Susanoo's storms.

Related: [Verdani](#), [Lux Crystals](#), [Fengua](#), [Susanoo](#)

Lux Crystals

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as Lux, Lux Shard, Lux Stone, Lux Gem, Lux Crystal

Lux - Lux Crystals

Lux is a crystalline radiance born from the Shattering of the Sky. Lunarkos carried concentrated Lux essence before colliding with Bahamut, scattering fragments across Aerisu where they became embedded in the crust and merged with geological and biological substrates to form an underlying crystalline lattice.

The concentration and refinement of Lux determine the intensity and nature of its effects. Less concentrated crystals produce a steady glow even without ambient light, becoming brighter in darkness, and can disrupt shadow formations, dispel minor obscuring and make concealment difficult. These forms are widely used for civilian illumination and distributed by clergy as tangible blessings. Greater concentrations flood an area with structured radiance, purifying darkness and destabilising Vanta-corrupted states. Lux can also stabilise souls, heal early Frallation and suppress Vanta temporarily.

~~The Psycrata~~ have documented that concentrated Lux can suppress free will, reduce creative deviation and enforce behavioural conformity. Prolonged or excessive use can also produce Lux Overgrowth, in which imposed order becomes pathological and structure hardens into rigidity. The most intense crystals act as revelation focuses, exposing hidden forms, suppressed truths and concealed identities, causing shapeshifters to revert, illusions to collapse and lies to become physically painful. Such exposure has caused severe trauma, destroyed relationships and driven some people to suicide, leading temples to maintain exclusive control over these forms.

Lux therefore serves as both a healing and controlling force, with its effects extending from physical restoration to the imposition of order upon matter, magic and thought. Its relationship with the Moon reflects the same principle: Moonlight reveals through reflection and refraction, illuminating while preserving mystery. Lux can reveal much while still leaving meaning to be understood.

Related: [Verdani](#), [VantaBlack](#), [Lunarkos](#), [The Moon](#)

VantaBlack

Age of Decay · Substances · also known as VantaBlack, Vanta Shard, Vanta Stone, Vanta Gem, Vanta Crystal

VantaBlack - Vanta Crystals

VantaBlack forms where Vanta saturation disrupts matter and structure collapses into void-touched crystal. Less concentrated forms can cause cognitive slips in which thoughts, memories or names become temporarily unreachable. Researchers exposed to them have reported recurring dreams of loss and erasure and developed compulsive habits of documentation, hoarding and recording. These effects can persist after contact and leave permanent psychological scarring.

The concentration and stability of VantaBlack determine the severity of its effects. Greater concentrations form stable void crystals that absorb light like a hole in space, producing intrusive doubt and existential unease concerning the meaning of actions, relationships and beliefs. Proximity correlates with depression, nihilistic ideation and existential dissociation even without activation, leading governments to license their possession. Vantari cults instead embrace these crystals in rituals intended to accelerate decay and return to primordial absence.

Vanta was once theorised to originate in the Geode beneath Tayran, but surveys established that it is present across Aerisu and intrinsic to reality. It represents condensed entropy and unfiltered desire, expressing wanting without wisdom, hunger without fulfilment and acknowledged lack left unresolved. Vanta can arise through emotional and existential processes and increases around entities and environments shaped by despair, nihilism and existential collapse.

The most concentrated black-tier deposits thin reality itself, making the boundary between the material and Spirit Realms permeable. Exposure can produce profound existential distress and the sensation of becoming less real while remaining physically present. Leaked reports describe effects that unmake concepts, erase bodies and the memory that they existed, and leave gaps in causality. Possession is illegal or tightly restricted across most of Aerisu, while Vantari nations such as Ereboska and Necrovia treat the most powerful forms as sacred and as deterrents against foreign aggression.

Vanta was once widely theorised to have originated with Bahamut during the Shattering, when the planetary defence tore through the mantle and exposed concentrated entropy. Comprehensive study now shows that Vanta exists within everything capable of conscious existence, making VantaBlack one of the most dangerous substances known to Aerisu.

Related: [Lux Crystals](#), [Mauri](#), [The Geode](#), [Vanta \(Concept\)](#)